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Spirit and Consciousness

Kat Salomon

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Foreword

Spiritual science or science of the spirit has always existed. It is known under different names and has been taught with different methods that correspond to the level of consciousness of man. Names such as yoga, Buddhism, cabbala, occultism, theosophy, anthroposophy and philosophy are only single fragments of spiritual science.

Spiritual science, just as any other science, is based on facts. The main difference to natural sciences consists in becoming conscious of the facts by means of sense organs, which are different from physical organs. However, every man can develop these organs within himself in his normal waking conscious state. These perception organs are called *supersensible* or *spiritual organs* of perception.

The consciousness of modern-day man allows him to develop these organs by himself. In order to develop the spiritual organs of perception according to the modern level of consciousness properly, it is necessary to know the principles of the development of consciousness. The objective of this book is to present the principles of interrelationships of consciousness and spirit and the respective methods of developing supersensible organs of perception.

This paper is based on three theses, which can be considered as the axioms of spiritual science. Just like the science of geometry is built on the basis of Euclid's axioms, so is it possible to build the science of spirit on the basis of spiritual theses. These can build the basis of the scientific explanation of religion and philosophy and allow transition from the natural sciences to spiritual science.

The eclectic or selective approach of this paper allows the use of citations from representatives of various schools and systems. The citations themselves must not be considered as proof, but serve to illustrate the conclusions derived from the theses of spiritual science. The proofs are only possible for those in whom the spiritual perception organs are already developed. However, for understanding of these topics, logical thinking is sufficient.

Kat Salomon
February 2012

Chapter 1

The freedom of choice

As different as systems of world views are, they all agree in the acceptance of the existence of one source of everything, of what man is or is not capable of becoming conscious of. This source can be given different names, for example: God, Father, Allah, Brahman, etc. They all have the purpose of designating one reality which is all. Such a reality can only be one, and is therefore called the unified or the one and only reality. Yogi Ramacharaka refers to the oneness of all with the following words:

All philosophies which thinkers have considered worthy of respect, find their final expression of Truth in the fundamental thought that there is but One Reality, underlying all the manifold manifestations of shape and form. It is true that the philosophers have differed widely in their conception of that One, but, nevertheless, they have all agreed upon the logical necessity of the fundamental conception that there is, at least, but One Reality, underlying All.

Yogi Ramacharaka. A Series of Lessons in Gnani Yoga.

The fifth lesson. The One and the Many.

The term *absolute Spirit*, or *the Absolute*, will be used throughout to designate the one unified reality which is all. This choice of term enables the first thesis of spiritual science to be expressed as follows.

The first thesis

The absolute Spirit is conscious of itself.

Because the absolute Spirit always exists and is conscious of itself, it is then also always conscious of itself. There can be no state when the absolute Spirit is not conscious of itself, otherwise it would not be all. To have infinite consciousness, or to be infinite, can only be that which is all. Therefore, the consciousness of the absolute Spirit is infinite. The finiteness of the consciousness of the absolute Spirit would mean that there is something outside of its consciousness. But because the absolute Spirit is all, everything that can exist must also be in the consciousness of the absolute Spirit.

The first thesis means that God always has self-consciousness if by the word *God* one understands the one and only reality. The concept of God appears not because man is superstitious, but because he is able to realize all that exists as one. Superstition arises when the word God is understood not as the one and only reality, but that which is not all, is only a part of the one and only reality. It is not difficult to agree that God must be conscious of himself, but in order to understand that God is the one and only reality, a certain stage of consciousness is necessary. Modern man has enough consciousness to distinguish that there is no difference between the absolute God and the one and only reality. In this sense, the concept of the one God has existed in all religions and philosophical systems. This concept of God was described by Jacob Böhme:

That is the true one only God, out of whom thou art created, and in whom thou livest; and when thou beholdest the Deep and the Stars, and the Earth, then thou beholdest thy God, and in that same thou livest, and also art, or hast thy Being therein, and that same God governs or rules thee also, and out of or from that same God also thou hast thy Senses, and thou art a

Creature out of or from him and in him; else thou hadst been nothing, or wouldst never have been.

Now perhaps thou wilt say; I write in a heathenish Manner. Hearken and behold! Observe the distinct Understanding, how all this is so; for I write not heathenishly, or barbarously, but philosophically; neither am I a Heathen, but I have the deep and true Knowledge of one only God, who is ALL.

Jacob Böhme. The Aurora. The Day-Spring or Dawning of the Day in the East.
Chapter XXIII. Of the Deep above the Earth.

Consciousness and existence are inseparable from each other. Because the consciousness of the absolute Spirit is infinite, there can be no beginning and no end of the possibilities of the manifestations in the consciousness of the absolute Spirit. To be manifested, emanated, or to be a being, always means to have finite consciousness and to be in the consciousness of the absolute Spirit. One has to understand finite consciousness in the sense that it does not encompass all in itself. All that is manifested is referred to as the *manifested world structure*, or simply the *world structure*.

The concept of *consciousness* is impossible to define because it is impossible to define the infinite consciousness of the absolute Spirit in which there is everything, including all concepts. The absolute Spirit has the absolute choice of freedom because nothing exists that could make its choice not be free. Since the absolute Spirit in itself can be conscious only of itself, it has the highest self-consciousness or the highest 'I'-consciousness. Because the absolute Spirit is all, he has the highest knowledge which is called the all knowledge. This leads to the following interesting question:

Could something exist that is unknown to the absolute Spirit which is all and which is always self-conscious?

That something not only can exist, but also always exists. It is the not knowing about the free choice of a being in advance. If the absolute Spirit is conscious in itself of a being with the freedom of choice, then the absolute Spirit can never know which free choice will be made by such a being through the absolute Spirit in advance. If the choice was known in advance, it would not be free. The free choice of a being already means that it is not known if it has not been determined yet. The absolute Spirit is always conscious of all possibilities of free choice, for it is all, and is always conscious of itself. The free choice of a being becomes known to the absolute Spirit only when it is determined by the being itself. The being with freedom of choice will be referred to as a *free being* or a *personality* further on.

What the Absolute can or cannot know has been discussed in many philosophical schools. One of these schools is the eclectic school of yoga. This school has carried out the great task of analysing, summarising, and selecting the best system from the different philosophical concepts of India that have been formed over the course of centuries. The eclectic nature of this system is best of all described with the words of Yogi Ramacharaka:

Our own system is Eclectic in its nature, and has points of agreement with, and points of difference from, each of the other principle systems of the Hindu Philosophy, and besides, advances many independent conceptions and interpretations not found in the said systems, and which are part of the great body of Eclectic Philosophical Thought in India which has refused to identify itself with any of schools or systems.

Yogi Ramacharaka. The inner teachings of the philosophies and religions of India.
The fourth lesson. The Vedanta system.

In order to compare the conclusions of the eclectic yoga school and those which follow from the theses of spiritual science, consider the following reasoning of Yogi Ramacharaka about what can be known and unknown to the Absolute:

The Intellect informs us that it is compelled to think of the Absolute as containing within Itself all possible Knowledge or Wisdom, because there can be no Knowledge or Wisdom outside of It, and therefore all the Wisdom and Knowledge possible must be within It. We see Mind, Wisdom, and Knowledge manifested by relative forms of Life, and such must emanate from the Absolute in accordance with certain laws laid down by It, for otherwise there would be no such wisdom, etc., for there is nowhere outside of the All from whence it could come. The effect cannot be greater than the cause. If there is anything unknown to the Absolute, then it will never be known to finite minds. So, therefore, ALL KNOWLEDGE that Is, Has Been, or Can Be, must be NOW vested in the One – the Absolute.

Yogi Ramacharaka. A Series of Lessons in Gnani Yoga.
The first lesson. The One.

These words of Yogi Ramacharaka were written at the beginning of the twentieth century. They are not only an expression of a representative of the eclectic school, but also an expression of the consciousness of man of the twentieth century. The consciousness of modern man has changed so much that it becomes possible to extend this thought in the following way.

Not only all knowledge must be in the Absolute, but also all that could be unknown to the Absolute must also be in the Absolute. If there is something unknown to the Absolute, then the Absolute must always be conscious that it does not know something. This unknown is the free choice of man as a free being, as a personality.

And thus, all knowledge now belongs to the Absolute, so all possibilities of free choice which personality could choose are always known to the Absolute. The free choice which is unknown to the Absolute cannot be known to any being. However, as soon as a personality makes its choice through the Absolute, this choice becomes known to the Absolute at once, because the personality as well as all possibilities of free choice are in the consciousness of the Absolute.

Every being always has a beginning and an end and is always in the consciousness of the absolute Spirit. The absolute Spirit is always infinite and cannot be a finite being. Therefore, the absolute Spirit can never know in advance which choice a personality will make. Because the absolute Spirit is conscious of all that a personality is conscious of, it is also aware of the ignorance of a personality. If there were no personalities, then the absolute Spirit could be conscious only of its own infinite knowledge through beings without freedom of choice, because with unfree beings all is known to the absolute Spirit.

Thus, not-knowledge is always present in the Absolute and becomes knowledge only when a personality makes a free choice. It would be a mistake to come to the conclusion that if something unknown to the absolute Spirit can become known through a personality, then the consciousness of the absolute Spirit develops. The concepts of development and change are applicable only to the finite consciousness of a being. Infinite consciousness of the Absolute of all possibilities and consequences of the free choice of personality do not change when free choice is made because they are always known to the Absolute. For this reason, it would be incorrect to state that the consciousness of the Absolute can develop and change. The Absolute knows all through the infinite consciousness, but it does not know all through the finite consciousness of a personality. If the Absolute would not manifest itself in a personality, not-knowledge would never become knowledge and there would be no manifestation of a world structure in which a personality could make free choice.

The concept of *freedom of choice* is inseparable from the concept of *will*. To want or to manifest the will means to make choice through the absolute Spirit. Therefore, freedom of

choice and freedom of will mean the same. Consciousness is always primary in relation to choice because before free choice can be made at all, the personality must be conscious of at least two possibilities. If only one possibility exists for the consciousness of a personality, then the choice would not be free.

Consciousness and Spirit are inseparable therefore the consciousness of a personality is always permeated by the absolute Spirit which possesses absolute freedom of will. Consequently, the consciousness of the personality is always permeated by will, which means that if choice exists, then the personality is able to make free choice through the absolute Spirit. Only beings without freedom of choice can carry out the free choice of a personality. If only personalities existed, then all choices of a personality would have to be fulfilled by other personalities. That means other personalities would not have the freedom of choice. Therefore any manifested world structure always must consist of personalities as well as beings that do not have the freedom of choice.

Animals, for example, are beings without freedom of choice. Let's assume that there are two pieces of food in front of an animal, one of which is poisoned, and the consciousness, which is normally called instinct, is also able to distinguish which piece is poisoned. The animal would never take the poisoned piece, and instead would eat the other one. The actions of the animal are predetermined by instinct. Instinct is the consciousness of the whole kind, or the consciousness of the whole type of animal, and will always predetermine the actions of single being of the kind. Instinct operates according to a scheme which can be predicted. The scheme of action of a personality is impossible to predict because each personality has the freedom of choice. If a personality knows which piece of food is poisoned, the choice is still not determined in advance.

In spiritual science, beings whose consciousness is comprised of the consciousness of all animals of a kind are called the animal group souls. Animal instinct is the consciousness of the animal group soul. Animal group souls do not have the freedom of choice, therefore single animals also do not have the freedom of choice. Hence, man cannot be descended from animals. A personality can only be descended from that which has the freedom of choice, that is, from the absolute Spirit. Personality is the image and likeness of the absolute God because his freedom of choice is manifested in the freedom of choice of a personality.

A personality can only be responsible for the results of free choice, and not the absolute Spirit in whose consciousness all possibilities of free choice exist. Free choice is the cause which without fail will always lead to the corresponding result. That is why a personality, by his free choice can only suffer *from* choice, but not *for* choice. To suffer from free choice means to suffer due to the results of the free choice. Suffering for free choice would mean the existence of punishment for free choice. No punishment for free choice can exist because then choice would not be free since it would be determined in advance by the punishment of suffering. This can make it clear why the absolute God allows personalities to commit crimes, to steal, to lie and to cause suffering for each other. Otherwise, the personalities would not have the freedom of choice.

The Sanskrit word *Karma* means 'action', 'deed'. Since without the freedom of choice any action would be determined in advance, Karma always signifies free action, that is, action made through free choice. The relationship between cause and result of free choice of a personality is also called the law of destiny or the law of Karma. In this sense, with Karma it is always necessary to understand the results of actions made through free choice. Without the freedom of choice there could also be no Karma. The law of cause and effect inevitably leads a personality to the next free choice. Following one after another, free choices of a personality defines its destiny, its Karma. It is impossible to predict future free choice. It is only possible to predict the results of a free choice. That is why in all religious documents in which the future is predicted, only the consequences of free choices are mentioned, which have already been made by personalities.

When man suffers, one speaks about his bad Karma. Whether man has bad or good Karma depends only on his free choice. Because animals have no freedom of choice, they create no Karma and should not suffer because their choice is always predetermined by instinct which does not have the freedom of choice. Instinct, for example, always protects the animal against suffering, thus animals can never choose suffering on their own. To understand what could be the cause for the suffering of animals, consider the second thesis of spiritual science.

The second thesis

Man is the only being with freedom of choice in the manifested world structure.

The second thesis of spiritual science gives the unique, unequivocal characteristic to man as a personality and supports an answer to the following question: *What is man?* Man is a being with the freedom of choice. If even one single personality exists, there must be a world structure in which personality can become conscious of free choice and make free choice. Thus in the following section, the term manifested world structure is understood to mean all that it is possible for man to become conscious of through the freedom of choice. This also means that all possibilities of free choice must already exist in the world structure, and the world structure itself must be in the consciousness of the absolute Spirit. The world structure must also have consciousness because everything that the absolute Spirit is conscious of, has consciousness.

If no personalities existed in the manifested world structure, then the world structure would not contain free life if it did not contain the freedom of choice. Free life is the change of consciousness through free choice. The change of consciousness of a personality through free choice also means that something that was previously unknown to the absolute Spirit becomes known. The manifestation of the world structure without personalities would end at once because in such a world structure, all is already known to the absolute Spirit in advance. Therefore, a world structure cannot be manifested without personalities. Personalities also cannot be manifested without a world structure that contains in its consciousness all possibilities of the free choices of the personalities.

The existence of freedom of choice in a personality makes all personalities potentially equal as to the free development of their 'I'-consciousness. This means that all personalities, without exception, must always have the potential to become conscious of themselves as the absolute 'I', as the absolute Spirit. If this was not so, then the absolute Spirit, in order not to injure the free choice of a personality, must always fulfil it through beings without the freedom of choice, and would forever take away the freedom of choice from itself. Since this is impossible, there must be only one type of being with freedom of choice that can become conscious of themselves as the absolute Spirit. The existence of two different types of personalities would mean inequality in the development of the 'I'-consciousness. One type of the personalities would have the possibility of becoming conscious of itself as the absolute Spirit, and the other would not. The freedom of choice of man makes it possible to assume that man must be the only free being in the world structure.

The manifestation of man as a being with the freedom of choice causes the manifestation of all other beings, which do not have the freedom of choice, including animals. The free choice of man affects not only his own consciousness, but also the consciousness of other beings. Beings that have no freedom of choice are always dependent on beings that do have freedom of choice. Therefore, the cause for the suffering of animals can only be due to the free choice of man. This makes man responsible for the suffering not only of animals, but also for the suffering of all beings in the manifested world structure. From here it is possible to understand that the absolute God never punishes someone and that only the free choice of a personality can be the cause of the suffering.

Everything that can exist must possess consciousness because all is in the consciousness of the absolute Spirit, which is always conscious of itself. Man who recognizes the existence of consciousness in himself but denies consciousness in the variety of the outer surroundings would be similar to a man who accepts the existence of the air in his lungs but denies the existence of the air outside of his physical body. The concept of a *being* is identical to the concept of *consciousness* in the sense that there is no being without consciousness and there is no consciousness without a being that manifests this consciousness. Therefore, that which can be developed, chosen, or changed in the manifested world structure is consciousness because all that is manifested, is manifested as beings with different stages of consciousness. Since everything has consciousness and the manifested world structure always consists of personalities and beings without freedom of choice, then all possibilities of choice by a personality can only be manifested through beings without freedom of choice.

To illustrate this point we present the opinion of the representative of occult philosophy H. P. Blavatsky on the existence of consciousness in everything in the universe:

Everything in the Universe, throughout all its kingdoms, is conscious: i.e., endowed with consciousness of its own kind and on its own plane of perception. We men must remember that, simply because we do not perceive any signs of consciousness which we can recognize, say, in stones, we have no right to say that no consciousness exists there. There is no such thing as either "dead" or "blind" matter, as there is no "blind" or "unconscious" Law.

H. P. Blavatsky. The Secret Doctrine. Volume 1.
The Stanzas of Dzyan. Summing up.

The manifestation or emanation of all beings occurs whilst the absolute Spirit becomes conscious of beings which have the freedom of choice. The concept of a *being* cannot be applied to the absolute Spirit because it assumes the finiteness or limitation of consciousness. The consciousness of the absolute Spirit is infinite, therefore the absolute Spirit is not a being; instead all beings are always in the consciousness of the absolute Spirit.

The word *self-consciousness* assumes the duality of consciousness – the possibility of becoming conscious of itself within itself. Whatever the absolute Spirit becomes conscious of within itself, also possesses consciousness and becomes a relative consciousness. This duality also means the existence of two opposites. The consequence of the duality of consciousness is the existence in the manifested world structure of beings with the freedom of choice and also of beings, which do not have the freedom of choice.

If man has the freedom of choice, then beings must also exist, which do not have the freedom of choice. The existence of beings with different levels of consciousness means that hierarchies of beings or hierarchies of consciousness exist. The hierarchy of beings without the freedom of choice cannot lie, or deny what exists because it would signify the existence of the freedom of choice in them. They can only be that which they are conscious of. In this sense, the consciousness of beings without freedom of choice is always true. Man recognises truth, if he recognises what the hierarchies of consciousness without the freedom of choice are conscious of. Since the consciousness of any being is finite, the hierarchies of consciousness can only reflect relative truth. Man can only become aware of truth gradually, by achieving the different levels of the hierarchies of consciousness. To know absolute truth would mean to know what the absolute Spirit is conscious of, or to achieve consciousness of the absolute Spirit, or to become conscious of one's self as the absolute Spirit.

The existence of the hierarchies of consciousness offers an answer to the following question: *Which came first, the chicken or the egg?* Neither one nor the other. The egg and the chicken are different manifestation forms of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. Everything that is manifested, is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness. Physical laws are also the relationships between the hierarchies of consciousness without the freedom of choice. Natural science is only possible because hierarchies of beings without

freedom of choice exist, and the relationships between them can be predicted. Natural sciences examine the relationships which are accessible to the waking consciousness or day-consciousness of man. The relationships between the hierarchies of consciousness accessible to the waking consciousness of man are called the *solid*, *liquid*, *gaseous* and *fiery* states. In spiritual science one calls these four states of relationships between the hierarchies of consciousness: Earth, Air, Water and Fire.

If man has developed the spiritual or supersensible organs of perception, then his day-consciousness can include the sleep consciousness with dreams, the dreamless sleep consciousness and the deep dreamless sleep consciousness. The waking consciousness that encloses the dream consciousness is called the *imaginative* consciousness. One calls the waking consciousness that encloses the dreamless sleep consciousness the *inspirative* consciousness. The waking consciousness which encloses the deep dreamless sleep consciousness is called the *intuitive* consciousness. The imaginative consciousness perceives consciousness of the hierarchies in animals. The inspirative consciousness perceives consciousness of the hierarchies in plants. The intuitive consciousness perceives consciousness of the hierarchies in minerals. For the supersensible perception, the consciousness of everything is immediate fact.

For the supersensible perception there is no such thing as “unconsciousness”, but only the varying degrees of consciousness. Everything has consciousness.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 13. An Outline of Occult Science.
The Development of the World and Man.

Everything that is manifested as hierarchies of consciousness can only have finite consciousness because only the absolute Spirit has infinite consciousness. Since the world structure is manifested, it must have consciousness and its consciousness must be finite. This leads to the third thesis of spiritual science.

The third thesis

Any manifested world structure is finite.

The finiteness of the world structure means that there is a beginning and an end of the world structure. The manifestation of the world structure begins whilst the absolute Spirit becomes conscious of personalities as beings with freedom of choice. The world structure ends whilst the personalities become conscious of themselves as the absolute Spirit. Since the absolute Spirit is always conscious of itself and its consciousness is infinite, countless previously manifested world structures have already existed. Due to the infinity of consciousness of the absolute Spirit, there cannot be a first or last world structure. Therefore, there are always countless possible manifestations of world structures, in which the personalities have not yet become conscious of themselves as the absolute Spirit. Consequently, the past, present and future are always connected with the freedom of choice of a personality. Without the freedom of choice of a personality there would be no past, present or future because everything would be known to the absolute Spirit in advance.

The third thesis can be also formulated differently:

The number of personalities in any manifested world structure is finite.

Suppose that the manifested world structure is finite, and the number of personalities in it would be infinite. Then personalities with different levels of consciousness would always exist which have not yet made a possible choice, and thus have not become conscious of themselves as the absolute Spirit. Such a world structure would never end, which contradicts

the supposition of finiteness of the world structure. Therefore, the number of personalities as beings with the freedom of choice must always be finite in any manifested world structure.

And vice versa, if we suppose that the number of personalities is always finite in the manifested world structure, then the world structure must be finite also. The infinite world structure would consist of countless possibilities of free choice for personalities. The free choice of the personalities in the infinite world structure would never end and the personalities could never become conscious of themselves as the absolute Spirit. In turn, the absolute Spirit, having manifested the freedom of choice in the personalities, would have deprived itself of the freedom of choice forever. Consequently, the absolute Spirit is conscious of the manifested world structure as a being whose consciousness is formed of the finite number of all possibilities which the personalities can choose to become conscious of themselves as the absolute Spirit. Since the world structure and personalities cannot be manifested without each other, then both variations of the third thesis are equivalent.

H. P. Blavatsky also refers to this numerical or mathematical aspect:

There must be a limited number of Monads, evolving and growing more and more perfect, through their assimilation of many successive Personalities, in every new Manvantara. This is absolutely necessary in view of the doctrines of Rebirth and Karma, and of the gradual return of the human Monad to its source – Absolute Deity. Thus, although the hosts of more or less progressed Monads are almost incalculable, they are still finite, as is everything in this Universe of differentiation and finiteness.

H. P. Blavatsky. The Secret Doctrine. Volume 1.
Additional facts and explanations concerning the Globes and the Monads.

Manvantara is a state of consciousness in which personalities can create and change their Karma through their free choice. In the state of consciousness which one calls *Pralaya*, personalities cannot change Karma created in the *Manvantara* state. They can make free choices that prepare the manifestations of such conditions in the *Manvantara* state in which the changing of Karma is possible. In this sense *Manvantara* is the state of activity, and *Pralaya* is the state of rest or the state of dissolution of activity. In the *Manvantara* state, personalities develop their consciousness through free choice. Thus, every personality has its own personal experience, and not all personalities can use others' experiences. In the *Pralaya* state all personalities have the opportunity to experience others' experiences. How far each personality will use the experience of other personalities depends on its free choice.

The word *Monad* translated from the Greek means 'unity' or the 'one' and indicates indivisibility in the sense that it is impossible to separate something from the whole and not destroy the unity. The word *individuality*, translated from the Latin, means 'indivisibility' and in this sense means the same as the concept of *Monad*. The concept of individuality and *Monad* will be understood hereafter in the sense of a whole, from which it is impossible to separate something and not destroy its unity.

Man is conscious of himself as a separate being, as the 'I'. This means he has self-consciousness, 'I am' consciousness, or 'I'-consciousness. The highest 'I'-consciousness has the absolute Spirit who is indivisible because it is impossible to separate something from it, and it is the absolute individuality. Therefore, the true 'I', or man's true Self can only be the absolute individuality, which is the absolute Spirit or the Absolute. Yogi Ramacharaka also refers to this:

The real Self is not the body or even the mind of man. These things are but a part of his personality, the lesser self. The real Self is the Ego, whose manifestation is in individuality.

Yogi Ramacharaka. The Hindu-Yogi Science of Breath.
Chapter XVI. Yogi spiritual breathing. Soul consciousness.

The highest 'I' of man is manifested in the world structure as his individuality. One can also define the individuality of man as the highest 'I'-consciousness which man can have in the manifested world structure. In order for all personalities to be equally free, their individualities must be potentially equal. This is possible if every individuality contains in itself all possibilities of free choice of a personality. All possibilities of the free choice of a personality do not change in the manifested world structure, and in this sense, the individuality also does not change in the manifested world structure. How far man is conscious of himself as an individuality makes up his personality.

All together, man is individuality, personality and the relationship between the hierarchies of consciousness that are manifested as the result of free choice. According to ancient knowledge, man consists of spirit, body and soul. Individuality corresponds to the spirit. Personality corresponds to soul. Body corresponds to Karma, or the relationship between the hierarchies of consciousness that are manifested as the result of free choice. Rudolf Steiner holds that the Catholic Church officially distanced itself from this ancient knowledge not so very long ago:

The science of spirit, for example, had already become inconvenient for the Catholic Church in 9th century; I have often mentioned this. That's why the spirit was abolished during the eighth general Ecumenical Council of Constantinople in 869. At that time the dogma was set up, that man, if he is a proper Christian, may not think that he consists of body, soul and spirit, but only of body and soul, and that soul has spiritual qualities. Today this is still taught in psychology, because it is believed to be unbiased science, however, it is only repeating the dogma of 869.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 194. The Mission of the Archangel Michael.
Lecture on 12th December 1919.

Personality is determined by the consciousness of man and changes during its development due to free choice. The individuality of man is his highest manifested 'I' which is indivisible and is the principle of personality. Personality cannot be separated from individuality, just as individuality cannot be separated from mankind. The consciousness that the absolute Spirit is conscious of within itself as the consciousness of all personalities is understood to be the consciousness of mankind. Mankind is not just all personalities together, but is also a being whose consciousness encompasses the consciousness of every personality within itself. Before single personalities can be manifested, mankind, as a being with the freedom of choice of all personalities must be manifested. When consciousness of every personality attains consciousness of its individuality, the end of the world structure is reached and all personalities will become conscious of themselves as the absolute, unified individuality, as the absolute 'I', as the absolute Spirit. This is the return of individuality or Monad of man to his source, to the absolute Deity.

The concepts of *consciousness* and *freedom of choice* are fundamental for the understanding of the possibility of the beginning and end of the manifested world structure. The world structure begins with the free choice of the absolute Spirit to manifest personalities within itself, as beings with the freedom of choice. The world structure exists as long as at least one personality exists which is not conscious of itself as an individuality in the manifested world structure. The world structure comes to an end through the free choice of every personality to become conscious of itself as the absolute individuality, which is the absolute Spirit. This is only possible when every man is already conscious of himself as an individuality in the manifested world structure. If even one personality is not yet conscious of itself as an individuality, that also means that no other personality has reached such a high consciousness due to the potential equality of the individualities. Therefore, a personality can become conscious of itself as the absolute Spirit only together with all other personalities. This means that no man can unite himself with the Absolute, that is, to become conscious of

himself as the absolute Spirit, as long as not every other man is able to unite with the Absolute yet.

The number of personalities in any manifested world structure must be finite. This number however must also be different in the different world structures. If the number of the personalities were the same in the preceding and next world structure, then they would be the same personalities due to their potential equality. In this case, both world structures would be completely identical. Choice would not be free because it would already be known from the preceding world structure. Therefore, such a proceeding world structure cannot be manifested.

Personalities, as various beings, must have different consciousnesses. Personalities can have the same level of consciousness, but their consciousnesses must be different. This means that personalities with higher and lower levels of consciousness always exist in the manifested world structure. Therefore, one personality must also exist which has the most consciousness of itself as an individuality, and has the highest self-consciousness in our manifested world structure. This is the personality that is called Jesus Christ in the New Testament. The name of Jesus corresponds to the consciousness of personality and Christ corresponds to consciousness of individuality as the highest 'I'-consciousness in our manifested world structure.

The theses of spiritual science form the basis for the answer to the final question.

The final question

Why has the Infinite manifested and emanated Finite forms of being?

Yogi Ramacharaka. A Series of Lessons in Gnani Yoga.
The fifth lesson. The One and the Many.

All that can be manifested through free choice of personality already had to exist in the consciousness of the absolute Spirit. Therefore, all possibilities and the consequences of any free choice of any personality are always known to the absolute Spirit. In this sense, free choice of a personality cannot change something in the consciousness of the absolute Spirit and in this sense nothing can be attained by it. Therefore, Yogi Ramacharaka formulates the final question in the following way:

"Why did God create the Universe, since He is not bound by Necessity or Desire; since nothing can be accomplished by it; since there is nothing that can be that has not always been – be the universe illusion or reality; why was it created?" So it always has been – so it is now, perhaps, will be always, for none but God himself – the Absolute – can answer this question from full knowledge, for such full Knowledge is God Himself, or the Brahman, or Absolute Intelligence. This is indeed the Riddle of the Sphinx.

Yogi Ramacharaka. The inner teachings of The philosophies and religions Of India.
The fourth lesson. The Vedanta system.

The question "Why" can only be applied to something finite, because only something that is finite has a cause of the beginning and end of its manifestation. If, however, this question is applied to the absolute Spirit or to the Infinite, which always exists and has no beginning or end, the true cause of the manifestation of finite forms of being must always exist and always be infinite. One also calls the infinite cause of manifestation the *uncaused cause*. To acknowledge the existence of the infinite cause through finite consciousness, the infinite cause has to be manifested in finite consciousness. If the infinite cause was not manifested in man, it would be impossible to become conscious of it.

Let us look at whether it is possible to find this infinite cause in man. Firstly, freedom of choice is infinite, because the absolute Spirit is infinitely free as to how and what to be conscious of within itself. Secondly, every personality has the freedom of choice as to how

and what to become conscious of through the absolute Spirit. Because the freedom of choice of the absolute Spirit is manifested in the free choice of every personality, man can become conscious of the answer to the final question within himself. If another cause of manifestation existed besides the freedom of choice, then that would impose restrictions on the freedom of choice of the absolute Spirit.

All possibilities of manifestation of all world structures always exist in the consciousness of the absolute Spirit. Which world structure will be manifested is determined through the free choice of the absolute Spirit to become conscious within itself of the manifestation of a finite number of personalities. Personalities develop their consciousness by making free choices through the absolute Spirit. When all personalities together become conscious of themselves as the absolute Spirit, then the full answer to the final question will become known to each personality. This is possible because the freedom of choice of the absolute Spirit is manifested in the freedom of choice of a personality. Therefore, there can be no absolute limits for the development of consciousness of a personality, nor can absolute limits on knowledge exist.

Yogi Ramacharaka connects the answer to the final question with the concept of the *divine plan*:

But, remember this – that while the Higher Yogi Teachings contain no "guess," or speculative theory, regarding the "Why" of the Divine Manifestation, still they do not deny the existence of a "Why". In fact, they expressly hold that the Absolute Manifestation of the Many is in pursuance of some wondrous Divine Plan, and that the Unfoldment of the Plan proceeds along well-established and orderly lines, and according to Law. They trust in the Wisdom and Love of the Absolute Being, and manifest a perfect Confidence, Trust and Peaceful Patience in the Ultimate Justice, and Final Victory of the Divine Plan. No doubt disturbs this idea – it pays no attention to the apparent contradictions in the finite phenomenal world, but sees that all things are proceeding toward some far-away goal, and that "All is Well with the Universe".

Yogi Ramacharaka. A Series of Lessons in Gnani Yoga.
The fifth lesson. The One and the Many.

If the divine plan exists, it must be perfect because the absolute Spirit is perfect. That also includes the perfect fulfilment of the plan. If the divine plan needed to be fulfilled by beings without freedom of choice, instead of by personalities, then this would contradict the freedom of choice of the personalities. Hence, the divine plan can only be fulfilled by personalities. But how are finite personalities which have the freedom of choice and are capable of making mistakes able to fulfil a divine plan? Is it possible? If it is possible, then the divine plan must encompass not only everything that is perfect, but also everything that is imperfect. And then everything that is imperfect must be also perfect because the absolute Spirit is perfect. This is possible if a divine plan encompasses all possibilities of the free choice of a personality in the manifested world structure. Then the divine plan also encompasses the possibility of the free choice of a personality to become conscious of itself as the absolute Spirit. If this were not so, it would mean that personalities would not have been free beings. Therefore, for the divine plan to be able to be fulfilled at all, the freedom of choice of a personality must exist. The existence of the freedom of choice of a personality allows another question to be asked for which there can be no answer in the manifested world structure:

What is the number of the personalities in the manifested world structure?

The number of personalities in the manifested world structure is always finite. This number is known only to the infinite consciousness of the absolute Spirit who is conscious within itself of every personality, as a being with the freedom of choice. To find out the number of all the personalities and not violate their freedom of choice, one must have consciousness

which encloses all individualities. Consciousness of all individualities can only be attained by all personalities together. If all personalities already had consciousness that they can become conscious of themselves as individualities, then all possibilities of choice and their consequences would already be known to them in advance, and then the choice of the personalities would not be free. Hence, freedom of choice of a personality means that no personality can know the finite number of all personalities in the manifested world structure. The answer will become known to all personalities only when every personality reaches the highest consciousness with which it becomes conscious of itself as an individuality. Only then can each personality as an individuality become conscious of itself as the absolute Spirit and all other personalities as individualities, and hence know the number of the personalities in the manifested world structure.

The finite number of personalities is the numerical characteristic of the world structure. It gives rise to the concept of the centre of the manifested world structure. Because everything has consciousness, the centre of the manifested world structure will be that level of consciousness in which it is possible to know the finite number of the personalities in the manifested world structure. On this level of consciousness, every personality is conscious of itself as an individuality, and all personalities together can become conscious of themselves as the absolute individuality. This number builds the basis of all relationships between the hierarchies of consciousness, regardless of whether or not it is possible to express this as a number. Without a finite number of personalities in the world structure there could not be any manifestation of the world structure. Without a manifested world structure there could not be any science. Therefore, knowledge of the existence of the finite number of personalities in the manifested world structure has been laid in the basis of spiritual science.

Personal message

All the aforementioned applies directly to you. You are manifested as a personality in the consciousness of the absolute Spirit. Whatever you experience is also experienced by the absolute Spirit. In your freedom of choice, the freedom of choice of the absolute Spirit is manifested. Your true 'I' is the absolute Spirit. Without you no world structure can be manifested. You always exist, and you have already been manifested as various personalities in countless manifested world structures previously. Now, the development of consciousness of all beings in the manifested world structure depends on your free choice. You have the freedom of choice and hence you are the highest part of the manifested world structure. Therefore, you bear the responsibility for your free choice that is expressed in your destiny, in your Karma.

Main conclusions

The one and only reality is the absolute Spirit, which is all and which is always conscious of itself. Consciousness and existence are inseparable from each other. Man is the only being with the freedom of choice in the manifested world structure. Any manifested world structure is finite. To be manifested, or to be a being, means to be in the consciousness of the absolute Spirit and to have finite consciousness. Finite consciousness does not encompass everything in itself. A personality is a being that has the freedom of choice. The number of personalities in any manifested world structure is finite. The world structure is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness. Consciousness of the beings of the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice is always true. The development of consciousness in the world structure occurs through the free choice of personalities. Karma means free action. All together, man is individuality, personality and the relationship between the hierarchies of consciousness, manifested as the result of free choice. Man consists of spirit, body and soul.

Individuality corresponds to spirit, personality corresponds to soul. Body corresponds to Karma or the relationship between the hierarchies of consciousness, manifested through free choice. Personalities make free choices through the absolute Spirit. Personalities become conscious of themselves as the absolute individuality all together. Jesus Christ has the highest consciousness as an individuality in our manifested world structure. The finite number of personalities is the numerical characteristic of the world structure. The centre of the manifested world structure is that level of consciousness in which it is possible to know the finite number of personalities.

Chapter 2

The Involution

The freedom of choice of the absolute Spirit to manifest finite number of personalities in itself was referred to as an infinite cause of emanation of the world structure. Because there is nothing unconscious, this free choice manifests first being, whose consciousness is divine plan, or idea of the development of the world structure. The word *idea* is used for description of being with finite consciousness which contains all possibilities of manifestation. The separated personalities are not manifested yet and exist as principles of personalities, as individualities. Consciousness of this manifested being is consciousness of all individualities. Consciousness of all individualities that contains all possibilities of free choice of all personalities is consciousness of mankind. To fulfil divine plan, mankind has the freedom of choice of all personalities.

The fulfilment of divine plan occurs in states of involution and evolution. The concept of *involution* signifies envelopment, folding inwards, and *evolution* signifies unfolding. Because everything has consciousness, involution signifies envelopment of consciousness, and evolution signifies unfolding of consciousness. Envelopment and unfolding of consciousness are connected with the freedom of choice. The free choice of the absolute Spirit to become conscious in itself of manifestation of personalities, leads to manifestation of the world structure. Manifestation of consciousness of separated personalities corresponds to involution, because infinite consciousness of the absolute Spirit is folding into finite consciousness of personalities through free choice of mankind. Free choice of separated personalities in the world structure corresponds to evolution because finite consciousness of personalities is unfolding into infinite consciousness of the absolute Spirit. Involution and evolution of consciousness are inseparable from the freedom of choice.

So that all personalities are to be manifested equally free, they must themselves determine which consciousness every separately manifested personality will have in order to make its first free choice. This can do only all personalities together, as whole mankind, as one being. If mankind not by itself choose with what consciousness every separated personality will start to make its free choice, then the choice of all personalities, as of whole mankind would be not free and predetermined by the absolute Spirit from the beginning. Then the first choice of every separately manifested personality would be not free also, what would contradict to the freedom of choice of personality. Therefore, the free choice of the absolute Spirit to become conscious in itself of manifestation of finite number of personalities manifests mankind, as one being with the freedom of choice of all personalities. This free choice of the absolute Spirit is called *great sacrifice* because now only mankind can make free choice through the absolute Spirit.

The trinity

All conceptions which deserve of attention and which make an attempt to explain manifestation of the world structure refer to necessity of trinity. Therefore, all such conceptions can be characterized by one general statement, expressing the main idea of the emanation of the world structure:

One manifests Two; Two manifest Three; Three manifest the world structure.

In spite of fact that different names were given to elements of this trinity in various conceptions, all these conceptions refer to three elements which form basis of manifestation

of the world structure. The examples of naming by different systems of elements of trinity can be found in the following table:

<i>Secret Doctrine</i>	<i>Theosophy</i>	<i>Hinduism</i>	<i>Vedanta</i>	<i>Christianity</i>
One	1-st Logos	Brahma	Sat	Father
Two	2-nd Logos	Vishnu	Ananda	Sohn
Three	3-rd Logos	Shiva	Chit	Holy Spirit

For example, in *Stanzas of Dzyan*, which were put by H. P. Blavatsky in the basis of explanation of *Secret Doctrine*, it is possible to find the following description:

When the One becomes Two, the Three-fold appears. The Three are One.

H. P. Blavatsky. The Secret Doctrine. Volume 1.
The Stanzas of Dzyan. Commentaries. Stanza VII. – Continued.

The emanation of the world structure from and in the absolute Spirit is possible because an object which the absolute Spirit is conscious of in itself has consciousness and becomes subject of consciousness. Herein it is included possibility that manifested One becomes Two. However, One must be manifested first before Two can be manifested. Manifested One is not the absolute Spirit because the absolute Spirit is infinite, and something manifested can be only a being with finite consciousness. Manifested One can contain only one manifested world structure and only finite number of personalities in its finite consciousness. Infinite consciousness of the absolute Spirit contains all countless possibilities of manifestation of the world structures and personalities.

Manifestation of One, as being with finite consciousness, begins with free choice of the absolute Spirit to become conscious in itself of finite number of personalities. The result of such consciousness is manifestation which itself has consciousness and which is called *Father* in *Christianity*. This is manifested One. Theosophy prefers name of *1-st Logos*. *Hinduism* uses name of *Brahma*. *Vedanta* system uses name of *Sat*. All these names, however, denote the same.

Further on, the names which are accepted in Christianity will be used for denotations of elements of trinity: *Father*, *Son* and *Holy Spirit*. It has to do with fact that Christianity will play more and more important role for the development of consciousness of personality through free choice in the future. Therefore, the idea of manifestation of the world structure can be expressed in the following way:

The absolute Spirit manifests Father; Father manifests Son; Father and Son manifest Holy Spirit; Father, Son and Holy Spirit manifest the world structure.

To manifest something it is possible only through the free choice. In order to make free choice, it is necessary to have the freedom of choice. Therefore, the freedom of choice must exist in all three elements of the trinity, so that the world structure could be manifested, in which finite number of personalities have freedom of choice. Because mankind is always first manifested being with freedom of choice of all personalities, it is possible to make the following statement:

Free mankind, which is conscious of itself as One, is Father.

Mankind has divine plan of the development of all possibilities of consciousness of personalities in itself. Which number of personalities must be manifested is predetermined through free choice of the absolute Spirit in advance. All possibilities of any choice of

personalities are also predetermined through individualities in advance. However, which relations of consciousness will be manifested between personalities, which consciousness will have every separately manifested personality, all personalities must determine together, as one whole mankind.

Manifestation of separated personalities can occur only together with manifestation of hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. So that equally free personalities and hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice, as all possibilities of free choice of personalities, have to be manifested, it is necessary that whole mankind is conscious of duality in itself. One element of duality must correspond to all personalities with freedom of choice, and another element of duality must correspond to all hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. Possibility for mankind to become conscious in itself of duality exists, as consequence of self-consciousness. Mankind cannot be not conscious of duality in itself because it has self-consciousness, mankind, however, has freedom to choose how to be conscious of duality in itself. To become conscious in itself of duality it is necessary for manifestation of the world structure. However, mankind makes its free choice to determine which relations will be manifested between elements of duality.

The free choice of mankind as One allows to become conscious of such possibilities of manifestation of all relations between two elements of duality which are most suitable for manifestation of separated free personalities. Such free choice is made from knowledge of all possibilities of free choice of all personalities. The free choice of mankind as One, allows mankind to become conscious of itself as Two. Personalities and hierarchies of consciousness exist in consciousness of mankind as two original principles. The Sanskrit names of these principles are *Purusha* and *Prakriti*. This corresponds to statement that Father manifests Son, or that One manifests Two. Hence, the following statement:

Free mankind, which is conscious of itself as Two, is Son, or Word.

The concepts of *Purusha* and *Prakriti* are used in philosophical system of *Sankhya*. *Purusha* corresponds to the principle with freedom of choice and *Prakriti* corresponds to the principle without freedom of choice. *Purusha* and *Prakriti* do not exist separated from each other. As *Purusha* is in *Prakriti*, it is *Prakriti* in *Purusha* also. *Purusha* and *Prakriti* exist together, in each other and beside each other. Mankind becomes conscious in itself of relations between both principles and through them becomes conscious of itself.

To become conscious in itself of duality it is not enough for manifestation of plenty of beings in the world structure yet. For this purpose it is necessary that mankind becomes conscious of trinity in itself. The possibility to become conscious of the trinity in itself exists because mankind does not lose consciousness of itself as One. Mankind is conscious of itself as One and as Two together. To be conscious of itself as One and as Two together means to become conscious of itself as Three. Mankind makes free choice of which relations of consciousness will be manifested between the elements of trinity.

The Sanskrit names of the elements of trinity, as three principles are *Sattva*, *Rajas* and *Tamas*. Every principle is also called *Guna*. *Sattva*, *Rajas* and *Tamas* do not exist apart of each other. All three *Gunas* exist together, in each other and beside each other. Mankind is conscious in itself of three *Gunas* and through them is consous of itself. This corresponds to statement, that Father and Son manifest Holy Spirit or that Two manifest Three. Therefore, one can do one more statement:

Free mankind, which is conscious of itself as Three, is Holy Spirit.

Involution of consciousnesses of mankind occurs through free choice of mankind as one being, consisting of all individualities. All individualities are potentially equal and contain all

possibilities of free choice of all personalities. Involution of consciousness consists of that, that mankind becomes conscious in itself of principles or ideas that can be manifested in evolution beside each other and in each other. The purpose is manifestation of separated personalities with freedom of choice and of hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. Eclectic school of yoga also refers to this involution of principles. Yogi Ramacharaka, for example, describes trinity of consciousness of mankind, as manifestation by the Absolute of three finite universal principles of: *mind, energy and matter*.

At the dawn of a Brahmik Day, the Absolute begins the creation of a new Universe. The Teachings inform us that in the beginning, the Absolute forms a Mental Image, or Thought-Form of an Universal Mind Principle, or Universal Mind-Stuff, as some of the teachers express it. Then this Universal Mind Principle creates within itself the Universal Energy Principle. Then this Universal Energy Principle creates within itself the Universal Matter Principle. Thus, Energy is a product of Mind; and Matter a product of Energy.

Yogi Ramacharaka. A Series of Lessons in Gnani Yoga.
The seventh lesson. Cosmic Evolution.

This description of creation of a new universe or world structure corresponds to already mentioned description of involution of consciousness of mankind. The main difference is that Yogi Ramacharaka does not point out to the freedom of choice as main principle, which forms the basis for the creation of new world structure by the Absolute. Without freedom of choice the creation of new world structure by the Absolute would be automatic process for whole mankind. This would contradict to the freedom of choice of personalities.

Sanskrit name of principle of mind is *Chitta*, of energy is *Prana*, of matter is *Akasha*. Because there exists nothing unconscious, the manifested Chitta, Prana, Akasha must have consciousness also. Free mankind, as Father, corresponds to Sanskrit name *Ishvara*. The state of consciousness of mankind, as Father, is also Chitta, or *principle of consciousness*. The state of consciousness of mankind, as Son or Word, is also Prana or *principle of life*. The state of consciousness of mankind, as Holy Spirit, is also Akasha or the *principle of form*. Thus, involution of consciousness of mankind is process of folding inwards of infinite consciousness of the absolute Spirit into finite principles of *consciousness, life and form*.

Father	One - Ishvara	Principle of consciousness - Chitta
Son in Father	Two - Purusha and Prakriti	Principle of life - Prana
Holy Spirit in Son and Father	Three - Tamas, Rajas, Sattva	Principle of form - Akasha

Mankind becomes conscious of itself as One, Two and Three together. The state of consciousness as One is attained together with state of consciousness as Two and together with state of consciousness as Three. Therefore all states of consciousness exist always together, in each other and beside each other. This means Three are One. Ancient scriptures can express it in various ways. For example, in *Sandilya Upanishad* it is possible to find the following description:

The Supreme Brahman, the Truth, is the imperishable and the actionless. Then from the formless Brahman, three forms (or aspects) arose, (viz.) Nishkala (partless), Sakala (with parts) and Sakala-Nishkala (with and without parts).

Sandilya Upanishad. Chapter III.

The manifestation form of Brahman without parts corresponds to that, that mankind becomes conscious of itself as One. Consciousness in which mankind is conscious of itself as Two is the manifestation form of Brahman with parts. The manifestation form of Brahman

with and without parts corresponds to consciousness, in which mankind is conscious of itself as Two and as One together and is consciousness, in which mankind is conscious of itself as Three. In such a way Three are One.

There are no contradictions between spiritual science and ancient scriptures. Ancient writings, however, do not refer to the freedom of choice directly. The reason for it is that waking consciousness of man was developed so far yet, that it was possible to speak about freedom of choice directly. Therefore ancient scriptures mention the freedom of choice indirectly. Consciousness of man, however, has changed. Responsibility of personality for its free choice changes accordingly to its consciousness. To point out to the freedom of choice became necessary because further destiny of mankind on the Earth depends on that, that every single personality will become conscious of consequences of its free choice.

The mutual existence of three states of consciousness of mankind as Tamas, Rajas and Sattva leads to further involution of principles of consciousness, life and form. From any three elements (a, b, c), without consideration of their order, it is possible to form only seven different combinations (a, b, c, ab, bc, ac, abc). Therefore, consciousness by which mankind becomes conscious of three Gunas determines sevenness of consciousness. Mankind becomes conscious of three Gunas in itself and through three Gunas becomes conscious of itself, what creates seven combinations of consciousness. Free choice of mankind determines which relations of consciousness will be manifested between all possible combinations of consciousness of Gunas. The result of free choice of mankind is seven combinations of consciousness of three Gunas, or seven principles. Rudolf Steiner describes them, as *seven creative spirits before the throne of God*:

These are so-called seven creative spirits before the Throne of God, seven next creative forces after three Logos: a, b, c, ab, ac, bc, abc.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 89. Consciousness, Life, Form.
Lecture on 10th November 1904.

Rudolf Steiner describes these seven principles through relations between Father, Son and Holy Spirit also:

First relation - all-mightness: Father reveals himself to Word.

Second relation - all-wisdom: Word reveals itself to Spirit.

Third relation - all-love: Holy Spirit reveals himself to Father.

Fourth relation - all-justice: Father wraps himself in Word and reveals himself to Spirit.

Fifth relation - all-salvation: Word wraps itself in Spirit and reveals itself to Father.

Sixth relation - all-sanctification: Holy Spirit covers himself in Father and reveals himself to the Word.

Seventh relation - all-blissfulness: Father wraps himself in Word and Spirit and becomes revealed to himself.

Such are seven beings which have originated from mutual fertilizing. These are seven Rulers, seven Powers which stand before the Throne [of God] and these are their qualities. Qualities originate from relations of three Logos. Only seven are possible.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 89. Consciousness, Life, Form.
Lecture on 2nd July 1904.

The correspondence between the combinations of Gunas and seven creative spirits before the throne of God is presented in the following table:

<i>Combinations of Gunas</i>	<i>Seven creative spirits</i>
a - Tamas	1. all-mightness
b - Rajas	2. all-wisdom

c - Sattva	3. all-love
ab - Tamas, Rajas	4. all-justice
bc - Rajas, Sattva	5. all-salvation
ac - Tamas, Sattva	6. all-sanctification
abc - Tamas, Rajas, Sattva	7. all-blissfulness

The world structure will be manifested when plenty of hierarchies of consciousness will be manifested. This occurs whilst mankind becomes conscious of plenty of principles in itself. Mankind becomes conscious of itself as One, Two, Three and so on. Further involution of consciousness occurs whilst mankind becomes conscious of sevenness, or of seven creative spirits before the throne of God. Rudolf Steiner also points out to manifestation of next principles which are called *Prajapatis*:

From these seven creative forces originates what we call Prajapatis. Whilst everyone can exactly repeat this fact again on subordinated stages of consciousness, life and form, we thus get everywhere three: three times a, three times b, three times c, three times ab, three times ac, three times bc, three times abc, thus together three times seven = 21 Prajapatis. Every one of them behaves itself as original Logos. Thereby we get 21 creators of certain solar system.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 89. Consciousness, Life, Form.
Lecture on 10th November 1904.

Before seven spirits of God and twenty one Prajapatis can be manifested during evolution, they all must become conscious to mankind as principles during involution. Because single personalities are not manifested yet, involution of consciousness of mankind occurs through free choice of whole mankind, and not through free choice of single personalities. The result of such mutual free choice of mankind, are principles of consciousness, life and form. Mankind becomes conscious of principles in itself which can be manifested as beings with self-consciousness. Beside principles with lower consciousness mankind becomes conscious of principles with higher consciousness in itself. In such a way, involution of consciousness of mankind is involution of principles. Yogi Ramacharaka points to it also.

The true teaching is that the process of Involution was accomplished by a Principle involving itself in the lower Principle created within itself, and so on until the lowest plane was reached. Note the difference – "Principles as Principles" did this, and not as Individual Forms of Life or Being. There was no more a "devolution" in this process than there was in The Absolute involving itself in the Mental Image of the Mind Principle. There was no "devolution" or "going down" – only an "involution" or "wrapping up," of Principle, within Principle – the Individual Life not having as yet appeared, and not being possible of appearance until the Evolutionary process began.

Yogi Ramacharaka. A Series of Lessons in Gnani Yoga.
The sixth lesson. Within the mind of the One.

Consciousness of modern man in physical body allows him to make distinction between space and time. Awareness of space is connected with manifestation of different relations between hierarchies of consciousness beside each other and in each other. Successive repetition of changes of relations between hierarchies of consciousness following one after another, leads to awareness of time. Personalities can become conscious of space and time only together with manifestation of hierarchies of consciousness. In this sense involution of consciousness of mankind is also process of wrapping up of infinite consciousness of the absolute Spirit into space and time. In state of involution personalities and hierarchies of consciousness have no independent existence yet because they are only parts of consciousness of mankind. Therefore, the state of involution of consciousness of mankind is timeless and

spaceless. Time and space will be manifested only in the state of evolution and exist beside each other and in each other. One can find indications to it in *Vishnu Purana*. Vishnu Purana refers to *discreet* and *indiscrete*, as in state before time, as well as in state of time.

Purusha (spirit) is the first form, of the supreme (Brahma); next proceeded two other forms, the discrete and indiscrete; and Kāla (time) was the last.

Vishnu Purana. Book 1. Chapter II.

The purpose of involution of consciousness of mankind is manifestation of single personalities which are able to make their free choice. Evolution of consciousness of personalities begins with manifestation of single personalities. Because involution and evolution of consciousness are inseparable from the freedom of choice, they cannot exist without each other also. The free choice of mankind in state of involution leads to free choice of personalities in state of evolution. The change of two states of consciousness, such as for example, involution and evolution is *rhythm*, or *cycle* of consciousness.

The rhythms

In any rhythm or cycle there are always two alternating states as result of principle of duality. These two states can be considered as two opposites. Because there is nothing unconscious, rhythm can be defined as alternation or change of two states of consciousness. Such events as day and night, in-breathing and out-breathing and so on, are rhythms of consciousness also.

Esoteric philosophy of all times describes life of the world structure, as rhythmic life. Indian philosophy, for example, speaks of inhalation and exhalation of Brahma. Brahma experiences different states of his divine life. These states are compared to in-breathing and out-breathing. Out-breathing of Brahma corresponds to manifestation of the world structure from the absolute Spirit and in-breathing corresponds to state of dissolution of the world structure in the absolute Spirit. Thus alternate the manifested and not manifested world structure, states of activity and rest. Manvantara is state of activity or *Day of Brahma* and Pralaya is *Night of Brahma*, or state of Brahma, resting in himself.

The Yogi Teachings contain much regarding the "Days and Nights of Brahma"; the "In-breathing and Out-breathing of the Creative Principle;" the periods of "Manvantara," and the periods of "Pralaya." This thought runs through all the Oriental thought, although in different forms, and with various interpretations. The thought refers to the occult truth that there is in Cosmic Nature alternate periods of Activity and Inactivity – Days and Nights – In-breathings and Out-breathings – Wakefulness and Sleep. This fundamental law manifests in all Nature, from Universes to Atoms. Let us see it now in its application to Universes.

At this point we would call the attention of the student that in many of the presentations of the Hindu Teachings the writers speak as if the Absolute, Itself, were subject to this law of Rhythm, and had Its Periods of Rest and Work, like Its manifestations. This is incorrect. The highest teachings do not so hold, although at first glance it would so appear. The teaching really is that while the Creative Principle manifests this rhythm, still even this principle, great though it be, is a manifestation of the Absolute, and not the Absolute itself. The highest Hindu teachings are firm and unmistakable about this point.

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Basic or main rhythm of the world structure is determined by two states of consciousness, by the state of consciousness where the absolute Spirit is conscious in itself of personalities, as beings with freedom of choice, and by state of consciousness where all personalities are

conscious of themselves as the absolute Spirit. This corresponds to manifestation of the world structure from the absolute Spirit and to dissolution of the world structure in the absolute Spirit. It is necessary to emphasize again that manifestation of any rhythm is result of free choice. The main rhythm is result of free choice of the absolute Spirit to be conscious of finite number of personalities in itself as well as result of the free choice of all personalities to become conscious of themselves as the absolute Spirit.

The numerical characteristic of this rhythm is finite number of personalities in the manifested world structure. Because manifestation of finite number of separated personalities occurs only after completion of involution of consciousness of mankind, all rhythms that could be manifested in the world structure must become conscious to mankind in state of involution. Because in the world structure must be manifested personalities with the freedom of choice and hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice, all rhythms must be manifested through hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. In state of involution mankind becomes conscious of different rhythms of consciousness, life and form which all separated personalities must experience during involution in order to become conscious of themselves as the absolute Spirit.

The state of involution of consciousness of mankind is timeless and spaceless. Space and time are manifested only in state of evolution. Evolution of consciousness of personalities occurs in space and time. Involution and evolution together form creative activity of the manifested world structure. According to Indian philosophy the creative cycle of activity must be replaced by creative inactivity in which manifested world structure is dissolved in the absolute Spirit. Besides, it is mentioned that states of creative activity - Manvantara and inactivity - Pralaya have same duration.

In state of involution all personalities create no Karma yet, but free choice of mankind prepares conditions for free choice of separated personalities in evolution. Karma can be created by single personalities only in state of evolution. Therefore, state of involution can be compared with state of Pralaya, and state of evolution with state of Manvantara.

It is necessary to point out to certain difficulty which arises already by comparison of duration of involution and evolution. Involution occurs prior to manifestation of time and space. Evolution occurs in time and space. It is possible to compare only by units of time and space. Such units of comparison are rhythms which are manifested only in state of evolution. However in state of involution rhythms are not manifested yet, neither time nor space is manifested, therefore, it is impossible to compare duration of involution and evolution. Nevertheless it is possible to claim that all rhythms which mankind became conscious of in state of involution will become conscious to separated personalities in state of evolution. And in this sense it is possible to claim that involution and evolution have equal duration.

Still bigger difficulty arises by attempt to compare duration of state of the manifested world structure and duration of state in which the world structure is dissolved in the absolute Spirit. Such state is also called Maha-Pralaya in Indian philosophy. Is it possible to compare the state of infinite loneliness and oneness of the absolute Spirit in rhythms of the manifested world structure whose source is the absolute Spirit? Indian philosophy, for example, specifies duration of our world structure in terrestrial years and equates their number to duration of Maha-Pralaya.

The Yogis take up the story where the astronomers drop it, at the Year. Beyond the Year there are other and greater phases of Cyclic Time. The Yogis know many cycles of thousands of years in which there are marked periods of Activity and Inactivity. We cannot go into detail regarding these various cycles, but may mention another division common to the Yogi teachings, beginning with the Great Year. The Great Year is composed of 360 earth years. Twelve thousand Great Years constitute what is known as a Great Cycle, which is seen to consist of 4 320 000 earth years. Seventy-one Great Cycles compose what is called a

Manwantara, at the end of which the earth becomes submerged under the waters, until not a vestige of land is left uncovered. This state lasts for a period equal to 71 Great Cycles. A Kalpa is composed of 14 Manwantaras. The largest and grandest Cycle manifested is known as the Maha-Praylaya, consisting of 36 000 Kalpas when the Absolute withdraws into Itself its entire manifestations, and dwells alone in its awful Infinity and Oneness, this period being succeeded by a period equally long – the two being known as the Days and Nights of Brahm.

Yogi Ramacharaka. A Series of Lessons in Gnani Yoga.

The twelfth lesson. Occult Miscellany.

Similar calculations could be found in other sources also. H. P. Blavatskaya in second volume of *Secret Doctrine* gives the number equal to 311 040 000 000 000 terrestrial years. Although various calculations can differ from each other, their sense remains the same. All calculations express duration of the world structure in finite number of terrestrial years and equate it to state of Maha-Pralaya when no world structure is manifested, when the absolute Spirit dwells in its infinite loneliness and oneness.

If to suppose the absolute Spirit dwells in its infinite loneliness and oneness exactly as much terrestrial years as the world structure can last, then it would mean the absolute Spirit is subjected to some rhythm. The absolute Spirit is source of any rhythm and can not be subjected to rhythm. May the absolute Spirit, who is always conscious in itself of all possibilities of manifestation of all world structures, to be in need of such state whose duration could be measured by finite number of terrestrial days, before next world structure is manifested? If the absolute Spirit is always conscious of all possibilities of manifestation of next world structure, then the state of Maha-Pralaya could pass over into state of involution at once. Even if certain pause existed between the end of preceding world structure and the beginning of next world structure, it would be impossible to measure it by units of the manifested world structure. Therefore, any such calculations can be only characteristics of the manifested world structure. In this sense that number of the terrestrial years is characteristics of number of rhythms which every personality must experience in order to become conscious of itself as the absolute Spirit.

However between the states in which the world structure is manifested and is not manifested, there always exist relations to which it is possible to point out. On the one hand, in not manifested world structure all possible results of free choice are known to the absolute Spirit, but free choice itself cannot be made by single personalities, because they are not manifested yet. On the other hand, in the manifested world structure, all possible results of any free choice are unknown to personalities, but free choice itself can be made. These two sides express relations which can be considered equal for manifested and not manifested world structure. These relations always exist because in infinite consciousness of the absolute Spirit always exist possibilities of manifestation of new world structures.

The world structure comes to an end when every personality becomes conscious of itself as the absolute Spirit. Only then the finite number of personalities can become known to every personality in the manifested world structure. Therefore, no being in the manifested world structure can know what the next world structure will be. There is no possibility to compare the present and next world structures because it is not known what may be manifested in next world structure. It is possible, however, to state, that next manifested world structure never repeats itself because the number of personalities is always different in any world structure. Next world structure cannot contain something that was already recognized by personalities through free choice in uncountable preceding world structures. Otherwise it would be known to the absolute Spirit in advance which choice personalities will make and such choice would not be free. The true 'I' of personality is the absolute Spirit. Therefore, the 'I' of man was always manifested in personalities in preceding world structures and always will be manifested in personalities in following world structures. Knowledge about preceding and next world structure is beyond consciousness of single personality in the manifested world

structure. Here would be suitable to repeat the words of Yogi Ramacharaka explaining how at all knowledge about involution, about beginning of manifestation of the world structure, can become known to man on his modern stage of consciousness:

At the dawn of the Brahmic Day, The Absolute begins the creation of a new Universe, or the recreation of one, just as you may care to state it. The highest Yogi Teachings inform us that the information relating to this event (which is, of course, beyond the personal knowledge of man as we know him) has been passed down to the race from teachers, who have received it from still higher teachers, and so on, and on and on, higher and higher, until it is believed to have originated with some of those wonderfully developed souls which have visited the earth from higher planes of Being, of which there are many. In these lessons we are making no claims of this sort, but pass on the teachings to you, believing that their truth will appeal to those who are ready for them, without any attempt to attribute to them an authority such as just mentioned. Our reference to this high source of the teachings was made because of its general acceptance in the Eastern countries, and by occultists generally.

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The sixth lesson. Within the mind of the One.

Free choice of mankind in state of involution leads to further awareness of mankind of principles of consciousness, life and form. The state of involution is purely internal state where nothing is manifested externally yet, and everything what will be manifested is in consciousness of mankind. Neither principles, nor single personalities have independent existence yet. Principles get independent existence together with the manifestation of single personalities. Manifestation of single personalities signifies beginning of evolution. On transition from involution to evolution mostly lowest state of principles of consciousness, life and form is attained. This lowest state is always higher than any state of evolving single personalities and principles.

The personal message

In state of involution you, together with other individualities, determined what manifested world structure will be like. You were conscious of all principles or ideas which will be manifested as single beings in state of evolution. You were not manifested as single personality yet, you were manifested as principle of personality. You yourself prepared conditions in which you will be manifested as personality. Your choice was free choice of all individualities, free choice of whole mankind.

The main conclusions

Free choice of the absolute Spirit to manifest finite number of personalities leads to manifestation of mankind. Mankind is first manifested being which has the freedom of choice of all personalities. The single personalities are not manifested yet and exist as principles of personalities, as individualities. Free choice of mankind to determine which relations can be manifested between principles of consciousness, life and form corresponds to the process of involution. Involution is envelopment of consciousness. Evolution is development of consciousness. Involution and evolution are inseparable from the freedom of choice. Free mankind which is conscious of itself as One is Father, or principle of consciousness. Free mankind which is conscious of itself as Two is Son, or principle of life. Free mankind, which is conscious of itself as Three is Holy Spirit, or principle of form. Awareness of mankind of all possible relations between elements of trinity is consciousness of all relations between Father, Son and Holy Spirit. Seven possible relations between elements of trinity are seven creative spirits before the throne of God. The trinity of relations between seven creative spirits

before the throne of God are twenty one Prajapatis. Mankind is conscious of all possibilities of choice of personalities as the hierarchies of consciousness, as rhythms or cycles. All rhythms, as changes of states of consciousness, become conscious to mankind in the state of involution. The state of involution is timeless and spaceless. The lowest state of consciousness of not yet manifested principles in involution is higher, than highest state of consciousness of single manifested principles in evolution.

Chapter 3

The Evolution

To the end of involution mankind is conscious of all principles which can be manifested as separated beings in state of evolution. Yogi Ramacharaka calls this state a *pause*.

Down, down, down went the process of Involution, until the lowest point was reached. Then ensued a moment's pause, preceding the beginning of the Evolutionary Unfoldment.

Yogi Ramacharaka. A Series of Lessons in Gnani Yoga.
The ninth lesson. Metempsychosis.

Such a pause does not mean inactivity, but only some intermediate state of consciousness of mankind between involution and evolution. It is necessary in order that all personalities could determine with which consciousness they will be manifested. Personalities have now such consciousness which allows them to be conscious of all possibilities of manifestation of principles of consciousness, life and form. This allows them also momentarily to become conscious of all possible consequences of free choice. Therefore, the first free choice in pause between involution and evolution all personalities can make together. If first free choice would not be made by all personalities together, then the choice of one personality could predetermine the choice of another personality what would contradict the freedom of choice.

The first free choice signifies beginning of evolution and is choice to manifest personalities, as single separated beings. In involution consciousness and will of all personalities were still manifested as uniform consciousness and will of whole mankind. In evolution consciousness and will of mankind are manifested in personalities and in different principles through the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. Personalities can make now their free choice, according to their consciousness and will. Single principles are manifested as beings, whose consciousness is expressed in different *rhythms* or *cycles*. Therefore, evolution in the world structure can be described proceeding from rhythms of oneness, duality, trinity and so on. Jacob Böhme, for example, describes the world origin through seven *Source-Spirits (qualifying or fountain Spirits) of God*:

The seven Spirits of God, in their Circumference or Space, contain or comprehend Heaven and this World; also the wide Breadth and Depth without and beyond the Heavens, even above and beneath the World, and in the World, yea the whole Father, who hath neither Beginning nor End. They contain also all the Creatures both in Heaven and in this World; and all the Creatures in Heaven and in this World are imaged, fashioned or framed out of these Spirits, and live in them as in their own Propriety. Their Life and their Reason is generated in them in such a Manner as the Divine Being is generated, and also in the same Power. Out of and from the same Body of the seven Spirits of God are all Things made and produced, all Angels, all Devils, the Heaven, the Earth, the Stars, the Elements, Men, Beasts, Fowls, Fishes; all Worms, Wood, Trees, also Stones, Herbs and Grass, and all whatsoever is.

Jacob Boehme. The Aurora. The Day-Spring or Dawning of the Day in the East.
The Ninth Chapter. Of the gracious, amiable, blessed, friendly and merciful Love of God.

Seven Source-Spirits of God have no freedom of choice and are those seven creative spirits before the throne of God which were conscious to mankind as principles in the state of involution. Jacob Böhme calls them *Qualities*. It is necessary to note that Jacob Böhme was not only representative of consciousness of man of sixteenth century, but he also had supersensible faculties of perception. Exactly these supersensible faculties allowed him to perceive septenary rhythm of the development of consciousness through manifestation of

Qualities. Consciousness of modern man is different than it was of man of the sixteenth century and, according to this consciousness, understanding of importance of the freedom of choice for the development of consciousness of personality will be different also.

Three kingdoms of consciousness

Separated personalities were manifested on different stages of the hierarchies of consciousness. The stages of consciousness of the hierarchies differ from each other by the stages of conscious following to rhythms of the development of consciousness of the world structure. One of such rhythms is rhythm of *trinity* or *Holy Trinity*. According to this rhythm three are manifested three kingdoms of consciousness. Jacob Böhme describes manifestation of these three kingdoms of consciousness in the following way:

When God Almighty had decreed in his Council that he would make Angels or Creatures out of himself, then he made them out of his eternal Power and Wisdom, according to the Form and Manner of the Ternary in his Deity, and according to the Qualities in his Divine Being.

At first he made three kingly Governments or Dominions, answerable to the Number of the Holy Trinity, and each Kingdom had the Order or Ordinance, Power and Quality of the Divine Being.

Jacob Boehme. The Aurora. The Day–Spring or Dawning of the Day in the East.
The Seventh Chapter. Of the Court, Place and Dwelling, also of the Government of Angels,
how these things stood at the Beginning, after the Creation, and how they became as they are.

The first free choice of all personalities manifested three kingdoms and determined in which kingdom and with which consciousness every personality is manifested. Because personalities are manifested with different consciousness, there must be manifested personality with the highest consciousness in each kingdom. Jacob Böhme calls the names of these personalities: *Michael*, *Lucifer* and *Uriel*. Each of these personalities is called by Jacob Böhme as *Angelical King* or *Prince*:

Concerning the King or great Prince Micha-El.

Micha-El signifies the great Strength or Power of God, and bears the Name operatively, actually and in Deed: For he is incorporated or consolidated together out of the seven qualifying or fountain Spirits, as out of Kernel or Seed of them, and stands here now as in the Stead of God the Father.

The Meaning is not, that He is God the Father, who consists in the seven Spirits of the whole Deep, and is not creaturely; but the Meaning is, that in Nature among Creatures there is also such a Kind of Creature, is like God the Father, as he is in the seven qualifying or fountain Spirits, which is to reign among the Creatures.

For when God made himself creaturely, then he made himself creaturely according to his Ternary: And as in God, the Ternary is the Greatest and Chiefest, and yet his wonderful Proportion, Form, and Variety, cannot be measured, in that he shows himself in his Operation so various and manifold; so also he has created three principle Angel princes, according to the biggest Primacy of his Ternary.

Jacob Boehme. The Aurora. The Day–Spring or Dawning of the Day in the East.
The Twelfth Chapter. Of the Nativity and Proceeding forth or Decent of the Holy Angels,
as also of their Government, Order, and Heavenly joyous Life.

Jacob Böhme does not refer to freedom of choice of the Angelical Kings directly. However every king must be personality. If kings would be created by the Father-God as beings

without freedom of choice, then the fall, mentioned by Jacob Böhme, would be impossible for king Lucifer:

Of the second King Lucifer, now so called, because of his Fall.

King Lucifer, shut thy Eyes here a little, and stop thy Ears a little, that thou mayest neither hear nor see, or else thou wilt be horribly ashamed, that another sits upon thy Seat, and thy shame shall be fully discovered yet before the End of the World, which thou hast kept so closely concealed in Secret, and suppressed, ever since the Beginning of the World, wheresoever thou couldst: I will now describe thy kingly Primacy, not for thee, but for Benefit of Man.

This high and mighty, glorious and beautiful King, lost his right Name in his Fall: For he is now called Lucifer, that is, one carried forth or expelled out of the Light of God. His Name was not so at the Beginning: For he was a creaturely Prince or King of the Heart of God in the bright Light, even the Brightest among the three Kings of Angels.

Of his Creation.

As Micha-El is created according to the Quality, Manner and Property of God, the Father, so was Lucifer created according to the Quality, Condition and Beauty of God the Son, and was bound to and united with him in Love, as a dear Son or Heart, and his Heart also stood in the Center of Light, as if he had been God himself; and his Beauty or Brightness transcended all. For his Circumference, Conception, or chiefest Mother, was the Son of God, and there he stood as a King or Prince of God.

His Court, Province, Place, Region or Quarters, wherein he dwelt with his whole Army or Company, and wherein he is become a Creature, and which was his Kingdom, is the created Heaven and this World, wherein we dwell with our King Jesus Christ.

For our King sits in divine Omnipotence, where King Lucifer sat, and on the kingly Throne of expelled Lucifer, and the Kingdom of King Lucifer is now become His: O Prince Lucifer, how dost thou relish that?

Jacob Boehme. The Aurora. The Day–Spring or Dawning of the Day in the East.
The Twelfth Chapter. Of the Nativity and Proceeding forth or Decent of the Holy Angels,
as also of their Government, Order, and Heavenly joyous Life.

Being without freedom of choice cannot fall by itself because action scheme of such a being is always predetermined in advance. Only free choice of Lucifer could lead him to that, what Jacob Böhme calls the *fall*. Therefore, one calls Lucifer also *devil* what literally means the '*fallen God*'. Besides, the name Lucifer signifies the '*bearer of light*' or the '*light-bearer*'. In the beginning of evolution Lucifer had the highest consciousness among all personalities. The consequence of the fall of Lucifer is that he is not personality with the highest consciousness any more. The highest consciousness has Jesus Christ. This does not mean Lucifer has lost his consciousness or his high wisdom. This means Jesus Christ has developed his consciousness so far, that it became higher than consciousness of any personality in our world structure. Confirmation that Lucifer is personality could be taken from the following citation:

Did not the total or universal God know this, before the Time of Creation of Angels that it would to come to pass? No: For if God had known it before the Time of Creation of Angels, it had been an eternal predestinate purposed Will, and it had been no Enmity against God, but God had indeed at the Beginning created him a Devil.

Jacob Boehme. The Aurora. The Day–Spring or Dawning of the Day in the East.
The Fourteenth Chapter. How Lucifer, who was the most beautiful Angel in Heaven,

is become the most horrible Devil.

If God could not know that fall of Lucifer will take place in advance, then that means Lucifer is personality. Because free choice of personality cannot be known to nobody in advance and in this sense it is unknowable.

Jacob Böhme characterizes third king in the following way:

Of the third Angelical King, called Uri-El.

This gracious, amiable, blessed prince and king hath his name from the Light, or from the Flash or Going forth of the Light, which signifieth rightly God the Holy Ghost.

For as the Holy Ghost goeth forth from the Light, and formeth, figureth and imageth all, and reigneth in all, such also is the Power and gracious, amiable Blessedness of a Cherubim, who is the King and Heart of all his Angels; that is, when his Angels do but behold him they are all then infected and touched with the Will of their King.

For as the Will of the Heart infects and stirs all the Members of the Body, so that the whole Body doth as the Heart hath decreed or concluded; or as the Holy Ghost riseth up in the Centre of the Heart, and enlighteneth all the Members in the whole body; so the Cherubim with his whole Glance or Lustre and Will infects all his Angels, so that they all are together as one Body, and the King is the Heart therein.

Now this glorious and beautiful Prince is imaged and framed according to the Kind and Quality of the Holy Ghost, and is indeed a glorious and fair Prince of God, and is united with the other Princes in Love, as one Heart.

These are now the three Princes of God in the heaven. And when the Flash of Life, that is, the Son of God, riseth up in the Middle or central Circle in the qualifying or fountain Spirits of God, and sheweth itself triumphantly, then the Holy Ghost also riseth upwards triumphantly: In this Rising up the Holy Trinity also riseth up in the Heart of these three Kings, and each of them triumpheth also according to his Kind and Quality.

Jacob Boehme. The Aurora. The Day-Spring or Dawning of the Day in the East.
The Twelfth Chapter. Of the Nativity and Proceeding forth or Decent of the Holy Angels,
as also of their Government, Order, and Heavenly joyous Life.

All personalities together have made their free choice, which allowed Lucifer to have the highest consciousness among personalities. Some personalities manifested themselves on lower stage of consciousness and have allowed other personalities to manifest themselves on higher stage of consciousness and vice versa. All personalities have made their mutual sacrifice, because they have made their first free choice together. No personality was forced by another personality to its choice and all personalities remained equally free. Therefore, personalities on lower stage of consciousness can develop their consciousness even more quickly than personalities, which are manifested on higher stage of consciousness. In other words, the speed of the development of consciousness depends not so much on stage of consciousness on which personalities are manifested, but rather on which free choice will be made.

Because any personality is member of whole mankind, any free choice of personality always exercises influence over the development of consciousness of other personalities. The higher is stage of consciousness of personality, the more influence can be exercised and the more responsibility personality has in determination of its choice. Responsibility of personality is determined by Karma to which free choice of personality leads. Beside individual Karma, all personalities, without exception, create Karma of mankind.

Lucifer had possibility to allow personalities in his kingdom, to manifest only those relations with beings of the hierarchies, whose consequences he himself could foresee. According to his stage of consciousness Lucifer has chosen to remove restrictions on

connection of personality with beings of the hierarchies. This allows personalities in kingdom of Lucifer to become dependent on connection with beings of the hierarchies and to manifest greatest evil. To explain what is evil, Rudolf Steiner uses the following example:

What is evil? It is nothing else but an untimely good. To state an example, that was occasionally stated by me: If we suppose that we have to do with an excellent piano player and an excellent piano engineer and both are perfect of their kind. First engineer must build the instrument and then give it to player. If he is a good player, he will use it in suitable way and thus both are good, as it were. If, however, engineer now goes to concert hall instead of player and would like to hammer around, then he would be at wrong place. Good would thus become evil. Thus we see that evil is nothing else but good at wrong place.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 93. The temple legend and the golden legend.
The Manicheans. Berlin, 11th November 1904.

It is possible to give another example of manifestation of good and evil. If child is fed with spoon, when it cannot do this yet by itself, then it is good. If this is continued when child is already in a state to do it by itself, then it would be evil, because that will not correspond to the development of consciousness of child in rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. One and the same action with the same intention of good can manifest good in one state of consciousness, and in other state of consciousness be evil. The following saying points to connection between good and evil: "*The road to hell is paved with good intentions*".

Speaking in general, if free choice of personality does not correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind, then it is evil. Free choice of personality which leads to manifestation of evil means separation of consciousness of personality from consciousness of mankind, through connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. It is expressed in that, that personality strives for satisfaction of egoism without taking into consideration other personalities. The more is separation, the more is evil which can be manifested by personality through its free choice. To balance result of the greatest separation of personalities, it is also necessary through free choice to manifest the greatest good which leads all personalities to consciousness of unity of mankind. In this sense, the greatest evil exists in order to manifest the greatest good.

Lucifer had possibility to restrict connection of personality with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness, not allowing personality to become dependent on beings. Just as the absolute Spirit allows mankind to be free in its choice of the development of consciousness, Lucifer also allows personalities in his kingdom to be free in the development of consciousness through manifestation of good and evil. The absolute Spirit, however, has infinite consciousness and knows all possible consequences of any free choice. In spite of fact, that consciousness of Lucifer was the highest, it is still finite, therefore, he could not foresee all possible consequences of his free choice. The free choice of Lucifer has led to that what one calls the *fall*.

The fall signifies that Lucifer could not counterbalance relations between personality and beings of the hierarchies in such a way, that personality could develop the 'I'-consciousness keeping independence from beings of the hierarchies. The free choice of personality, which owing to decision of Lucifer manifests evil, creates Karma not only to personality, but also to Lucifer. Lucifer has become dependent on connections with beings of the hierarchies, which were manifested as result of free choice of other personalities. He became unfree and hence has fallen in a sense, that he could not counterbalance manifestation of evil, and in such a way to prevent influence of evil on himself.

In kingdom of Lucifer there exists one personality which has used the choice of Lucifer in order to attain the highest consciousness of separation from mankind. This personality is called the *devil*, *Mephistopheles*, *Ahriman*. One should make distinction between the concepts

of *devil* and *Satan*. Devil signifies '*fallen God*' and is referred to Lucifer. Satan signifies those, who '*leads away from the God*' or who '*separates from God*'. In New Testament the words devil and Satan point accordingly to Lucifer and Ahriman.

The development of consciousness of personality in every kingdom has property which depends on consciousness of king. To understand better specific properties of the development of consciousness of personality in every kingdom, one can use the following analogy. The kingdoms of Michael, Lucifer and Uriel can be considered as three schools of the development of consciousness accordingly. In each school there are director, teachers and disciples. Director has the highest consciousness on which depends the education in school. In first school director gives teachers instructions what must be educated. Teachers carry out instructions of director without any objection, not because they have no personal opinion, but because consciousness of director is superior to consciousness of each teacher and he knows much more, than they do. In third school director consults with teachers, before they get instructions from him. This makes the main difference between first and third schools. Disciples, according to their level of consciousness, fulfil instructions of teachers. The development of consciousness of disciples in first and third schools occurs relatively slow. To accelerate the development of consciousness, director of second school makes decision to allow disciples to change conditions of education in his school. Conditions of education can be changed so far, that director becomes unable to conduct education. In this case someone else should take control over education.

Michael and Uriel made their choice which does not allow personality to manifest evil in their kingdoms. Personalities in kingdoms of Michael and Uriel have possibility to become conscious of evil through what corresponds to the concepts of contemplation, meditation or reasoning (thinking) in our kingdom of Lucifer. However one should not imagine that consciousness of modern man on the Earth is the same, as consciousness of personalities in kingdoms of Michael and Uriel. The lowest stage of consciousness of personality in their kingdoms is comparable with the stage of consciousness of Angel. Personalities on the stage of consciousness of Angel do not need to be manifested in physical body. Their free choice does not manifest such relations with the hierarchies of consciousness as physical birth, illness or death. They cannot impose sufferings on other personalities, but they can think about them and experience them through reflection. Because of that, the development of consciousness in kingdoms of Michael and Uriel occurs more slowly, than in kingdom of Lucifer. It is much faster to manifest good or evil through choice and to experience its consequences than to become conscious of all consequences of free choice through reflection. Confirmation for that is also Jesus Christ who was manifested in kingdom of Lucifer and has become personality whose consciousness is the highest in our world structure. Consciousness of Jesus Christ permeates through all three kingdoms, whilst consciousness of one king does not permeate through other kingdoms. How high consciousness of Christ, Michael, Lucifer and Uriel may be, their consciousness, as well as theirs kingdoms are finite.

The Place (Locus) or Space of this World, the Deep of the Earth, and above the Earth even to Heaven, as also the created Heaven, which was made out of the Midst [or Center] of the Waters, which moveth above the Stars, and which we behold with our Eyes, whose Depth we cannot sound or reach with our Sense, all this Place or Room together was one Kingdom, and Lucifer was King therein, before his being thrust out.

The other two Kingdoms, that of Michael and that of Uriel, are above the created Heaven, and are like that other Kingdom. These three Kingdoms together contain such a Deep, as is not of any human Number, nor can they be measured by any Thing. Yet you must know that these three Kingdoms have a Beginning and an End; but that God, who hath made these three Kingdoms out of himself, is infinite, and hath no End. Yet without and beyond and besides

these three Kingdoms there is likewise the Power of the Holy Trinity, for God the Father hath no End.

Jacob Boehme. The Aurora. The Day–Spring or Dawning of the Day in the East.
The Seventh Chapter. Of the Court, Place and Dwelling, also of the Government of Angels, how these things stood at the Beginning, after the Creation, and how they became as they are.

Because Lucifer allowed personalities in his kingdom to manifest evil without restrictions, he has deprived himself of possibility to counterbalance evil. In order any personality always could have possibility to become conscious of itself as the absolute Spirit another personality must counterbalance evil with good in the kingdom of Lucifer. This personality is Jesus Christ. Thereby, nobody is deprived of freedom of choice to manifest evil. To manifest evil means also to manifest opposites by opposing consciousness of some beings to consciousness of other beings. Michael and Uriel have preserved their power to counterbalance relations between beings in their kingdoms. Lucifer also had such a power before his fall. Jacob Böhme refers to that with the following words:

Of the Nativities or Genitures of the Angelical Kings, and how they came to be

The Person or Body of a King of Angels is generated out of all the Qualities, and out of all the Powers of his whole Kingdom, through the moving, wellingup Spirit of God; and therefore such a one is their King, in that his Power reacheth into all the Angels of his whole Kingdom, and he is the head and general or leader, the most beautiful and most powerful Cherubim or Throne Angel. Such a one was lord Lucifer also before his Fall.

Jacob Boehme. The Aurora. The Day–Spring or Dawning of the Day in the East.
The Seventh Chapter. Of the Court, Place and Dwelling, also of the Government of Angels, how these things stood at the Beginning, after the Creation, and how they became as they are.

Speaking about all Angels of kingdom, Jacob Böhme points out to the hierarchies of consciousness. Man can choose only from what is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness. Therefore in order to understand evolution of consciousness of man it is necessary to consider the hierarchies of consciousness.

The hierarchies of consciousness

Everything what man perceives through physical sense organs is only external expression of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. The hierarchy of consciousness consists of beings of one kind which are comprised in consciousness of being which one calls *Hierarch*. Hierarch has highest consciousness in the hierarchy. Being with higher consciousness is able to become conscious of what a being with lower consciousness is able to become conscious of too. Therefore, Hierarch is always conscious of what single being of the hierarchy is conscious of. For example, any fire on the Earth is comprised in consciousness of Hierarch which the Indian tradition calls *Agni*. Agni is Hierarch of all beings of the element of Fire on the Earth.

Indivisibility is inherent in hierarchies of consciousness. For example, the hierarchy of Angels signifies all Angels that are united through consciousness of the Hierarch of Angels. The hierarchy is indivisible whole in a sense that single Angel cannot exist without other Angels of the hierarchy.

Man as only being with freedom of choice, forms his own hierarchy of consciousness, which is *mankind*. Unlike other hierarchies of consciousness, each member of mankind has freedom of choice and consequently has its own Hierarch. Hierarch of man is his individuality, his highest ‘I’ (Self) in the manifested world structure. Man cannot exist

separated from his individuality, and individuality cannot exist separated from mankind. Consciousness of mankind is united consciousness of all human Hierarchs.

The teaching about the hierarchies of consciousness, as beings without freedom of choice, is teaching about gods. In the Acts of the Apostles (17:34) one can find the reference to Dionysius the Areopagite who became disciple of Apostle Paul and who systematized this teaching. It was written down much later by another Dionysius as explains Rudolf Steiner:

Instruction about the Gods was first systematised by Dionysius the Areopagite, the pupil of the apostle Paul. It was however written down first in the 6th century. This is why scholars deny the existence of Dionysius the Areopagite and speak about the writings of the Pseudo-Dionysius, as though it was in the 6th century that old traditions were first put together. A true matter of facts can only be established by reading in the Akashic Chronicle. The Akashic Chronicle does however teach that Dionysius actually lived in Athens, he was initiated by Paul and was given a task from him to lay the foundation of the teaching about the higher spiritual beings and to impart this knowledge to special initiates. At that time certain lofty teachings were never written down but only communicated as tradition by word of mouth. The teaching about the Gods was also given in this way by Dionysius to his pupils, who then passed it further on. These pupils in direct succession were intentionally called Dionysius, so that the last of these pupils, who wrote down this teaching was one of those whom the name of Dionysius was given.

This teaching about the Gods, as given by Dionysius, encompasses three times three limbs of divine beings. The three highest are: Seraphim, Cherubim, Thrones. The next stage encompasses: Dominions, Might, Powers. The third degree encompasses: Primordial Forces or Primal Beginnings, Archangels and Angels.

Whenever the words 'In the Beginning' occur in the Bible, they refer to the Primordial Forces or Beginnings. 'In the Beginning God created the heavens and the earth.' This means: The God of the Beginnings, who stands at this stage, created heaven and earth. It was one of the Primordial Forces belonging to the third division of the Hierarchies.

Above the Seraphim stand divine Beings of such sublimity that the human power of understanding is not sufficient to comprehend them. After the third stage, follows the fourth Hierarchy: Man, as the tenth in the entire sequence.

The names of the Hierarchies are not the proper names, but the names for certain stages of consciousness of the great universe, and the Beings move from one stage to another.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 93a. Foundations of Esotericism.

Lecture on 8th October 1905.

Different names were given to the hierarchies also. In the following table are presented some various names of beings of the hierarchies.

<i>1st Hierarchy</i>	
Seraphims	Spirits of Love
Cherubims	Spirits of Harmony
Thrones	Spirits of Will
<i>2nd Hierarchy</i>	
Dominions, Kyriotetes	Spirits of Wisdom
Mights, Virtutes, Dynamis,	Spirits of Movement
Powers, Potestates, Exusiai	Spirits of Form
<i>3rd Hierarchy</i>	
Primal Beginnings, Beginnings, Archai	Spirits of Personality
Archangel, Archangeloi	Spirits of Fire, Messengers of Archai
Angels, Angeloi	Sons of Life, Messengers

Beings without freedom of choice can have consciousness higher and lower than consciousness of man. Those beings whose consciousness is higher than consciousness of man are called the *heavenly beings* or *Devas*. In such way, Dionysius describes three hierarches of heavenly beings and points to purpose of hierarchy:

The aim of Hierarchy is the greatest possible similarity (likeness) and union with God.

Dionysius the Areopagite. The Celestial Hierarchy.
Chapter III. What is Hierarchy, and what the use of Hierarchy?

Similar to God can be only such being which has freedom of choice. Because the hierarchies of consciousness do not have freedom of choice, the similarity and union of hierarchy with God can occur only through free choice of personality. Consequence of the free choice of personality is the development of consciousness of personality, as well as of the hierarchies of consciousness. The higher is consciousness of personality the more it is conscious of possibilities of free choice. Because all possibilities of choice are manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness, the development of consciousness of personality occurs through inclusion of consciousness of beings of the hierarchies in consciousness of personality. If, for example, consciousness of personality encloses consciousness of Angel in itself, then it can become conscious of that, what Angel is conscious of. Consciousness of personality can be limited only by consciousness of the world structure. The end of the world structure can be reached only if consciousness of every personality is developed so far that it is conscious of all what can be conscious to all hierarchies. In such a way, personality with its consciousness can become superior to consciousness of any hierarchies or their combinations.

Man, being a compound of the essences of all these celestial Hierarchies, may succeed in making himself, as such, superior, in one sense, to any Hierarchy or Class, or even combination of them.

H. P. Blavatsky. The Secret Doctrine.
Volume 1. The Stanzas of Dzyan. Summing up.

The luciferic and ahrimanic beings

The idea of the development of the world structure is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness which provide possibilities of free choice to personalities. In the beginning of evolution Michael, Lucifer and Uriel were the first among personalities who were conscious of the idea of the development of the world structure. Their free choice manifested new possibilities of choice for other personalities.

That man is conscious only of the physical world, results from his free choice. If free choice of man manifests evil, then this choice opposes consciousness of some beings of the hierarchies to consciousness of other beings, whose consciousness is lower, than consciousness of man. Possibility of such a choice has been manifested by Lucifer and Ahriman, therefore unfree beings, whose consciousness becomes opposed or set against to consciousness of other unfree beings, are called *luciferic* and *ahrimanic* beings. These beings also are called *devilish* and *satanic* beings. Man bears responsibility for opposition of consciousnesses of beings of the hierarchies against each other and, hence, for manifestation of devilish and satanic consciousness. Free choice of man corresponds to truth if it corresponds to consciousness of beings of the heavenly hierarchies, whose consciousness is higher, than consciousness of man. Such free choice heightens consciousness of man because consciousness of a heavenly being will be included in consciousness of man.

The presence of consciousness of devilish and satanic beings in consciousness of man is expressed in changes of consciousness which are called suffering, illness, old age, birth and

death. If man were able to counterbalance connection with these beings according to consciousness of heavenly beings, then instead of birth and death he would experience a metamorphosis of one state of consciousness into another. Because man cannot do it by himself, then in order not to become completely dependent from devilish and satanic beings, his consciousness is limited by perception of physical world only.

The free choice of man always manifests certain relations between the hierarchies of consciousness and man. There occurs an exchange of consciousness. As result, single beings will be manifested which can influence next free choice of man. Beings themselves have no freedom of choice, therefore their consciousness is true. Lie is negation of reality. Therefore, if man lies he manifests beings whose consciousness truly reflects lie of man. They influence consciousness of other men so that lie which is truly reflected by consciousness of beings, will be perceived as truth, that is as influence of consciousness of heavenly beings. The strength of such influence depends on how much manifested beings can use consciousness of man. The more man lies, the stronger becomes influence of beings and the stronger will be dependence of man from beings. Similar occurs, when man is mistaken, that is when it unintentionally lies to himself. The main difference between mistake and lie is that consequences of mistake are less destructive for consciousness of man, than consequences of lie.

Typical example of dependence from beings is desire to experience pleasure just for the sake of pleasure. In this case, an influence of manifested beings works as temptation. Temptation consists of that, that beings truly reflect that pleasure, which man can experience due to connection with beings. Man can give in to temptation and become dependent from beings of the hierarchies in determination of his free choice and in this sense to become unfree.

Each time when man gives in to temptation, in consciousness of manifested beings will be included a part of consciousness of man. The use of consciousness of man by beings is the reason why man is predisposed to become feeble-minded, physically underdeveloped and ill since his birth. Dependence from beings may be so strong, that it is necessary to pass through several incarnations before man can be freed. The purpose of incarnation of man in physical body is the development of consciousness. In order man could be incarnated in some form of physical body, this form must be manifested as relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. For this purpose various beings pass through various incarnations also. The Earth also has passed through various incarnations before man could have the present form of physical body.

Just as man passes from one incarnation to another, one metamorphosis to another, so all the beings of the world pass through incarnations and reincarnations, from the smallest to the greatest, even such a being as our Earth itself – i.e. a planetary being - passes through reincarnations.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 110. The Spiritual Hierarchies and Their Reflection in the Physical World. Zodiac, Planets, Cosmos. Lecture on 13th April 1909.

Consciousness, life, form

The incarnations of man are connected with incarnations of the Earth which occur corresponding to rhythms of the development of consciousness of mankind. According to the rhythm of trinity there are three members in any manifested being, which are called *consciousness*, *life* and *form*. With the names *consciousness*, *life* and *form* it is always necessary to understand relations between the hierarchies of consciousness manifested through free choice of personalities. In this sense evolution of consciousness of mankind is unfolding of consciousness of personalities in infinite consciousness of the absolute Spirit through principles of consciousness, life and form.

What mankind has become conscious of in the state of involution is manifested in the state of evolution, on the one hand, as the universal rhythms of the world structure, of the Macrocosm, and on the other hand as personal rhythms of Microcosm. The rhythm of trinity is the rhythm of the world structure and is manifested in any being as consciousness, life and form. With the form it is necessary to understand that, what allows a being to have finite consciousness, and thus separates life of one being from another. The principles of consciousness, life and form correspond to spirit, soul and body in man. Another rhythm of the world structure is septenary rhythm which is manifested in the development of consciousness, life and form. How much consciousness, life and form of man correspond to the universal rhythm, depends on his free choice. The interaction of free choice of personalities and rhythms of trinity, sevenness and so on, creates variety of manifestations of consciousness, life and form. Every man in present rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind is personality who has the 'I'-consciousness, or is conscious of itself as the 'I'. Not all personalities had such consciousness in the beginning of evolution and in this sense they could become man only in subsequent rhythms of the development of consciousness. As Rudolf Steiner specifies it, to become man - means to have the 'I'-consciousness:

Since what does it mean to become man? It means to attain the 'I'-consciousness. You cannot do this unless you can differentiate yourself as the 'I' from what is outside you. Only through this you are the 'I'.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 110. The Spiritual Hierarchies and Their Reflection in the Physical World. Zodiac, Planets, Cosmos. Lecture on 13th April 1909.

In order for man to have consciousness of himself as the 'I', his spirit, soul and body must be in certain relations to each other, which allow man to become conscious of his separation from his external environment. These relations between the hierarchies of consciousness were manifested through free choice of personalities which had the 'I'-consciousness earlier, than man on the Earth. At what level of the hierarchies of consciousness each personality was manifested, it was determined by the first free choice of all personalities. Personalities which in the beginning of the evolution were manifested on the level of second hierarchy and higher, from the very beginning of the evolution had the 'I'-consciousness. Other personalities did not have such 'I'-consciousness yet and must pass through certain stages of the development of consciousness. Rudolf Steiner describes seven stages of the development of consciousness:

The occult science represents the world's development in which man goes through his successive stages. And it calls these development stages with names which have gone over as designations onto the planets surrounding the Earth. The development stage on which man stood with the most dull consciousness yet is called Saturn development; the second in which man lived with the dreamless sleeping consciousness, as the Sun development; the third in which the dreaming consciousness appeared, as the Moon stage; the fourth one, the present stage, on which man has attained clear day-consciousness, as the Earth development. And the stages of the future, which are accessible to initiates in the higher worlds today, on which the development stages will find their physical manifestation, are called successively as the Jupiter, Venus and Vulcan development.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 89. Spiritual scientific Cosmology I.
The fragment from year 1903/04

It is hardly possible to find out more detailed description of the stages of the development of consciousness corresponding to consciousness of modern man, than in books and lectures of Rudolf Steiner, which were written in the beginning of XX century. Because consciousness of mankind has changed since then, there is possibility to point out to the freedom of choice

directly. Everywhere in works of Rudolf Steiner where it is possible to find the words about beings of the hierarchies staying behind, about sacrifice of beings of the hierarchies, it is always a talk about personalities staying on certain level of the hierarchies of consciousness, because to make sacrifices or to stay behind in the development of consciousness it is possible only then when one has the freedom of choice.

The Saturn state of consciousness

The first words in the Gospel of St. John "*In the beginning was the Word*" mean that "*In the beginning was the freedom of choice*", and specify that state of evolution when personalities on the level of consciousness of the hierarchy of the Beginnings developed their 'I'-consciousness through free choice. This state of evolution in the kingdom of Lucifer is called the *Saturn state of consciousness*. It corresponds to the rhythm of all-mightness (omnipotence) which became conscious to mankind in the state of involution. This rhythm was manifested in each of three kingdoms differently. The manifestation of the rhythm of all-mightness in the kingdom of Lucifer is the Saturn state of consciousness.

In the Saturn state of consciousness Lucifer makes his free choice to remove limitations to manifest good and evil in his kingdom. In order to have the 'I'-consciousness, it is necessary to become conscious of separation from all what is manifested. Therein there is also a possibility of manifestation of greatest evil. The greatest evil can be manifested through personality, which in consequence of its free choice will attain the highest consciousness of separation from mankind. In the Saturn state personality which is called *Satan*, *Mephistopheles* and *Ahriman* has used such possibility. Ahriman has manifested his 'I'-consciousness as the highest principle of separation, possibility of which was provided by the free choice of Lucifer. Therefore it is said that Ahriman is Karma of Lucifer. In the Saturn state the principle of separation developed by Ahriman corresponded to the rhythm of all-mightness, that is why it was timely suitable and necessary for the development of the 'I'-consciousness of personalities through free choice.

Because consciousness of Lucifer was the highest one, to know about his free choice it is only possible because he has made it accessible for supersensible perception. The same relates to the free choice of Ahriman to manifest the highest consciousness of separation. And the more it will be true for free choice of Christ. Lucifer, Christ and Ahriman make their free choice with objective of development of consciousness of other personalities. Their free choice is a sacrifice and they do not have intension to get any benefit from it or to hide it. The more it will be known about their free choice and those possibilities of manifestation which follow from it, the more other personalities can make their free choice consciously.

In the Saturn state of consciousness man had the lowest dull trance-consciousness, which comparable with consciousness of a stone or a mineral on the Earth. A being with trance-consciousness on the Earth is not conscious of itself as a being separated from its environment at all, but is conscious of itself only as a part of its environment. It perceives movements of planets, mineral forms, forms of crystals and so on, but plants, animals and man cannot be perceived by such a being. It is possible for it to perceive forms in the world structure, but not life of forms. Because personalities with trance-consciousness did not separate themselves from their environment yet, their free choice always corresponded to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Because the form of manifestation of a being depends on its level of consciousness, man in the Saturn state also had form and life other than modern man on the Earth.

<i>State of consciousness</i>	<i>Members of man</i>	<i>Consciousness of man</i>
Saturn	Physical body: <i>Fire - Spirits of Will</i>	Trance-consciousness

In the Saturn state of consciousness man has such manifested physical body the development of which was influenced by free choice of personalities of the level of consciousness of Archai. Physical body of man had at that time quite different form, than it is now. All physical bodies of men were manifested as one physical body of the whole Saturn state of consciousness. The relations between the hierarchies of consciousness manifested as substance of physical body in the Saturn state of consciousness are called *Warmth*, or *Fire*. Manifestation of Warmth was connected mainly with free choice of personalities of the level of consciousness of Spirits of Will. Physical body of man that consisted of Warmth was changed under the influence of free choice of personalities of the level of consciousness of Archai.

The Sun state of consciousness

The rhythm of all-mightness was followed by the rhythm of all-wisdom which in the kingdom of Lucifer was manifested as the Sun state of consciousness. Not all personalities on the level of consciousness of Archai were able to develop the proper 'I'-consciousness before the Sun state of consciousness has come to an end. Such personalities have stayed behind rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind in the development of their 'I'-consciousness. The staying behind was not forced, but it was consequence of free choice of personalities. The rhythm of all-mightness continued to act in the Sun state of consciousness also, but it was not predominated any more. All previous rhythms always continue to act in following rhythms, but relations between them change due to free choice of personalities. Therefore, personalities which were not able to develop proper 'I'-consciousness in previous rhythm, have possibility to continue the development in next rhythm, if it was allowed by new relations. In the Sun state of consciousness the 'I'-consciousness developed personalities which were on the level of consciousness of the hierarchy of Archangel.

Personality which is known now as Jesus Christ was manifested on the level of consciousness of the hierarchy of Powers, or Spirits of Form in the Saturn state of consciousness. In the Sun state of consciousness Jesus Christ attains the highest 'I'-consciousness among personalities with the level of consciousness of the hierarchy of Powers. The principle of separation developed by Ahriman is manifested in the Sun state of consciousness as the principle that prevents the development of the 'I'-consciousness of Jesus Christ. Consciousness of Ahriman was still higher than consciousness of Jesus Christ and it influenced all personalities. The consequence of such influence of Ahriman was that in the Sun state of consciousness one personality which is called *Sorat*, or the *Sun-demon* has developed such consciousness which was opposed to consciousness of Jesus Christ.

In the Sun state of consciousness man had already dreamless sleep consciousness, which is comparable with consciousness of single plant on the Earth. A being with this consciousness on the Earth perceives life in minerals and plants, but the animal kingdom, feelings and thoughts do not exist for such consciousness. This state of consciousness is already less dull, but it is also less comprehensive, than the trance-consciousness. Free choice of man with dreamless sleep consciousness also corresponded to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind in the Sun state of consciousness.

<i>State of consciousness</i>	<i>Members of man</i>	<i>Consciousness of man</i>
Sun	Etheric body Physical body: <i>Air - Spirits of Wisdom</i>	Dreamless sleep consciousness

In the Sun state of consciousness to the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness manifested as physical body of man, were added other relations which were manifested as the etheric body. The addition of substance of the etheric body has been connected mainly with free choice of personalities of the level of consciousness of Spirits of Wisdom. The etheric body supported more stable form of the physical body, than it was in the Saturn state of consciousness. The alterations of the etheric body of man were influenced by free choice of personalities of the level of consciousness of Archangel. The physical body of man becomes manifestation of the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which are called *Air*. Such relations made physical body still more stable to the alterations, taking place in the etheric body, owing to free choice of Archangels.

The Moon state of consciousness

The next rhythm all-love was manifested in the kingdom of Lucifer as the Moon state of consciousness. In this state the 'I'-consciousness developed personalities which were on the level of consciousness of the hierarchy of Angels. Among Spirits of Form in the Moon state of consciousness the highest 'I'-consciousness was attained by personality which is called *Jehova*, or *Jahve*. *Jehova* already has been manifested on the level of consciousness of the hierarchy of Powers, or Spirits of Form in the Saturn state of consciousness. However the leading personality among Spirits of Form *Jehova* becomes only in the Moon state of consciousness.

In the Moon state of consciousness for the first time was manifested that, what it is called the *fight in heaven* or the *war in heaven*. The war is always connected with violation of freedom of choice of personality. If one man wishes something that will contradict freedom of choice of other man this will wage war with other man. Though this war may not be manifested on physical level, however it is manifested on level of consciousness which is called mental and on which thoughts are real beings. Similarly, if man experiences feeling of hate or anger in relation to other man, then such war is manifested on level which is called astral where feelings, emotions, passions and lusts are real beings. For example, behind manufacture of arms there are always thoughts to kill. Therefore when men produce weapons they already wage war with other mankind on the mental level. If the feelings of benefit, greed, pride, envy, anger and similar are added to such thoughts, a war is waged not only on the mental, but also on the astral level of consciousness and it is not far away to its manifestation on the physical level at all.

The first war was waged on the level of consciousness of Angels which is higher than the level of waking consciousness of modern man on the Earth therefore this war is called the *war in heaven*. Personalities on the level of consciousness of Archangels, Archai and higher made their free choice which could lead to mistakes, but it corresponded to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Therefore personalities on the level of consciousness higher than of Angels did not manifest evil. Their consciousness was high enough to make free choice, not violating the freedom of choice of other personalities. Personalities on the level of consciousness of Angels in the Moon state of consciousness for the first time began to make free choice depending on personal sympathies and antipathies which could contradict the freedom of choice of other personalities.

The free choice of Lucifer caused that some personalities could stay behind in their development because of free choice of other personalities. The free choice of personality is always manifested through beings of the hierarchies without freedom of choice. Therefore all hierarchies of consciousness have been involved in the war in heaven. Since then there were many wars and they will proceed to exist until it will be realized, that free choice of one personality must not violate free choice of other personalities.

In the Moon state of consciousness man had dreaming sleep consciousness, which is comparable with consciousness of single animal on the Earth. Such consciousness, besides the forms of mineral, plant and animal kingdoms, also perceives life and feelings of beings of these kingdoms. Such consciousness is still less comprehensive, than previous one, however free choice of personality with this consciousness still corresponded to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind.

<i>State of consciousness</i>	<i>Members of man</i>	<i>Consciousness of man</i>
Moon	Astral body Ethereic body Physical body: <i>Water - Spirits of Motion</i>	Dreaming consciousness

To the physical and etheric body of man in the Moon state of consciousness were added relations between the hierarchies consciousness called *astral body*. The addition of substance of the astral body has been connected mainly with free choice of personalities of the level of consciousness of Spirits of Movement. Now free choice of personalities of the level of consciousness of Angels influenced the development of the astral body of man. The free choice of personalities of the level of Angels could, however, manifest evil already. Therefore personalities with consciousness higher than consciousness of Angels acquired wisdom to make free choice so, that on the one hand, do not violate free choice of personalities with consciousness of Angels, and on the other hand, to the greatest degree to protect physical, etheric and astral body of man from an influence of evil. Eventually man has received protection against evil in physical and etheric body because they gave in to the influences of the astral body less of all. The physical body of man in the Moon state of consciousness has been manifested as relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which are called *Water*. Because in the Moon state of consciousness personalities acquired wisdom to make free choice without violation of free choice of other personalities, the Moon state of consciousness is called the *Cosmos of Wisdom*.

The Earth state of consciousness

The rhythm of all-justice was manifested in the kingdom of Lucifer as the state of consciousness of mankind called *Earth*. Here the 'I'-consciousness develop those personalities, which, actually, are called man and which still had no such possibility in the states of Saturn, Sun and Moon and. What is called the Earth planet is a plenty of relations between hierarchies of consciousness which allow man to develop his 'I'-consciousness. The Earth planet is a characteristic of the whole Earth state of consciousness in a sense that on the Earth planet personalities can have the lowest and the highest 'I'-consciousness in the world structure. The highest 'I'-consciousness could be attained by Jesus Christ on the Earth planet.

When the Earth state of consciousness has come to existence, wisdom as result of free choice of personalities in the Moon state, was manifested in such relations between physical, etheric and astral bodies of man which allowed him to develop the 'I'-consciousness through his free choice. Such possibility of manifestation has been provided by free choice of personalities of the level of consciousness of the Spirits of Form. Up to the Earth state of consciousness man had no waking self-consciousness of himself as of personality. Now the 'I'-consciousness could be manifested in physical body of man. The relations between the hierarchies of consciousness manifested as physical body of man are called the *Earth*. In wonderful construction of physical body of man it is possible to see manifestation of wisdom which has been attained by personalities in the Moon state of consciousness.

<i>State of consciousness</i>	<i>Members of man</i>	<i>Consciousness of man</i>
Earth	'I' (Self) Astral body Etheric body Physical body: <i>Earth - Spirits of Form</i>	Waking consciousness

Consciousness of single stone, plant and animal on the Earth could be manifested only because man had trance-consciousness, dreamless sleep consciousness and dreaming consciousness in Saturn, Sun and Moon states of consciousness. Therefore it would be mistake to imagine, that consciousness of single stone, plant, animal are exactly the same as there was consciousness of man. They were manifested due to free choice of man. Man, having these three kinds of consciousness, still had not separated himself from whole mankind and his free choice has always been agreed with free choice of other personalities. Only in the Earth state of consciousness man can make free choice which does not correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Man begins to use his free choice for the manifestation of good and evil.

In the following table are listed names of rhythms of the world structure, states of consciousness in the kingdom of Lucifer and names of the hierarchies of consciousness on which level personalities developed their 'I'-consciousness.

<i>Rhythms of the world structure</i>	<i>States of consciousness in the kingdom of Lucifer</i>	<i>Personalities with the 'I'-consciousness</i>
All-mightness	Saturn	Arhai, Beginnings, Primal Beginnings
All-wisdom	Sun	Archangels
All-love	Moon	Angels
All-justness	Earth	Man

Each of these states of consciousness in the kingdom of Lucifer is Manvantara when personalities create their Karma through free choice. The transition from one state of consciousness to another state of consciousness is carried out by personalities in state of Pralaya. In Pralaya personalities can experience the experiences of each other. For example, when personality lies, then the consequences of lie work destructive for consciousness of personality. In order to learn not to lie, it is not necessary for each personality to experience the consequences of its own lie it is enough to experience the experiences of other personality. Such possibility is provided in Pralaya to all personalities. Personalities do not create Karma in Pralaya, but process the results of free choice made in previous Manvantara and prepare to use them for the development of consciousness in following Manvantara.

Between the Earth Manvantara and the following Planets man lives in Pralaya. Outwardly there is nothing whatever around, but all the forces which man has drawn forth from the Earth, are within him. In such period of life all the outer turns inwards. Everything is then present as seed and carries its life over to the next Manvantara. Broadly speaking this is a similar state to that in which we, in the moment of retrospect, forget all that is around us and only remember our experiences in order to preserve them in memory and later make use of them. So in Pralaya mankind as a whole remembers all experiences in order to put them to use again afterwards.

The Earth state of consciousness comprises the previous states of consciousness Saturn, Sun and Moon in itself. In this sense the previous states of consciousness were incarnations of the Earth being and had the mission to give man possibility to use forces of willing, feeling and thinking consciously.

According to four states of consciousness Saturn, Sun, Moon and Earth it is to distinguish four members or limbs in man: physical body, etheric body, astral body and the 'I'. The development of the 'I'-consciousness of man through mastering of willing, feeling and thinking corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind in the Earth state of consciousness. To bring these three elements through man consciously into balance makes up the mission of the Earth.

If one associates the Saturn mission with the endowment of the element of will, the Sun mission principally with the endowment of the element of feeling, and the Moon mission chiefly with that of the element of thought - with that what it is in the astral body of man - then the mission of the Earth is to bring about a perfect balance between these three elements, so that in state of balance these three elements, each of which had been predominant in an earlier incarnation of our Earth, will work together. This is the mission of our Earth. To stop the battle between these elements by bringing them into proper relation of balance between them, this is the mission of the Earth. Man is involved in this mission of the Earth in order that he may establish this balance between thinking, feeling and willing, first of all in his own inner being.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 121. The Mission of the Individual Folk-Souls In Connection with Teutonic Mythology. Lecture on 11th June 1908.

The seven kinds of consciousness of man

According to seven rhythms of the world structure, which mankind became conscious of in the state of involution, it is to distinguish seven states of consciousness in the kingdom of Lucifer. Seven kinds of consciousness, which man can have, correspond to seven states of consciousness in the world structure. To the four already described states Saturn, Sun, Moon and Earth will be added three more future states of consciousness Jupiter, Venus and Vulcan. All states of consciousness always exist together, beside each other and in each other, and became conscious to mankind as principles, in the state of involution. The involution and evolution of these principles is reflected in constitution of man. According to the seven states of consciousness there are seven members, limbs, or carriers of consciousness of man.

<i>States of consciousness</i>	<i>Members of man</i>	<i>Consciousness of man</i>
Saturn	Physiocal body	Trance-consciousness
Sun	Etheric, life body	Dreamless consciousness
Moon	Astral body	Dreaming consciousness
Earth	'I' (Self)	Waking, day-consciousness
Jupiter	Self-Spirit, Manas	Picture, imaginative consciousness
Venus	Life-Spirit, Buddhi	Tone, inspirative consciousness
Vulcan	Spirit-Man, Atman	Spiritual, intuitive consciousness

Man is not limited only by these seven members. He is finite image of the absolute Spirit, and enumeration of his seven members corresponds to septenary rhythm of the development of consciousness. There are other rhythms also, for example, nonary rhythm. Rudolf Steiner refers to this rhythm with the more detailed description:

You remember from my "Theosophy" that it is only rough classification if we are saying man consists of physical body, etheric body, astral body, 'I', spirit-self, life-spirit, spirit-man, and that the more correct division, as you know, is physical body, etheric body, astral body, and then we distinguish that wherein the 'I' emerges - sentient soul, rational or feeling (psychic) soul, consciousness soul - and that only therein we have spirit-self or Manas, life-spirit or Buddhi, spirit-man or Atma. Thus the soul-element appears to be inserted in man as sentient soul, rational soul and consciousness soul.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 102. The Influence of Spiritual Beings in Man.
Lecture on 15th February 1908.

The being of man is also described as consisting of four members or limbs: physical body, etheric body, astral body and the 'I'. The fourth member - the 'I' (Self) - is the most complex member of all. It is individuality of man which contains all possibilities of development of the 'I'-consciousness of personality. In modern man the 'I'-consciousness comprise the sentient, rational and consciousness soul. It is expressed by that, that man can use feeling, thinking and willing consciously. The higher three members - Self-Spirit, Life-Spirit and Spirit-Man - will be developed in man when his astral, etheric and physical bodies will be completely under his conscious control. The rhythms for the development of higher members of man - Self-Spirit, Life-Spirit and Spirit-Man - will be manifested in future states of consciousness - Jupiter, Venus and Vulcan. This does not mean, man has no possibility to develop the higher members in the Earth state of consciousness. It means the development of the Earth has an objective of development of the 'I'-consciousness of man through thinking, feeling and willing. When man will be capable to control consciously the processes of the astral body he will attain the development of Manas, or Self-Spirit. The consciousness in the etheric body will signify the development of Buddhi, or Life-Spirit. Man becomes Atman, or Spirit-Man when the processes of physical body will be part of his waking 'I'-consciousness. Man has these higher members in himself already, but he still cannot control them consciously. In Rudolf Steiner's works it is possible to find the following, more detailed description of four members of man:

First, it is the physical body. It is that man, who is visible to the bodily eye, the only natural man who is known to now-days science. The purely physical man corresponds to the mineral world. He is a summarization of all the physical forces of the universe.

Second, it is the etheric body. How one can understand it? We know that hypnosis wakes a different state of consciousness, not only in the hypnotized subject but also in the hypnotist, who suggests anything he pleases to his test subject. He can make him think that a chair is a horse, or that the chair is not there, or again that there is nobody in a room which is really full of people. The Initiate can apply this ability to himself as desired and he can make himself to suggest that the physical body of the person in front of him is absent. Then, in place of the physical body he beholds, not an empty space, but the etheric body. This body somewhat resembles the physical body and yet it is different. It borrows its form from the physical body, but extends somewhat beyond it. The etheric body is more or less luminous and fluidic. Its organs appear as currents of diverse colors, and in place of the heart one finds out a veritable knot of forces, a vortex of streaming currents. The etheric body is also the real 'etheric double' of the physical body.

Man possesses it in common with the plants. It is not produced by the physical body as empiricists could believe, but the etheric body is on the contrary, the builder of whole physical organism. For the plant, as well as for man, it is the force of growth, rhythm and reproduction.

Third, it is the astral body. It has neither the form of the etheric nor the form of the physical body. It takes on the form of an oval and extends beyond the physical body like a cloud, an aura. The astral body can appear in all the colors of the rainbow, according to the passions by which it is ensouled. Each passion has its astral color. Besides this, the astral

body is, in some extent, the synthesis of the physical and etheric bodies, namely in the following way: the etheric body always has a contrary character to the sex of the physical body. The etheric body of a man is female; the etheric body of a woman is male. In both man and woman, the astral body is bisexual. In every respect, therefore, it is a synthesis of the two other bodies.

Fourth, it is the 'I' (Self) - Manas in Sanscrit, Jehova in Hebrew - is the rational and conscious soul. It is the indestructible individuality of man which entails the knowledge of how to build the other limbs of human being. It is the unutterable, the human 'I' and the divine 'I'. It is that union of four elements which was venerated by Pythagoras in the sign of the tetragram.

The evolution of man consists in transforming the lower bodily limbs with the aid of the 'I' into spiritualized bodies. The physical body is the most ancient and hence the most perfect limb of to-days man. The present phase of human evolution has a task to transform the astral body.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 94. An Esoteric Cosmology.
Lecture on 26th May 1906.

The description of members of man is only a sketchy description out of which one should not make dogmas. Human being is much more complex, than it could be described at all. All hierarchies of consciousness participate in manifestation of human being and in order to describe it completely, it would be necessary to describe all possible relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. Therefore it is always possible to extend any description. For example, the astral aura of man in physical body has form of an oval, or an egg because the etheric, or life (vital) currents which permeate the astral body, form so-called etheric, or energetic cocoon which has shape of an oval, or an egg in man. It is necessary to understand the etheric, vital or energetic currents as relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which for the supersensible perception appear as streams or currents. All sentient living beings on the Earth have etheric cocoon which is connected with etheric body of the Earth. Death of being in physical body comes when its etheric cocoon will be destroyed. The etheric cocoon of man appears at the moment of physical conception and it keeps connection of the etheric body with physical body of man. When the etheric cocoon is destroyed, the etheric body is released from physical body and there comes alteration of consciousness called death. After death man can preserve his waking consciousness in the astral body if he has appropriate qualities, or attributes. The astral aura of man is a colour characteristic of qualities of man, laid on the etheric cocoon. About the complexity of constitution of man it is possible to find the following explanation of Rudolf Steiner:

Self-knowledge is difficult because man is such a complex being. The reason for this complexity of man is that he is connected with all the higher worlds and beings. What we have in us are shadow-images of the great world and our members, our constitution - our physical, etheric, astral bodies and the 'I' - are worlds for divine beings. Our physical body, etheric body, astral body and the 'I' form one world; the other is the higher world, the Heaven world. The bodily members of man are high worlds for divine-spiritual beings of the higher worlds. Man is such complex being because he is a real mirror-image of the spiritual world. Realization of this should make him conscious of his human dignity. However from the knowledge that although we are reflected images of the spiritual world we nevertheless are far removed from what we ought to be – on the indirect way from this knowledge we also acquire, as well as our human dignity, the right attitude of modesty and humility towards the Macrocosm and its Gods.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 130. Esoteric Christianity and the spiritual guidance of Mankind. The Etherisation of the Blood. Basel, 1st October 1911.

Life after death

During life in physical body man is not conscious of, that he is not only in physical, but also in the soul and spiritual world, among beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. In occultism the soul world is called astral world, and the spiritual world - *devachanic* world, or *Devachan*.

One distinguishes three worlds in occultism: first, the physical world, it is the world in which we live. Second, it is the astral world. It contains one region, which corresponds to purgatory. Third, it is the spiritual world or, according to description in Sanskrit, the devachanic world. It corresponds to Heaven in Christianity.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 94. An Esoteric Cosmology.
Lecture on 2nd June 1906.

The expressions *sky*, *heavens*, *heavenly world* are used for a designation of the world of the heavenly hierarchies, whose consciousness is higher than consciousness of man. Because the hierarchies of consciousness are manifested together, beside each other and in each other, all worlds are manifested together too. Man is manifested in all worlds, but in waking consciousness in physical body he is conscious only of the world of physical space and time.

Perception of space is connected with perception of manifestation of the hierarchies of consciousness beside each other, and perception of time - with perception of rhythmic sequence of alteration of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. In this sense space and time exist until exists the manifested world structure and their perception depends on the level of consciousness of personality. Man in physical body is conscious of space of three dimensions, and of time - as a sequence of alterations in space. The soul and spiritual worlds are not physically spatial and timely worlds, therefore man in physical body is not conscious of them. His waking consciousness does penetrate through threshold of supersensible space and time. When man falls asleep, he crosses this threshold and loses that content of the waking consciousness which is adapted only for physical space and time. It can make clear why man, waking up, cannot recollect, what he perceives behind threshold of the supersensible world. Man crosses this threshold completely when his consciousness changes through death. The fear of death is connected with unconscious fear of sufferings which have to do with the loss of content of consciousness of physical space and time.

To adapt himself to the soul and spiritual worlds after death, man first must free himself from the connections with beings of the hierarchies which he has established, striving to satisfy lusts and desires through physical body. The state of consciousness in which man is purified from sensual lusts and desires of the physical world is called the *purgatory*, *Kamaloka* – the '*place of desires*' in Sanskrit. The deprivation of a possibility to get satisfaction of desire through physical body causes sufferings. The more consciousness of man, deprived of physical body, is connected with pleasures of the physical world, the more is suffering of purification. Kamaloka is not physical place, it is state of consciousness, Man is protected from direct perception of Kamaloka by physical body. To perceive the state of Kamaloka, it is not necessary to pass through death, it is sufficient to develop supersensible organs of perception during life in physical body.

Kamaloka is situated in the astral world, where lusts and desires of man are manifested through beings, which are called *Kama-devas*. In a similar way to how physical body of man has materiality, corporeality of devas also has some materiality. Materiality needs to be understood as such level of consciousness on which consciousness, life and form of beings of the hierarchies are manifested in equal proportions. The body of Kama-devas possesses astral materiality. The devachanic world, *Devachan*, is subdivided into low and higher areas. The low Devachan is the mental world where thoughts of man are manifested through beings called *Rupa-devas*. The higher Devachan is the world of intentions, ideas and plans. Here

there are all possibilities of manifestation of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness through the free choice of personality. The beings of the higher Devachan are called *Arupa-devas*. According to the higher and low Devachan it is to distinguish in man the causal and mental body.

The causal body of man has originated in the beginning of evolution together with the first free choice of all personalities. Every personality has causal body which contains any choice that has already been made by personality. The made free choice is impossible to change, it is only possible to make next free choice. The made free choice is preserved unchanged from incarnation to incarnation and in this sense the causal body it is impossible to change too.

Spiritual world - higher Devachan	Arupa-devas	Causal body
Spiritual world - low Devachan	Rupa-devas	Mental body
Soul world - astral world	Kama-devas	Astral body

For example, to Kama-devas belong beings which in the Middle Ages have been still perceived as *gnomes*, *undines*, *sylphs*, *salamanders*. To Rupa-devas belong beings of third, and to Arupa-devas belong beings of first and second hierarchies of consciousness. In the spiritual world there is a level of consciousness which is called *Akasha-chronicle*. All results of free choice of personalities could be perceived on this level of consciousness. When one investigates Akasha-chronicle supersensibly, then it is possible to make conclusions about the free choice of personality only from the results of free choice. The free choice itself, as a cause, is imprinted in causal body of personality and cannot be investigated by others. The free choice is made through the absolute Spirit and is an intimate act between personality and the absolute Spirit. It can become known to others through Akasha-chronicle only with the consent of personality itself.

All is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness, therefore everything, what man perceives through his physical organs of perception, exist in other spaces as relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. After death instead of planets of the Solar system man perceives the hierarchies of consciousness and boundaries of their ruling realm. Man becomes conscious of himself in other spaces, when he is conscious of the hierarchies of consciousness. The space of Kamaloka, which is in the area of the Moon, will correspond to realm of the hierarchy of Angels. After state of Kamaloka man extends his life up to life of other planets of the Solar system. This corresponds to life in the realms of still higher hierarchies of consciousness. In the astral world in centre of activity of the hierarchies of consciousness is the Earth. The Sun is boundary of ruling realm of the Spirits of Form and is one of planets of the Solar system. In occultism the planet nearest to the Sun is called *Venus*, and the second from the Sun - *Mercury*. In natural science the names of the planets Mercury and Venus are interchanged. In the following table are present the planets of the Solar system and the corresponding boundaries of ruling realms of the hierarchies of consciousness.

<i>Planets of the Solar system</i>	<i>Hierarchies of consciousness</i>
Moon	Angels
Mercury	Achangels
Venus	Spirits of Personality, Archai
Sun	Spirits of Form, Powers
Mars	Spirits of Motion, Might
Jupiter	Spirits of Wisdom, Dominions
Saturn	Spirits of Will, Thrones

Modern man has his waking consciousness in physical body because owing to physical body he can become conscious of his own differentiation from his surroundings and to have the 'I'-consciousness. After death of his physical body he loses part of waking consciousness already during purification in Kamaloka. On the one hand, he loses possibility to become conscious of himself because of lack of physical body, and in this sense his consciousness becomes more dull, and on the other hand, this allows him to extend his perception in the realm of Angels. To preserve his waking consciousness in the realm of Angels and in higher realms of the hierarchies of consciousness, man must possess properties, inherent to consciousness of beings of these realms. In a sense of exchange of consciousness these properties can be characterized by two words – *taking* and *giving*. Beings of the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice do not choose, how much to take and give. They can take and give only as much, as it is prescribed to them by rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. As man has freedom of choice, these properties correspond to the qualities of *renouncement* and *sacrifice*. Both these qualities together is a characteristic of quality of love and of freedom from egoism. To preserve his waking consciousness, man must by himself counterbalance exchange of consciousness with beings of the hierarchies, making free choice how much to take and to give in a sense of setting connections with the hierarchies of consciousness. He must be able to refuse to take more, than it is necessary for the development of his consciousness and to be able to sacrifice his free choice for the sake of development of consciousness of other beings according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. And the higher are his qualities of renouncement and sacrifice, the longer he can preserve his waking consciousness after death. Independent of these qualities, his life and perception extend up to life of the hierarchies of consciousness.

Further extension of life of man after death leads him in the realms of Thrones, Seraphims and Cherubims. The human life extends up to the life of the Cosmos. Physically this corresponds to the area of twelve constellations surrounding seven planets of our Solar system. These constellations form so-called *animal circle*, or *zodiacal circle* - *Zodiac*. The names of signs of animal circle refer to connection of the hierarchies of consciousness with manifestation of human form and form of animals.

Each member of the human body was given certain name in ancient language. The heart was called as the Lion within the body. Primeval wisdom said: to which direction of the Zodiac must one point, if one wishes to indicate the region out of which were laid the first layout of the human heart? They pointed upwards, and named these Thrones, Cherubim and Seraphim who acted from there as region of Lion (Leo). Man received the first layout of his physical body projected from out [of] cosmic space, and the region of his body, which he was accustomed to call inwardly, Lion, was also outwardly called the region of Lion out in the Zodiac Thus are these things connected with each other.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 110. The Spiritual Hierarchies and Their Reflection in the Physical World. Zodiac, Planets, Cosmos. Lecture on 17th April 1909.

The physical form of man allows him to have the 'I'-consciousness on the Earth. All hierarchies of consciousness which are manifested in it are manifested in configurations of stars, planets, animals, plants and minerals too. Physical form of modern man is only one of all possible forms in which man can have the 'I'-consciousness. All possibilities of manifestation of such forms are in his individuality. In antiquity the connection of individuality with the form of manifestation of man on the Earth was designated in form of cosmic man inscribed in the animal circle - Zodiac. Each part of human form was drawn to the corresponding constellation of animal circle from which acted Thrones, Cherubims and Seraphims. Thus, one has giant cosmic man from whom every single man has got his physical form.

<i>Constellations of Zodiac</i>	<i>Members of human form</i>
Aries, Ram	Head
Taurus, Bull	Neck
Gemini, Twins	Arms
Cancer, Crab	Breast
Leo, Lion	Heart
Virgo, Maiden	Stomach
Libra, Scales	Pelvic gridle
Scorpio, Scorpion, Eagle	Genitals
Sagittarius, Archer	Thighs
Capricorn, Sea-Goat	Knees
Aquarius, Water-Bearer, Man	Low legs
Pisces, Fish	Feet

Which form of manifestation modern man has, depends on his level of consciousness, and in the future, with the alteration of his consciousness, the form of his manifestation will change as well. In order man could have the form of physical body and to be conscious of physical space and time, interaction of all hierarchies of consciousness is necessary. The highest level of consciousness among the hierarchies, have Seraphims, Cherubims and Thrones. Above their consciousness there is level of consciousness of Trinity which is designated as Father, Son and Holy Spirit and it is where plan of the development of the world structure comes from.

Man is born in physical body in the certain family, folk, country and during certain time epoch. He does not notice that his whole life is connected with life of the hierarchies of consciousness. His personal life is connected with Angels, which are usually called the Guardian Angels. Life of whole folk depends on Archangels, and influences of Archai are manifested in peculiarity of the rhythm of time in which man is born on the Earth. In the state of consciousness after death man directly perceives the interaction of the hierarchies of consciousness. Instead of movement of the planets of Solar system he experiences the interaction of Spirits of Form, Spirits of Movement and Spirits of Wisdom. Life of the star systems, such as Solar system, appears to him as the manifestation of Spirits of Will, Spirits of Harmony and Spirits of Love. The highest consciousness of Trinity is manifested in life of the whole world structure.

When life of man after death extends up to life of the Trinity, then man has consciousness in causal body. In this state of consciousness man can perceive the free choice which has led to creation of Karma. Now he cannot change his Karma, because it has been created in other state of consciousness on the Earth. However he can make free choice which prepares new conditions for the correction of Karma on the Earth. His free choice leads to the changes in whole Cosmos, which are directed to the creation of such conditions. Man himself interacting with the hierarchies of consciousness prepares conditions for the birth and life in physical body on the Earth in correspondence with his Karma and rhythm of development of consciousness of mankind.

The purpose of incarnation of man in physical body on the Earth is the development of his 'I'-consciousness. Besides already mentioned seven types of consciousness of man, Rudolf Steiner specifies other five stages which will be reached by man in future rhythms of the development of consciousness of mankind:

There are seven grades of human consciousness: trance consciousness, deep sleep, dream consciousness, waking consciousness, psychic, super-psychic and spiritual consciousness. Actually these are in all twelve stages of consciousness; the five others are creative stages of

consciousness. They are those of the Creators, of the creative Gods. These twelve stages are related to the twelve signs of the Zodiac.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 93a. Foundations of Esotericism.
Lecture on 26th September 1905.

The stage of consciousness of the creative gods is the stage of consciousness of the heavenly hierarchies, and the higher is the level of consciousness of the hierarchies, the more powerful are beings of the hierarchies. Their power is manifested in the ability to give. Man learns to attain such power when he brings the ability to take in accordance with the ability to give. For this purpose it is necessary for him to pass through the school of life in physical body on the Earth.

The eighth sphere

The septenary rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind is manifested in every state of consciousness, life and form. This is reflected in seven members of man, which are manifested as relations between the hierarchies of consciousness owing to the free choice of personalities in the states of consciousness Saturn, Sun, Moon and Earth. In each of these states the development of consciousness goes through seven states called the states of life. The state of life is called *Round* in theosophy. Each state of life passes through seven states of form too. The state of form is called *Globe* in theosophy. Thus, personalities go through the development of $7 \times 7 \times 7 = 343$ states of form. The number 777 *seven-seven-seven* is called the number of evolution and in this sense the number 444 *four-four-four* will be the number of present state of the evolution of Earth. Concerning the states of forms this number signifies the middle of the development of the Earth state of consciousness.

As our Earth was in the middle point of its evolution, when our Earth had passed through the three planetary stages of Saturn, Sun, Moon, and as it had reached the fourth planetary state, having in front of it the states of Jupiter, Venus and Vulcan (as Earth, therefore, it is in the middle of its existence) - it had to pass through three "states of life" (also called "Rounds"). It has passed through three of these states of life and is now in the fourth; it has passed through three "states of form" - the arupic, the rupic, and the astral, until it has come to physical existence. Therefore in respect of the "states of form", our Earth is in the middle of its evolution.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 102. The Influence of Spiritual Beings in Man.
Lecture on 27th January 1908.

All rhythms of consciousness, life and form are manifested together. Therefore personalities which were not able to develop proper their 'I'-consciousness in the previous states in time, have possibility to continue the development of consciousness in the following states. However as relations between the states of consciousness owing to free choice of personalities change, personalities not always can develop the 'I'-consciousness by themselves. There could be manifested such relations between the consciousness of personalities and hierarchies that for the stayed behind personality it becomes impossible to develop the 'I'-consciousness, supported only by its own consciousness. The connection with beings, manifested due to free choice, does not allow the stayed behind personality to direct its own forces to the development of the 'I'-consciousness.

This is one type of staying behind the development of consciousness of mankind. Personalities want to develop themselves, but cannot because of the connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. Such personalities become the bearers of evil by virtue of their separation from mankind through connection with beings. They can be helped by other personalities, whose consciousness is higher than the level of consciousness of beings with

which the stayed behind personalities are connected. The other type of staying behind appears when personalities can change their connection with beings of the hierarchies, but do not want it to do. The stayed behind personalities become not only the bearer of evil, but evil itself. Such state of consciousness that will appear between the stayed behind personalities and beings of the hierarchies, is characterized by the number *six-six-six* 666. This means personalities can become evil itself when they will pass through the development of $6*6*6 = 216$ states of form.

The following Jupiter state of consciousness will be the fifth of seven states. In the 6th state of consciousness, the Venus state of consciousness, in the 6th state of life and in the 6th state of form, when personalities will pass through the development of 216 states of forms, consciousness of the stayed behind personalities will develop such form of separation from mankind, that they become evil itself. This state of separation is called the *eighth sphere*, or *hell*, and the number 666 is called the *critical number* of evolution. In Apocalypse of St. John this number is referred to as the *number of animal*, or the *number of the beast*. The number *six-six-six* designates also Sorat. It is the name of personality which in the Sun state of the development of consciousness was the opponent of Jesus Christ. Sorat will be the leading personality of the eighth sphere.

The personal message

You yourself chose, with which consciousness and on which level of consciousness your personality will be manifested, when you made first free choice. You have made your first free choice together with other personalities. Your free choice has allowed other personalities to have higher consciousness, than yours. You have passed through the development of various states of consciousness, life and form before you had possibility to develop the 'I'-consciousness by yourself. Now the manifestation of good and evil in the manifested world structure depends on your free choice of the development of the 'I'-consciousness.

The main conclusions

The evolution begins, when single personalities make their first free choice. All personalities have made the first free choice together. All personalities were manifested in three kingdoms of: Michael, Lucifer and Uriel. In the beginning of evolution Lucifer had the highest consciousness among personalities. The free choice of Lucifer allows personality in his kingdom to develop the 'I'-consciousness through the manifestation and experience of good and evil. Evil is the untimely good. Devil signifies *fallen God*. Satan signifies those one who *separates from God*. The hierarchies of consciousness are subdivided into three hierarchies: (I) Seraphims, Cherubims, Thrones; (II) Dominions, Might, Powers; (III) Archai, Archangels, Angels. The evolution of consciousness of personality occurs through rhythms, which mankind became conscious of in the state of involution. The rhythm of trinity is manifested in all beings as consciousness, life and form. In the kingdom of Lucifer personalities develop their consciousness through seven states of consciousness: Saturn, Sun, Moon, Earth, Jupiter, Venus, Vulcan. To be man means to have the 'I'-consciousness. In the Saturn state of consciousness the 'I'-consciousness was developed by personalities on the level of consciousness of Archai, Beginnings. In the Sun state of consciousness the 'I'-consciousness was developed by personalities on the level of consciousness of Archangels. During the Moon state of consciousness the 'I'-consciousness developed personalities on the level of consciousness of Angels. The first war in heavens was waged in the Moon state of consciousness. The Moon state of consciousness is *Cosmos of wisdom*. Man develops the 'I'-consciousness in the Earth state of consciousness on the Earth planet. Each state of consciousness has seven states of life. Each state of life comprises seven states of form.

Personalities pass through the development of $7*7*7 = 343$ states of form. The critical number of evolution 666 will be reached, when personalities will pass through the development of $6*6*6 = 216$ states of form. In this state of consciousness the stayed behind personalities become evil itself and will form the eighth sphere, or hell. The leading personality of the eighth sphere will be Sorat.

Chapter 4

The cosmos of love

What will occur to those personalities which become evil themselves and will form the eighth sphere, or hell? Whether these sinners will stay in the hell for ever? Because the answer to these questions is connected with the development of consciousness of man in the Earth state of consciousness it is necessary to consider the evolution of this state of consciousness in more detail.

Man, as a rule, does not pay attention to that he continuously makes free choice. He must make it because in his freedom of choice is manifested the freedom of choice of the absolute Spirit. Intention or will not to make free choice is a choice already. The free choice of man manifests relations with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. To manifest relations with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness means an exchange of consciousness. Life in the manifested world structure in general can take place only through an exchange of consciousness between personalities and the hierarchies of consciousness. The consequence of such exchange of consciousness is that beings of the hierarchies of consciousness get possibility to influence free choice of personality. As the result personalities can stay behind in the development of the 'I'-consciousness, identifying themselves with that form of manifestation which proceeds from relations with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness.

An example of such identification is identification of oneself with physical body. This leads to that, that man interprets the world which surrounds him, only as the world of material objects. As result there appears the view of materialism which in paradoxical way derives consciousness from that, what has no consciousness at all, from unconscious matter. From here also follows the view, that those change of consciousness which is called death, is destruction of consciousness because death must lead to the return to unconscious matter. Man without physical body cannot be perceived by physical sense organs. However this must not necessarily mean that dead man has no consciousness at all.

Everything what is manifested is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness. In this sense matter as substance, is manifestation of such beings of the hierarchies, whose consciousness, life and form are manifested in equal proportions. That the hierarchies of consciousness have no freedom of choice is interpreted in the view of materialism as unconsciousness of matter. This allows ascribe all to the material profit, justifying egoistical choice which, in fact, leads to manifestation of evil. The only reality of materialism is unconscious matter from which consciousness appears and into which consciousness is dissolved again. It is logical, that in such a view profit is more justified, than morality.

Man, making his free choice, can identify himself with physical body in such a degree, that he completely rejects possibility of existence of his own 'I' without physical body. There comes a state in which man cannot develop his 'I'-consciousness any more without assistance of personalities with higher consciousness, than consciousness of beings which influence free choice of man. Assistance consists in, not breaking the freedom of choice of man, to counterbalance relations with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness in such a way, that man could develop his 'I'-consciousness. Free choice of other personalities can also influence the staying behind development of the 'I'-consciousness of man. If in the kingdom of Lucifer there was no possibility to manifest evil, then man would have completely other Karma at all. Therefore connection of man with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness, a possibility of which has appeared owing to free choice of other personalities, in particular of Lucifer and Ahriman, it is possible to counterbalance. However one's own Karma can be counterbalanced only by personality itself.

The staying behind of personalities in the development of their 'I'-consciousness occurs constantly. Also a help to personalities in the development of their consciousness is constantly carried out. To this help refer, for example, the ancient Indian writings where it is said about Avatars. The concept of *Avatar* means incarnation of personality, which incarnate in form most suitable for help to the development of the 'I'-consciousness of personalities. The Indian philosophy points out to Avatar as incarnation of deity *Vishnu*. This means that conscious free choice of Avatar-personality corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. The higher is consciousness of personality, the more free choice of personality will be agreed with free choice of other personalities. Consciousness of personality which is incarnated as Avatar on the Earth is developed so high, that incarnation in physical body is not necessary for personality itself. Avatar-personality is able to develop its 'I'-consciousness without incarnation in physical body. Personality is incarnated as Avatar in order to help the development of the 'I'-consciousness of mankind. No personal benefit or award is expected by Avatar-personality from incarnation in physical body. Therefore incarnation of Avatar-personality is a sacrifice which is made for all mankind.

It is necessary to make distinction between birth and incarnation or embodiment in physical body. The birth in physical body is not the only possibility of incarnation in physical body. If consciousness of personality is developed in such degree, that it is able consciously control processes of physical body, then for incarnation of such personality it is not necessary to be born in physical body. Such personality can be incarnated in physical body when some man in physical body makes free choice to leave it and to provide it for incarnation of other personality. This is one kind of incarnation without birth in physical body. Another kind of incarnation without birth occurs, when man in physical body makes free choice to allow other personality with higher consciousness to act through his consciousness in physical body. Depending on the level of consciousness of man personality can act in the etheric body, astral body or through the 'I' of man.

The four sacrifices of Christ

Avatar-personality with the highest consciousness which was ever incarnated in physical body on the Earth is Jesus Christ. The peculiarity of personality of Jesus Christ is that it was incarnated in physical body only once. Other Avatar-personalities can be incarnated in physical body several times. Considering formally, in the New Testament are described events which lead Jesus from Nazareth to crucifixion, death and resurrection. It is quite obvious, however, that if modern man will die through crucifixion that hardly will increase the level of consciousness of mankind. Hence, death of Jesus from Nazareth on the cross must differ from death of modern man.

The main difference is, that all processes of alteration of consciousness which are entailed with death, are not controlled by modern man because they are not conscious to him. On the thirtieth year of life, beginning from the baptism in Jordan, in the body of Jesus from Nazareth acted individuality which is called Christ. The moment of baptism signifies the moment of incarnation of Christ in physical body of Jesus from Nazareth. This was not incarnation through birth in physical body. Personality which was born in physical body of Jesus from Nazareth and which has attained very high level of consciousness to his thirtieth year of life has left his physical body consciously and provided it to personality of Christ. Rudolf Steiner calls this personality *Zarathustra*:

I would like especially emphasize, that I speak about Zarathustra as of that being whose existence was already placed by Greeks in the time of five thousand years before the Trojan war and which has, thus, nothing to do with those one, who is designated as Zarathustra by

outward history, and also nothing to do with those one, who is mentioned as Zarathustra in the time of Darius.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 123. The Gospel of St. Matthew.
Lecture on 1st September 1910.

Since baptism in Jordan Jesus Christ was fully conscious of the processes of life in physical, etheric and astral body of Jesus from Nazareth. Jesus Christ has passed through death being completely conscious of all processes of death. Up to Jesus Christ this was not possible for personality which was incarnated in physical body. Why is it so difficult to achieve? As all what is manifested has consciousness, so also the Earth planet is conscious being. Physical body of man is part of consciousness of the Earth planet, and thus is part of physical body of the Earth planet also. In order to be conscious of all processes of death of physical body, it is necessary to have consciousness of the level of consciousness of the Earth planet. Up to Jesus Christ no personality had such level of consciousness. Having passed through the death consciously, Jesus Christ, in as much as it was possible for personality at all, has encompassed with his consciousness the consciousness of the Earth planet. The processes which occur on the Earth planet owing to free choice of man are conscious to Jesus Christ through alterations in consciousness of the Earth. Therefore crucifixion continues, when free choice of man on the Earth planet leads to any manifestation of evil.

Jesus Christ not only has passed through death consciously, but he consciously submitted himself to free choice of men that lead him to sufferings, crucifixion and death. He, together with the Earth planet, experienced results of the choice of man. The Earth planet, which has not freedom of choice, cannot interfere with free choice of man. Jesus Christ was able not to obey to free choice of other men which doomed him to sufferings. However then he would not experience consciousness of the Earth planet, but rather the influence of his own choice on consciousness of the Earth planet. Therefore, if he has not obeyed to free choice of men he could not attain level of consciousness of the Earth planet. That is very great sacrifice. To imagine sufferings which Jesus Christ has experienced it is hardly possible for modern man, because it is hardly possible for modern man to imagine level of consciousness of the Earth planet. However not all is so hopeless, as it would seem to be, because mankind is one unity. From unity of mankind follows the law which it is possible to express with the following words: *"If certain level of consciousness was reached by one personality it becomes available to other personalities also"*. Therefore possibility to attain the level of consciousness of Jesus Christ exists for every personality. The specified law is valid for consciousness of both good and evil. Rudolf Steiner points out to this law with the following words:

Such is the law of the evolution of mankind. Once something must be (stand) there in completely comprehensive sense in one personality, then it flows into mankind little by little, even also only throughout the thousands of years, so that all men can take up this impulse and develop these faculties.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 123. The Gospel of St. Matthew.
Lecture on 7th September 1910.

The necessity of incarnation of Avatar-personalities is determined by possibility to change the level of consciousness of mankind. After incarnation in physical body and after death of the physical body of Jesus from Nazareth, Jesus Christ with his consciousness could penetrate consciousness of the Earth. The new incarnations of Jesus Christ in physical body would not change the level of consciousness of mankind, for consciousness of the Earth planet is already permeated by his consciousness. Therefore Jesus Christ was incarnated in physical body only once. In the history of mankind repeatedly occurred, that some man claims he is, as it were, the resurrected Jesus Christ. The tragedy of such man and his followers is that they do not know what the resurrection really means.

It is possible to give many correct explanations to the resurrection of Christ which will only complement each other. One of them is that Jesus Christ has passed through the death of physical body consciously and has encompassed consciousness of the Earth planet with his consciousness. In such a way, physical body of the Earth is penetrated by consciousness of Christ and since then it is possible to perceive Christ on the Earth supersensibly. Nowhere in the Bible is said, that described events are perceived by the physical sense organs of perception only. In the New Testament it is described namely the supersensible perception of the resurrection of Christ. Every man can perceive Christ directly if he has corresponding level of consciousness.

The resurrection also means that for the first time consciousness of one personality has penetrated into kingdoms of Michael, Lucifer and Uriel. Before the event on Golgotha no personality had such consciousness. For the first time one personality has attained consciousness which is able to encompass the influences of all personalities in all three kingdoms. Jesus Christ has resurrected with consciousness of personality most approached to consciousness of the whole mankind. Yogi Ramacharaka describes, that Jesus Christ has reached so high consciousness that he was ready to merge himself with the absolute Spirit:

The Occult Teachings tell us that Jesus, after His final disappearance from before the eyes of His apostles, passed on to the higher planes of the Astral World where He rapidly discarded all of His astral and mental vehicles which the soul had used in its manifestation. The Astral Body and its corresponding higher sheaths were cast off and discarded. That is, all except the very highest of all. Had He discarded every vestige of individual soul-existence His spirit would have immediately merged itself with the One Spirit - the Absolute - from which it had originally proceeded and Jesus, as an entity, would have disappeared entirely within the Ocean of the One Spirit. This highest state of all He had deliberately resigned until the passage of ages, in order that He might accomplish His work as the World-Savior.

Yogi Ramacharaka. Mystic Christianity. Or, The Inner Teachings of the Master.
Ninth Lesson. The Inner Teachings.

An opinion, that one personality can merge itself with the Absolute independent from other personalities, is based on misunderstanding. To merge with the Absolute means to reach consciousness of oneself as the absolute Spirit. Before one personality can reach consciousness of the absolute Spirit, it must reach consciousness of mankind. However consciousness of mankind it is possible to reach only by all personalities together. No personality can exist independent from mankind. Therefore to merge with the Absolute can only all personalities together.

Before the event on Golgotha Lucifer was personality with the highest consciousness among all personalities. However Lucifer did not possess consciousness leading to unity of all personalities. The free choice of Lucifer has removed restrictions on the freedom of choice of personality in his kingdom and thus has deprived him of possibility to balance relations between the hierarchies of consciousness and consciousness of personality in his kingdom. Jesus Christ has resurrected with consciousness, which is able to balance those relations which were manifested owing to the free choice of Lucifer and Ahriman. Jesus Christ could attain the highest consciousness among personalities because his free choice of the development of consciousness leads to unity of all personalities. Thereby Jesus Christ does not constrain the freedom of choice of personality.

The event on Golgotha is central event of the Earth state of consciousness. After Jesus Christ other personalities from kingdoms of Michael and Uriel also could reach the level of consciousness, which is higher than the level of consciousness of Lucifer. Jesus Christ is not the only personality with consciousness that encompasses all three kingdoms any more, but he is personality with the highest 'I'-consciousness. The results of free choice of personalities in all three kingdoms can be known to Jesus Christ. However the number of all personalities can

not be known even to him. Personality can become known to Jesus Christ only when it itself, without any compulsion, through its free choice, will establish connection with Christ. To establish connection with Christ to modern man it is possible on the Earth planet only. Christ has connected the development of his consciousness with the development of consciousness of man on the Earth planet, therefore man who looks for Christ, can find him on the Earth. If modern man who has passed through death and would like to establish connection with Christ, having missed such possibility during his life in physical body, then it will be necessary to him to be incarnated in physical body again.

The free choice of Jesus Christ has manifested such relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which are called *love*. Love is connected with freedom of choice. Being without freedom of choice always follows that consciousness which part it is of. Therefore love may be only the manifestation of free consciousness which leads to the unity of all beings. Because the free choice of Jesus Christ has elevated the level of consciousness of mankind and his consciousness become available to all personalities, then it leads to the unity of all personalities, and hence to the unity of all beings. Therefore the sacrifice of Christ is the sacrifice of love. Just as the Moon state of consciousness was the Cosmos of wisdom where personalities learned to manifest wisdom through their free choice, so also the Earth state of consciousness is the Cosmos of love where personalities learn to manifest love.

If we would seek on the old Moon for one property which we find today on our Earth in ever-increasing measure as the development of the Earth goes forward, we would not find this property belonging to beings of the Moon. This property is love - an impulse which, proceeding from the free will, leads beings to each other.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 102. The Influence of Spiritual Beings in Man.
Lecture on 24th March 1908.

If personality makes free choice which leads to unity of personalities in the Earth state of consciousness, then the result of this choice will be manifested in the following state of consciousness as love. Love will be manifested in surroundings of man in the Jupiter state of consciousness. In the Earth state of consciousness free choice of one personality can oppose free choice of other personality, as love and egoism. Egoism means manifestation of such relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which lead to separation of personalities from each other. Feelings, thoughts, willing, which without self-seeking lead to sympathy, compassion, experience by one personality of states of consciousness of other personality, lead also to love, because then consciousness of personalities become united through feelings, thoughts and willing. Personalities in the Earth state of consciousness through their experience of good and evil acquire experience to transform wisdom attained in the Moon state of consciousness into love. Thus, mission of the Earth state of consciousness is mission of love. The secret of this mission of the Earth is connected with establishment by personality of internal balance between forces of willing, feeling and thinking.

The secret of this mission expresses itself in such a way, that through this interaction, through this balance of the three forces, the inner being really creates something new. Thereby in addition to the three previous elements there will be truly created the fourth element, and this fourth element is the element of Love. Love can only develop in the world's affairs when an absolute balance comes in between the three forces, which in earlier times were alternately leading forces of the hegemony.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 121. The Mission of the Individual Folk-Souls In Connection with Teutonic Mythology.
Lecture on 11th June 1908.

<i>State of consciousness</i>	<i>Members of man</i>	<i>Forces of soul</i>
Saturn	Physical body	Willing

Sun	Etheric body	Feeling
Moon	Astral body	Thinking
Earth	'I' (Self)	Love

Christ helps mankind in the development of the 'I'-consciousness not for the first time. Although Christ was incarnated in physical body only once, he already was manifested earlier through beings of the heavenly hierarchies. This could be called as the *ensoulment* of Christ in the form of manifestation of Archangel, which was not physical. In order to imagine when it could be, it is necessary to consider, that time of the development of consciousness of man on the Earth must be measured not by years, but rather by rhythms during which the level of consciousness of mankind changes. Such rhythm is the *septenary* rhythm, which is manifested in each of the states of consciousness, life and form.

Modern man develops his 'I'-consciousness in the fourth, the Earth state of consciousness, in the fourth state of life and in the fourth state of form. In each state of form are manifested seven more periods of time. The development of the 'I'-consciousness of man occurs now in the fifth period which is called *Continental*. The first period is called *Polar*, the second – *Hyperborean*, the third – *Lemurian*, the fourth – *Atlantic*. The sixth and seventh periods are specified in the Apocalypse of St. John as the time of *opening of seals* (6:1-8:1) and of *soundings of trumpets* (8:2-11:15). In the theosophy these seven periods are called *root races*.

The periods of the 4-th state of consciousness, 4-th state of life, 4-th state of form:

1. The Polar period
2. The Hyperborean period
3. The Lemurian period
4. The Atlantean period
5. The Continental, Post-Atlantean period
6. The period of the opening of seals
7. The period of the sounding of trumpets

Each of these seven periods, is subdivided in its turn into seven other sub-periods during which the level of consciousness of mankind changes. The sub-period is called *sub-race* in theosophy, and *culture period* in anthroposophy. Present time corresponds to fifth culture period which is called *European*. The first culture period is called *Pre-Indian*, the second – *Pre-Persian*, the third – *Egyptian-Chaldaic--Babylonian*, the fourth – *Greco-Latin* culture period. Rudolf Steiner describes them in the following way:

The successive Post-Atlantean cultures were as follows:

First: The Pre-Vedic culture in the south of Asia and in India. That was the beginning of the Aryan culture.

Second: The epoch of Zoroaster, comprising the culture of ancient Persia.

Third: The Egyptian culture, the epoch of Hermes, to which the Chaldean and Semitic cultures are linking. The first germs of Christianity were laid down in the bosom of the Hebrew peoples in this time epoch.

Fourth: The Greco-Latin culture epoch, which has experienced the birth of Christianity.

Fifth: A new epoch is prepared at the time of the migrations of the peoples and of the voyages of conquest. The heritage of the Greco-Latin culture was taken over by the races of the North: the Celts, the Germanic peoples and the Slavs. It is the epoch, in which we are still living now.

The seven culture periods are characterized in the Apocalypse of St. John through *letters* (messages) to *communities* (churches) (2:1-3:22). Rudolf Steiner calls future sixth culture period *Slavic*, and the seventh – *American* culture period.

Culture periods of the Continental period:

1. The Pre-Indian, ancient Indian culture period
2. The Pre-Persian, ancient Persian culture period
3. The Assyrian-Babylonian-Chaldaic-Egyptian-Hebrew culture period
4. The Greco-Latin culture period
5. The European culture period
6. The Slavic culture period
7. The American culture period

The first three periods: Polar, Hyperborean and Lemurian were peculiar recapitulations of the Saturn, Sun and Moon states of consciousness. During these periods of the development stayed behind personalities had opportunity to continue development of the 'I'-consciousness. In Polar period the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness of the Saturn, Sun and Moon states were manifested together, as one state. In Hyperborean period those relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which modern man calls Sun, and in the Lemurian period also those, which are called Moon now were manifested separated from each other.

Those relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which modern man calls Sun, Moon, Mercury, Venus, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn were manifested because there has come condition when some personalities could develop the 'I'-consciousness corresponding to rhythm of the development of mankind, and other personalities stayed behind. The difference in levels of consciousness became so large, that neither progressed forward, nor stayed behind in the development of consciousness personalities could not develop consciousness together any more, not violating the freedom of choice of each other. The consequence of this was that Christ, together with personalities with the highest level of consciousness, manifested for the development of their consciousness those relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which are called now Sun. In other words, the Sun withdrew itself from the Earth.

As regards spiritual activities it is not our Sun at all which stands in the centre of the system, but the Earth. Therefore, all the ages which have regarded spiritual development as the most essential part, have said: Certainly the Sun is a far nobler heavenly body, Beings have evolved upon it who stand higher than man; but what is important in the development is man, who lives upon the Earth. And when the Sun separated itself from the Earth, it did so in order that man could develop in the right way. If the Sun had remained united to the Earth man could never have been able to development at the right tempo. This was possible only because the Sun withdrew along with those Beings who could bear quite different conditions. It left the Earth to itself, so to speak, so that man might set his tempo of the development.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 110. The Spiritual Hierarchies and Their Reflection in the Physical World. Zodiac, Planets, Cosmos. Lecture on 15th April, 1909.

The further difference in levels of consciousness of personalities leads to manifestation of those relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which correspond to the modern Moon. The Moon separated itself from the Earth and other planets separated themselves from Sun and Moon. Thus, the Earth, Sun and other planets which modern man sees with physical eyes, represent external expression of relations between consciousness of personalities and hierarchies.

In Lemurian period that personality, which is called Jehova, makes free choice to act from the Moon in order to help the development of consciousness of man on the Earth. The level of consciousness of Jehova was high enough to develop his consciousness together with personalities which withdrew the Sun from the Earth. Jehova acted in such a way that man could have physical form which most protects him from direct connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness and, thus, promoted the development of his 'I'-consciousness. Owing to influence of Jehova man on the Earth has physical form which allows him to develop the 'I'-consciousness by himself since the Lemurian period. This influence promoted also that free choice of man is restricted by this form. As a result man perceives the world that surrounds him as the world of separated objects, rejecting perception of existence of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. In this sense Jehova and Ahriman act together limiting perception of man by perception of separated objects only.

The first sacrifice of Christ

As Lucifer could not counterbalance the result of free choice of personalities, not violating their freedom of choice any more, this must be made by Christ. In the Lemurian period Christ has managed to counterbalance relations between the hierarchies of consciousness manifested as organs of perception of man. Irrespective of whether beings of the hierarchies of consciousness, manifested in sense organs of man, perceive pleasure or pain themselves, the result of perception is passed to consciousness of man most neutrally and impartially. Man can perceive suffering in organs of perception during illness or by damage of organs of perception. If first sacrifice of Christ has not counterbalanced relations between the hierarchies of consciousness in the astral body of man, then man would perceive extremely strong pleasure and extremely strong pain alternatively. Using such sense organs, man could not develop his 'I'-consciousness unbiasedly. Free choice of man would be strongly affected by excessive consciousness of single organs of perception.

While the Earth was working through the Lemurian age, a Being living in spiritual heights became manifest - one might say, as a sort of prophecy of John's baptism - in an Archangel who sacrificed his soul powers, and was thus permeated by the Christ. Through this means a force was released that acted within human evolution upon Earth. Its effect was a quieting and harmonizing of senses. And if today we can use the senses so that they are selfless, then we, understanding this fact, have become grateful to the world order, we shall say, looking back to these ancient times, that what makes it possible for us as sensory beings to perceive not the pain through these senses, but the splendour of nature around us, is based on the first sacrifice of Christ. By ensouling Himself in an Archangel He brought forth the activity, which averted from the development of mankind the danger of selfishness of senses. That was the first pre-stage of the Mystery of Golgotha.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 152. Preliminary stages to the Mystery of Golgotha.
The Four Sacrifices of Christ. Basel, 1st Juni 1914.

The second sacrifice of Christ

In a similar way to the harmonizing of organs of perception in the Lemurian period, during the Atlantic period have been balanced relations between the hierarchies of consciousness manifested as the inner organs of man. The result of second sacrifice of Christ consists in that man usually does not notice, that his inner organs, such as stomach, lungs, liver, kidneys and so on, have their own consciousness. Their consciousness becomes noticed, when man feels pain or disorder in these organs.

If would be fulfilled what Lucifer and Ahriman wanted, if man had been relied only on his own, so he would have been chased about the world by animal lusts for what satisfied one organ or another, or by terrible disgust for all what was harmful. Imagine if we were to be placed in this world with such bodily organs so, that we were a plaything in the highest degree for every pleasant aroma that we would run after even if it is an hour away from us, or were forced by nausea to flee from far away from it. If we were tossed to and fro like a rubber ball, think of it, how we could possibly develop ourselves in this world? That this did not happen, that our vital organs were soften and harmonized, it is the consequence of that, that in the time when man was passing through the first Atlantean development, in supra-terrestrial (supramundane) spheres, the second pre-stage of the Mystery of Golgotha has happened. The Christ Being ensouled Himself in an Archangel-Being again, and what was accomplished by this deed shone down into atmosphere of the Earth. It took place that harmonizing of vital organs, that softening of vital organs which made them selfless.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 152. Preliminary stages to the Mystery of Golgotha.
The Four Sacrifices of Christ. Basel, 1st June 1914.

The third sacrifice of Christ

The third sacrifice of Christ during the Atlantic period has balanced relations between the hierarchies of consciousness manifested as thinking, feeling and willing. Balance between thinking, feeling and willing as activities of the rational, sentient and conscious soul, allows man to be free in his soul life. Without third incarnation of Christ man would become dependent from feelings, ideas and willing so, that he could not control them. He would be subdued any feeling, idea and willing which proceed not from his free consciousness, but from his connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness.

In the last periods of the Atlantean development mankind faced a third danger. Thinking, feeling and willing were threatened with disorder. Selfishness would enter in thinking, feeling and willing. What would have been the result of this? Well, man would have intended this or that, and followed this or that impulse of will, while his thinking would follow a different impulse, and his feeling still another. It was necessary for the development of mankind that thinking, feeling and willing should become unselfish members of the entirety of soul. Under the influence of Lucifer and Ahriman they could not have done this. Thinking, feeling and willing, would become self-seeking, they would have rent asunder as it were the harmonious working of soul. Then, toward the end of the Atlantean development, the third Christ event occurred. Once more the Christ Being ensouled Himself in an Archangel-Being, and the power thus generated in the supra-terrestrial world, because of Christ permeated an Archangel-Being, made possible the harmonization of thinking, feeling and willing.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 152. Preliminary stages to the Mystery of Golgotha.
The Four Sacrifices of Christ. Basel, 1st Juni 1914.

The fourth sacrifice of Christ

The incarnation of Christ in physical body occurred in the fourth, Greco-Latin cultural period of the fifth Continental period. One of the previous incarnations of Christ in the form of Archangel took place in the Lemurian, and other two took place in the Atlantic period. As consciousness of Archangel does not require physical body, Christ was manifested not in physical body, but in the astral and etheric bodies. However these bodies still did not permeated physical body of the Earth planet. Before the event on Golgotha, Christ accomplished three sacrifices in the astral and etheric surroundings of the Earth planet. Owing to the incarnation of Christ in physical body there was provided possibility to attain harmony in the development of the 'I'-consciousness of man.

The fourth stage of the Mystery of Golgotha occurred at last. This Mystery of Golgotha averted another danger, a danger for the 'I' of man coming into disorder through influences of Lucifer and Ahriman. In the Lemurian age the sense organs would have come into disorder through Lucifer; in the first Atlantean period the vital, life organs were threatened with disorder and disharmony, and in the late Atlantean era the soul organs, the organs that underlie thinking, feeling and willing. In the post-Atlantean period the 'I' itself was endangered with disorder. Because the 'I' at this time was to take its place in human development, one looked for establishing of harmony between this 'I' and the powers of the cosmos in order that the 'I' would not become a plaything of the powers of cosmos. It might become a plaything between these powers. The 'I' might have so developed that it could not keep its Self in itself, and had it been delivered to these powers, everything that came from the soul would have been rapt away by all elemental forces that come from wind, air, swell or waters. They would have rapt away man everywhere.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 152. Preliminary stages to the Mystery of Golgotha.
The Four Sacrifices of Christ. Basel, 1st Juni 1914.

The fourth sacrifice of Christ is the central event of the development of the Earth state of consciousness because it provides possibility to each man through becoming conscious of Christ in his own being to attain consciousness of himself as the absolute Spirit. If Christ did not managed to balance relations between the hierarchies of consciousness in the 'I'-consciousness of man, then dependence of man on consciousness of single beings of the hierarchies of consciousness would lead to that, that he could not become conscious of himself as the absolute Spirit. In order, that it would not occurred, other personality should make even higher sacrifice, than Christ has made. Without the fourth sacrifice of Christ consciousness of the Earth could not support relations between the hierarchies of consciousness in physical body of man and man could not be incarnated in physical body on the Earth planet any more. Consciousness of modern man is still insufficiently developed to become conscious of himself as the 'I' in the etheric and astral body, therefore without possibility of the incarnation in physical body he could not develop the 'I'-consciousness. As Jesus Christ has encompassed consciousness of the Earth, then the Earth through consciousness of Christ has received opportunity to support relations of the hierarchies of consciousness in physical body of man and man has received further possibility to be incarnated in physical body on the Earth planet and thus to develop consciousness of himself as the absolute Spirit. In this sense Jesus Christ is *saviour* of mankind.

Through balancing influence of Christ man has received opportunity to retain his health. If man experiences extremely strong suffering or pleasure constantly it means, that man is sick. Health means such relations between the hierarchies of consciousness and man which are balanced. This is possible when the hierarchies of consciousness are able to correct disturbances caused by free choice of man. By balancing those relations between hierarchies of consciousness and man, which arisen due to free choice of Lucifer and Ahriman, Christ provides possibility to man, through free choice, to create new relations which are balanced. When free choice of man establishes such connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness which does not allow restore balance any more, there comes dependence on beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. Single beings of the hierarchies of consciousness become more conscious in man, than it is necessary for restoration of balance. Man experiences availability of connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness through pleasure and suffering. If man strives to feel pleasure constantly, then sooner or later balance will be disturbed, and there comes unhealthy condition. Pleasure and suffering as result of exchange of consciousness of man with consciousness of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness, are integral parts of the evolution of consciousness. Lust, however, is not such necessary part. Striving for repetition of pleasure is *lust*, or *addiction*. In other words, striving

for pleasure just for the sake of it is lust. To lusts belong, for example, use of alcohol, tobacco, drugs. Typical kind of lust is striving to have sex just for the sake of pleasure. The dependence on regular drinking of coffee also is sign of availability of lust. Lust appears not only from use of substances or liquids. Lust of power, wealth, profit and so on, also belong to typical lusts of modern man.

Lust makes man dependent on such beings of the hierarchies of consciousness which influence the development of the 'I'-consciousness. Striving for satisfaction of lusts in physical body contributes to identification of man with his physical body. Man pays off for lust with his freedom of the development of the 'I'-consciousness. It is necessary to notice, that freedom from lusts does not mean refusal of pleasure or suffering. Pleasure and suffering are necessary parts of the evolution of consciousness. Refusal of pleasure or suffering would mean refusal of the development of consciousness through free choice. Freedom from lusts means freedom from striving for pleasure. Striving for pleasure leads to suffering. Man, who is free from lusts, is able to make free choice which does not depend on pleasure or suffering more consciously. Such man will not identify himself with physical body and become able to perceive his previous incarnations. Therefore in all religions and spiritual schools existed methods of purification from lusts. Awareness of availability of lusts by oneself already promotes the development of the 'I'-consciousness of man. Purification from lusts is necessary step in the development of the supersensible organs of perception. To perceive supersensibly in the etheric and astral bodies, it is necessary that in the etheric and astral organs of perception there is no lust. Otherwise man would perceive relations between the hierarchies of consciousness distorted by his own lusts, what leads to illusions. Physical organs of perception allow reduce influence of lusts maximally, therefore man can develop the 'I'-consciousness in physical body best of all. Physical body, on the one hand, provides protection of man against direct perception of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness, and on the other hand, provides possibility to man to identify his 'I' with it.

The war of all against all

Christ does not violate the freedom of choice of man. Which relations will be manifested by man with the hierarchies of consciousness, depends on his free choice. Despite of first three sacrifices of Christ, free choice of man in Lemurian and Atlantic periods led to catastrophes which ended both periods. As all, what is manifested possesses consciousness, there is nothing occasional. Any catastrophe occurs as result of free choice of man. When connections of personalities with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness do not correspond to rhythm of the development any more, there comes imbalance between consciousness of personalities and rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Personalities become unable to develop their 'I'-consciousness by themselves, because an exchange of consciousness with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness does not allow it any more. Such imbalance is expressed in sufferings which personalities experience. In the Lemurian and Atlantic periods sufferings of man were so strong, that man did not wish connections with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness any more. As man is free, only he himself can decide either to break or to keep connections with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. However when connections becomes so strong, that man makes choice to break them, but he cannot break them by himself, then connections will be broken through catastrophe. Catastrophe is a help, which breaks those connections of man with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness, which do not allow man to develop the 'I'-consciousness.

In both periods man manifested such relations with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness through his free choice that to restore balance could only catastrophe. In the Lemurian period lusts which man manifested as through outer, as well through inner organs of perception, caused fiery catastrophe. During this period for the first time appeared what is

called *black magic*, *black sorcery*. Black magic is such use of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness by man that violates the freedom of choice of others. During the Atlantic period black magic became so widespread, that it also has led to catastrophe. As result the whole continent, which Platon mentioned as *Atlantis*, was perished by water catastrophe.

Evolution is development therefore any rhythm of evolution will be substituted by other rhythm. The fourth Atlantic period of the development was followed by our fifth Continental period where man develops the 'I'-consciousness on various continents. In the previous periods of the development, mankind has not been separated by continents. The main evil of the fourth Atlantic period was black magic which led mankind to catastrophe. The main evil of the fifth Continental period is materialism as consequence of identification of oneself with physical body. The identification of oneself with physical body, in its turn, results from lusts satisfied through physical body. The materialism, through satisfaction of lusts in physical body, leads mankind to next catastrophe.

Mankind to the beginning of third millennium has saved up enough means to provide free knowledge, treatment and feed to each man. Up to the end of second millennium the accumulation of means corresponded to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind that is why it was justified. To the beginning of third millennium rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind has changed. There are already so much means, that their further accumulation becomes manifestation of lust of profit. Striving for satisfaction of lust of profit leads not only to achievement of personal pleasure of man, but also to sufferings of all mankind. Each man is forced to fight with other men for his own safe life in spite of the fact, that there are enough means for such life already for all. This fight for safe life, when there are enough means for safe life already for all, is called *the war of all against all*. With the change of rhythm of the development of consciousness, mankind entered into the war of all against all which leads mankind to catastrophe.

The involvement of modern man into the war of all against all can be exemplified by financial system manifested through network of banks. Banking itself is based on achievement of profit for the sake of profit. Profit may be used as for well-being of all and for increase of profit only. If profit is directed on satisfaction of lust of profit, then it does not correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind anymore and every man, whose money are used by bank, is joined to the war of all against all automatically. Only because some financial groups cannot agree among themselves and wage struggle in accumulation of means, mankind is involved in the war of all against all. Instead of directing means for creation of favourable conditions for the development of consciousness of personalities, means are used to increase means. Mankind becomes slave of bank system. Money, financial system, system of banks are not evil itself, but evil is created by use of these systems in such a way that does not correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind any more. This leads to manifestation of such conditions of life which man cannot sustain. Karma of men who by all means strive for ever greater profit, will inevitably lead them to experience such deprivations and sufferings to which other men are doomed. No accumulation of means can make someone safe from catastrophe.

Materialism is inasmuch evil as far it leads to separation of man from mankind through connection with Luciferic and Ahrimanic beings. Consciousness of Christ allows to balance both types of consciousness and to develop the 'I'-consciousness. Man has freedom of choice to develop Luciferic, Ahrimanic and Christian consciousness. The choice of satisfaction of lusts leads to development of Luciferic and Ahrimanic consciousness. The development of Christian consciousness through becoming conscious of oneself as integral part of mankind, leads to consciousness of oneself as the absolute Spirit. The present time corresponds to the fifth European cultural period of the development of the 'I'-consciousness. It will be followed by sixth and seventh culture period. The war of all against all, that begun in the fifth European

cultural period of the continental period of the development of the 'I'-consciousness of man is tending to end itself with catastrophe in the seventh American cultural period.

The struggle for accumulation of means leads to further technical progress the only objective of which is satisfaction of lusts. The technics will receive such impulse of development, that man will be compelled to live and work in rhythm of the Luciferic and Ahrimanic beings. The dependence of man on satisfaction of lusts through technics will lead to such rhythm of life, which man will not be able neither to sustain nor to change it by himself any more.

Dependence of man on satisfaction of lusts through technics could be illustrated by an example of man playing a computer game. At first man experiences great pleasure from game. Gradually rhythm of game is accelerated, tension increases, and man does not notice any more, that he gives all his power, all his energy, all his consciousness to the game. Man forgets the world that surrounds him, man forgets his 'I'. The objective of man becomes not to stay behind the game rhythm. The game itself has no much sense for the development of the 'I'-consciousness of man the only objective of game is attainment of pleasure. Man stops to play when he does not have enough power any more. After some rest man strives to look for even greater pleasure in game with other rhythm. If instead of game to understand manifestation of the Luciferic and Ahrimanic beings, which were manifested by man himself, then one has some remote concept about life in rhythm of the Luciferic and Ahrimanic beings.

Dependence of man on technics stands only at the beginning of its manifestation. Man is still able to sustain and change rhythm of life given by technics. The technics which will make rhythm of life unbearable for man is not manifested yet. However, possibility of manifestation of such development of technics is connected with the event which is the incarnation of Ahriman.

The incarnations of Lucifer, Christ, Ahriman

The embodiment or the incarnation of personality, beginning from level of consciousness of the hierarchy of Angel, differs from incarnation of modern man in physical body. Modern man is incarnated in physical body through birth. This occurs because man has Karma which he created through connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness on the Earth. Personality which in present time has no terrestrial Karma can be incarnated not through the birth. Christ has never created Karma on the Earth therefore the incarnation of Christ in physical body of Jesus from Nazareth occurred not through birth. Consciousness of Christ is significantly higher, than consciousness of Angel, therefore incarnation of Christ will differ from incarnation of modern man in physical body through birth. However, incarnation of Christ differs from incarnations of Lucifer and Ahriman also. Personality of Jesus from Nazareth left his physical body at the baptism on Jordan consciously and the individuality of Christ entered and dwelled in physical body of Jesus from Nazareth. By incarnation of Ahriman consciousness of man does not leave his physical body, but man becomes vehicle of consciousness of Ahriman. The same is true for incarnation of Lucifer. The relations between incarnations of Lucifer, Christ and Ahriman were described by Rudolf Steiner:

Just as there was an incarnation of Lucifer at the beginning of the third pre-Christian millennium, as there was the Christ Incarnation at the time of the Mystery of Golgotha, so there will be a Western incarnation of the Ahriman being some little time after our present earthly existence, approximately, in the third post-Christian millennium. In order to understand this process of the historical development of mankind during approximately six thousands of years properly, one must grasp that at the one pole stands a Luciferic incarnation, in the center, the incarnation of Christ, and at the other pole the Ahrimanic incarnation. Lucifer is such a power that stirs up all visionary, all falsely mystical forces in

man, all what physiologically tends to bring the blood into disorder and thus to elevate man beyond and out of himself. Ahriman is such a power that makes man dry, prosaic, philistine, ossifies man and brings him to the superstition of materialism. And the true nature and being of man is essentially the effort to hold the balance between the Luciferic and Ahrimanic powers; and the Christ Impulse helps present mankind to establish this balance.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 193. The inner aspects of social life. The luciferic past and ahrimanic future. Lecture on 27th October 1919.

There is something common not only to incarnations of Lucifer, Christ and Ahriman, but also to incarnations of personality whose level of consciousness is higher than level of consciousness of modern man. Every such incarnation manifests new possibilities for free choice which were not available to man before. The result of free choice of Lucifer, Christ and Ahriman creates possibility to manifest such relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which are available to every man in physical body. However in order these relations could become available to man in physical body, Lucifer, Christ and Ahriman must act through physical body of man also. Incarnation in physical body becomes necessary, because the influences of incarnation will be expanded then on the etheric body, astral body and the 'I' of every man through the hierarchies of consciousness, irrespective of where physical body of man could be. Lucifer, Christ and Ahriman can be incarnated in physical body, when some man voluntary, proceeding from his free choice will provide such possibility to them. The incarnation of personality through birth in physical body is necessary when personality still has Karma, created on the Earth. Lucifer, Christ and Ahriman never had such Karma, because they did not pass through the development of consciousness that man passes on the Earth. They are able to act through consciousness of personality, which is incarnated in physical body, directly. Let us consider the incarnation of Lucifer:

At the beginning of the third millennium a very momentous event took place. If one will to characterize where this dim, more instinctive life came from, then one may say, that soul-and-spirit being of men were still unable at that time to make use of the human organs of intellect. These organs were already available, they were formed in the physical being of man, but soul-and-spirit being could not make use of them. Thus men could not acquire any knowledge through their own thinking, through their own powers of intellectual discernment. They could acquire only that what was imparted to them from the Mysteries.

And then, about the beginning of the third millennium, a momentous event took place in the east of Asia. A child of a distinguished Asiatic family of the time was allowed to grow up in the surrounding of the Mystery ceremonies. Circumstances were such that this child was permitted to take part in the ceremonies, perhaps because the leading priests of the Mysteries felt it as an inspiration that such a child must be allowed to participate. And when the human being incarnate in that child had reached the age of about forty - approximately that age - something very remarkable came to light. It became evident - and it must be said that the priests of the Mysteries had foreseen the event prophetically - it became evident that this man who had been allowed to grow up in the surrounding of one of the Mystery centres in East Asia, began suddenly, at the age of about forty, to grasp through the faculty of human intellect a sense of what had formerly come into the Mysteries through revelation only. He was in a certain degree the first who was allowed to make use of the organs of human intellect, but still referring to the Mysteries.

Translating into terms of our present language how the priests of the Mysteries spoke of this matter, we must say: In this man, Lucifer himself was incarnated - no more and no less than that! It is a significant, momentous fact that in the third millennium before Christ an incarnation of Lucifer in the flesh really took place in the east of Asia. And from this incarnation of Lucifer in the flesh - for this personality became a teacher and taught - there

went forth what is described as the pre-Christian, pagan culture which still survived in the gnosis of the earliest Christian centuries.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 193. The inner aspects of social life. The luciferic past and ahrimanic future. Lecture on 4th November 1919.

Man, who chooses possibility to provide incarnation of other personality through himself has possibility to make free choice for this purpose two times. The first time it occurs before the birth of man in physical body, and the second time after his birth in physical body. Before the birth in physical body man perceives supersensibly, he is able to view all those possibilities of free choice that will be provided to him in physical body. He perceives the necessity of incarnation of other personality and possibility of granting such incarnation through himself. If man makes free choice to refuse to provide possibility of incarnation to other personality through himself before birth then personality does not address to man after his birth in physical body. Thus, relations between man and personality, which incarnates through man, are established before the birth of man. When modern man is born in physical body he ceases to be clairvoyant and is compelled to perceive the world of separate objects. This occurs because consciousness of man and the hierarchies of consciousness manifested as his etheric and physical body have now other relations to each other, than before birth. As a rule, several men perceive possibility for incarnation of personality through themselves. If one man refuses to provide possibility to Lucifer and Ahriman to incarnate through himself after birth, then it will be necessarily made by other man. This occurs because incarnations of Lucifer and Ahriman are necessary for manifestation of new possibilities of free choice of the development of the 'I'-consciousness in new rhythm in order to balance possibilities of choice of previous rhythms.

Ceremonies, rituals are carried out in the Mysteries in order to receive knowledge through connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. As knowledge can be used for manifestation of good as well as of evil, Mysteries were always secret. To participate in them it was allowed only to properly prepared man who has passed through tests confirming his ability to apply knowledge according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind and not for personal objectives. Because child can easily become dependent on connection with beings and thus can become vehicle of evil, children were not allowed to the Mysteries. That at that time a child was admitted to the Mysteries, not only once, but constantly, means something very extraordinary, namely that this child could counterbalance connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness by itself. When the child became mature man, he was addressed by Lucifer. By the time of the incarnation of Lucifer the level of consciousness of this man in physical body did not allow him to perceive Lucifer directly. The appellation of Lucifer was manifested in inspiration owing to which man has wished possibility to experience supersensible knowledge without ceremonies necessary in Mysteries. Knowledge which could be received in the Mysteries always corresponded to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Lucifer has allowed this man to have knowledge not only corresponding to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind, but also to have possibility of satisfaction of knowledge just for the sake of knowledge irrespective of whether this knowledge is actual or not for the development of consciousness of mankind. Lucifer in turn received opportunity through consciousness of this man to manifest new possibilities of free choice which counterbalanced influence of Jehova.

Influence of Jehova leads man to developing of the 'I'-consciousness through submission to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind, instead of making his own free choice between good and evil. Personalities which made choice to follow this influence separated that community which is known as the Hebrew people. The special mission of Hebrew people consisted in preparation of incarnation of Christ. Personalities which prepared incarnation of Christ were incarnated in the Hebrew folk. However as result of strong feeling of blood-kinship there appeared feeling of separation of the Hebrew people from other

peoples. Single member of the Hebrew people felt his own kinship with his own people only, instead of with all peoples. From here originates conception that Jehova which acted through Abraham and other ancestors is the only God of the Hebrew people.

Mankind proceeded from a unity, but previous development of Earth led to separation. In the Christ-concept is given an ideal that counteracts all separation, for in man who bears the name of Christ live also the forces of the exalted Sun Being in whom every human 'I' finds its origin. The Israelites felt themselves still as a folk, man as a member of this folk. Through comprehension of the fact first in thought that in the Christ Jesus lives the ideal man in whom no conditions of separation penetrate, Christianity became the ideal of an all-encompassing brotherhood. Disregarding all separate interests and separate relations, the feeling arose that the inmost 'I' of every man has the same origin. (Alongside all earthly forefathers the common father of all men appears. "I and the Father are One.")

Rudolf Steiner. GA 13. An Outline of Occult Science.
Chapter 4. The development of world and man.

Jesus Christ was first personality who in physical body possessed the highest consciousness of realization that the 'I' of every man is the absolute Spirit. Up to Jesus Christ such level of consciousness could be reached only outside physical body. This was known to priests of the Hebrew people also. It was also known that once personality, which will possess consciousness of unity of the 'I' of man and the absolute Spirit will be incarnated in the Hebrew people. Such personality must possess the highest consciousness among all personalities. However what could be a proof that some man has the highest consciousness? First of all, supersensible deeds of man, witness of man himself and witness of other men. The deeds and witness, which are described in the New Testaments, took place. However it was expected that man with highest consciousness will possess such supersensible power to become king not only of the Hebrew people, but also king of the whole world. The use of supersensible power for attainment of authority or for establishment of law leads to violation of the freedom of choice of man. Instead Jesus Christ let each man to make such free choice by himself without any compulsion that sets him in relations to the Christ. And in the New Testaments it is described, that the choice was made to sentence Jesus Christ to death.

To be consciousness of the 'I' of man as the absolute Spirit means first of all to be consciousness of the unity of all men. Consciousness of the unity of mankind did not find recognition by priests. The sacrifice of Christ was not understood in the Hebrew people. Religion of the Hebrew people remained religion of personality of Jehova as religion of God of the chosen Hebrew people. The consequences of this were counterbalanced through incarnation of Lucifer. Lucifer provided possibility for other peoples to understand Christ, and mankind received opportunity to have other religions, and not only religion of Jehova. As Rudolf Steiner describes it, the incarnation of Lucifer took place in China and promoted the development of culture of the Chinese people. Man, who provided possibility of incarnation to Lucifer through himself, developed his waking consciousness in physical body afterwards so far, that he knew, through him acts Lucifer.

The influence of Christ leads to the unity of all personalities irrespective of in what people personality is incarnated. As rhythm of the development of consciousness through Jehova was substituted by rhythm of the development of consciousness through Christ, the influence of Jehova began to correspond to the influence of Ahriman which leads to separation of personalities from each other. After the unacceptance of Christ the development of the Hebrew people lead to the incarnation of Ahriman. In the second half of the year 1999, in the age of about forty five years, one man in Northern America has reached such development of his consciousness, that he was addressed by Ahriman. As well as in the case of the incarnation of Lucifer, this man could not perceive Ahriman directly. But the address to him of Ahriman was manifested in the inspiration owing to which man has wished possibility of the greatest

satisfaction of lust of benefit. It was made free choice of the development of Ahrimanic consciousness, which leads to separation of personalities from each other and, consequently, to the war of all against all. This possibility of choice is opposite to possibility of choice of the development of Christian consciousness which is consciousness of love because it leads to the union of all personalities. The war of all against all is waged for the satisfaction of lust of benefit. The greatest advantage in such war will have those men, who possess the most developed technics, because the technics allow man to separate himself from the other people most of all with objective of achievement of maximal profit. The further development of technics tends to manifest rhythm of life, which man will not be able neither to change, nor to sustain it any more. Then to break dependence of man on rhythm of Luciferic and Ahrimanic beings will be possible only through the catastrophe.

Waking consciousness of man through whom Ahriman acts is not sufficiently developed to become conscious of the incarnation of Ahriman by himself in physical body. His consciousness is so busy by achievement of profit for the sake of profit, that in his waking state it is not possible. This man in waking consciousness does not know that he is incarnation of Ahriman. It is natural to ask question: Who this man? The answer to this question could be given publicly only if man would allow it to know that through him acts Ahriman. However as this man in waking consciousness in physical body is not conscious of it, his name could not to be named publicly. That is on the one hand. On the other hand, his name is not secret which cannot be known. Because of Ahriman does not hide his incarnation it is possible to know about man through whom Ahriman acts from the Akasha-chronicle. To understand a meaning of incarnation of Ahriman it is possible irrespective of either it is known what is name of this man, or not.

The directing of means to achievement of ever increasing profit does not corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind after incarnation of Ahriman any more, involves man in the war of all against all and leads him to separation from other personalities. This is manifested in ever more severe rhythm of life and prevents the development of the 'I'-consciousness of man. Man limits his perception of the world as of the world of separate objects only ever more. Modern man perceives the world of separate objects because his physical and etheric bodies coincide in the area of head. This was not always so. During the Atlantic period man possessed natural faculty of clairvoyance.

Why was that state of spiritual perception natural in those ancient times? Because other connection still existed between the physical body and the etheric body. The today's connection has originated only in the course of the last Atlantean times. In Atlantean man upper part of the etheric head and also some other parts of the etheric body were projected far beyond the physical head, and little by little, only by the end of the Atlantis, the etheric head moved into the physical head completely. Thereby the etheric body was brought almost to coincidence with the physical body. By this coincidence of physical and etheric parts of the head was caused recent state of consciousness, which became inherent to man after the Atlantean time: the possibility to perceive physical objects in sharp boundaries in the today's sense. That man can hear sounds, perceives smells, sees colours on the surfaces, though they are not witnesses of spiritual interior of things any more to him, all this was connected with that coincidence of the physical body and the etheric body which took place little by little at that time.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 102. The Influence of Spiritual Beings in Man.
Lecture on 13th April 1908.

Rhythm of the development of the 'I'-consciousness of man is changing and relations between the hierarchies of consciousness, manifested as the physical and etheric body of man, are changing too. The connection between the physical and etheric body becomes looser by modern man. Every man receives natural possibility of the development of supersensible

perception. Man perceives supersensibly when his etheric body is able to pass experience of the astral body to the physical body. When connection between the physical and etheric body is loosened, the etheric body is able to be projected out of the physical body and to pass impressions of the astral body over to the physical body. For man appears possibility to develop supersensible organs of perception and become clairvoyant. The influence of incarnation of Ahriman provides other possibility which prevents projection of the etheric body out of the physical body by directing consciousness of man on satisfaction of the lust of profit through the technics. The choice of the development of Ahrimanic consciousness is temptation, because it provides possibility to repeat pleasure just for the sake of pleasure and thus makes man dependent on lusts. The proper development of supersensible organs of perception is possible only through freedom from lusts. Ahrimanic consciousness helps man to become vehicle of evil first and then evil itself. After becoming evil itself, personality does not wish anything else, but satisfaction of lusts. To help such man, can only other personalities.

The possibilities of satisfaction of the lust of benefit which arise owing to incarnation of Ahriman are temptations for man. When Sorat will be incarnated in order to provide new possibilities of free choice for satisfaction of lusts this will be even greater temptation for personalities. If even one personality will follow Sorat then the difference in the levels of consciousness of personalities will become so large that neither personalities which went forward, nor personalities which stayed behind in the development of consciousness, cannot develop the 'I'-consciousness without each other. At the time of the incarnation of Christ in physical body of Jesus from Nazareth, Christ has reached such level of the development of consciousness, that he could not develop his consciousness, not balancing the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness and consciousness of man on the Earth any more. However there were other personalities, which still could develop their consciousness without helping the development of consciousness of man on the Earth. At the time of incarnation of Sorat no personality will be able to develop its consciousness not participating in the balancing of the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness and consciousness of man in the eighth sphere. Without stayed behind personalities no personality can attain consciousness of itself as the absolute Spirit. Therefore the help for the stayed behind personality in the development of 'I'-consciousness will be carried out through that, that personalities which went forward, will be incarnated in the eighth sphere in order to create possibilities of free choice to the stayed behind personalities to counterbalance relations between the hierarchies of consciousness manifested as the eighth sphere. The voluntary incarnation of those personalities in the eighth sphere, which went forward in the development of consciousness, will mean sacrifice because these personalities will experience sufferings and must make great efforts to counterbalance them. Their sacrifice will be similar to the sacrifice of Christ who consciously obeyed to free choice of men which lead him to crucifixion. The incarnated personalities will become the vehicle of rhythm of the development of consciousness of love for personalities of the eighth sphere.

The indication on the incarnation of Ahriman was given by Michelle Nostradamus also:

*The year 1999, seventh month,
From the sky will come a great King of Terror.*

The Prophecies of M. Michiel de Nostradame. X/72.

The prophecies of Nostradamus point out to supersensible events, therefore if one interprets them as sensibly physical events only one will almost always come to fantastic explanations. To be able to interpret the prophecies of Nostradamus properly, it is necessary to perceive the astral images which he describes supersensibly. To be able to make prophecies by oneself, it is necessary to be the initiate. Initiation makes man able to perceive

supersensibly and to interpret the future rhythms of the development of consciousness and the events connected with them properly. With each new rhythm of the development of consciousness the old methods which lead to initiation become not actual any more, and there arises the necessity of new methods. The incarnation of Ahriman corresponded to changes of rhythm of consciousness of mankind and has given man new possibilities for free choice. According to new rhythm, man must also have corresponding methods of the development of consciousness which can lead every man to initiation.

The personal message

You develop the 'I'-consciousness by yourself since the Lemurian period of the development of consciousness of mankind on the Earth. Your free choice manifested good and evil. You have experienced the catastrophes of the Lemurian and the Atlantic periods which were caused also by your free choice. Your consciousness is developed high enough now in order to make free choice from possibilities manifested through incarnations of Lucifer, Christ and Ahriman consciously.

The main conclusions

The incarnations of Avatar-personalities manifest new possibilities of choice for the development of consciousness of mankind. Christ is Avatar-personality with the highest consciousness. Christ was incarnated in physical body only once, because for establishment of balance between the hierarchies of consciousness and consciousness of man on the Earth it is enough to permeate consciousness of the Earth only once. Before the incarnation of Christ in physical body on the Earth he was incarnated in form of Archangel. Lucifer, Christ and Ahriman do not need to be incarnated through birth in physical body because they have no terrestrial Karma. They can be incarnated in physical body when man in physical body on the Earth will provide such possibility through his free choice for them. Man can make free choice two times accordingly, before birth and after birth in physical body on the Earth. Christ is personality with the highest consciousness whose consciousness for the first time has permeated the kingdoms of Lucifer, Michael and Uriel. The free choice of Christ has manifested consciousness of love because it leads to the unity of all beings. The incarnation of Lucifer provided possibilities of free choice which counterbalanced the influence of Jehova. The striving for repetition of pleasure is lust, or addiction. The incarnation of Ahriman in the European culture period has manifested possibility of satisfaction of the lust of benefit through the development of technics. Mankind at the time of incarnation of Ahriman has accumulated enough means to provide every man with free knowledge, feed, treatment. The means which after the incarnation of Ahriman are directed on satisfaction of the lust of profit, strengthen the war of all against all. The Continental period of the development of consciousness tends to end with catastrophe. The incarnation of personality Sorat will manifest possibilities of satisfaction of lusts in the eighth sphere. No personality can attain consciousness of itself as the absolute Spirit separately from personalities from the eighth sphere. In order to provide personalities from the eighth sphere with possibility of choice of the development of the 'I'-consciousness, personalities which went forward in the development of consciousness, will be incarnated in the eighth sphere voluntary.

Chapter 5

The qualities and faculties

Modern man loses his waking consciousness during deep dreamless sleep. Initiation leads to the attainment of such waking consciousness which encompasses consciousness of deep dreamless sleep. Thus, initiation leads to the continuity of waking consciousness, and the continuity of waking consciousness means consciousness of the eternal life. The development of consciousness of man in usual life occurs through the development of qualities and faculties. However to become initiate consciously, it is necessary to know methods of the development of qualities and faculties, and to be able to use them properly. As all is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness the qualities and faculties of personality depend on what relations will be manifested between personality and the hierarchies of consciousness through free choice of personality. Faculties are determined by how personality can use relations with the hierarchies of consciousness for manifestation of good and evil. How far personality applies faculties for manifestation of good only is determined by qualities, attributes or virtues of personality. Qualities allow personality to counterbalance relations with the hierarchies of consciousness manifested due to free choice. To be able to manifest only good, it is necessary always to make such free choice which corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Otherwise instead of good will be manifested evil for evil is untimely good.

The golden rule

The same faculty could be used for manifestation of good and evil. For example, the faculty of knowledge could be directed on satisfaction of lusts and well-being of all personalities. In order that the development of faculties did not lead to manifestation of evil, it is necessary to take care of the development of qualities. This constitutes the golden rule of the spiritual development:

But before one proceeds to take some steps, it is necessary to work extraordinary seriously on the purity of one's moral character. One must remove every thought of ever using the knowledge gained in this way for personal self-interest. One must be agreed with oneself never to use any power one might gain over fellow men in sense of evil. Therefore, everyone who seeks the mysteries of human nature through his own vision must abide by the golden rule of the occult sciences. And this rule is: For every single step that you try to take forwards in having knowledge of hidden truths, take three steps in perfecting your character toward the good.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 10. How to attain knowledge of the higher worlds?
The control of thoughts and feelings.

Conscious development of qualities and faculties leads man to initiation. Consciousness of modern man allows him to pass through the path of initiation without having in his vicinity teacher in physical body, that is, such personality which already attained initiation. There is certain relation between the level of consciousness and qualities. Qualities attained by man on one level of consciousness remain operative on any other level of consciousness. Qualities remain part of consciousness of man also when rhythm of the development of consciousness is changed. Therefore qualities which were attained in physical body remain part of consciousness of man also after change of consciousness which occurs through death. It is impossible, however, to state the same about all faculties. Faculties to satisfy lusts through

physical body are not preserved after death, though lusts remain. Qualities of initiate are natural laws which initiate steadily follows, irrespective of, whether he is incarnated in physical body, or not. Rudolf Steiner specifies the following two laws:

For there is a natural law for all initiates prompting them not to withhold from man knowledge that is due him. However there is an equally natural law which stating that nothing of esoteric knowledge can be imparted to anyone not called to have it. And the more perfect the initiate, the more strictly these two laws he observes.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 10. How to attain knowledge of the higher worlds?
Conditions.

The expression *natural law* does not mean that all initiates make an oath or sign a document to comply with some rules under the fear of punishment. It means that all initiates possess those qualities which allow them to have consciousness of initiate. And to be called to have knowledge or to have access to knowledge means neither more or less than to have qualities of such level of consciousness on which knowledge is used only for good. As any violation of freedom of choice of man is evil, then for initiate will be natural the following third law also:

Regulate each of your actions and each of your words so that free-will decision of any man will not be interfered through you.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 10. Knowledge of the higher worlds and its attainment.
Inner Peace.

As present rhythm of the development of consciousness allows each man to become an initiate then some conclusions follow from these laws. First, the path to initiation is opened to any man irrespective of, whether he strives through his free choice to manifest good or evil. Secondly, access to knowledge which man can attain on the path of initiation, depends not so much on his faculties, but rather on his qualities. And thirdly, knowledge attained on the path of initiation, must not violate freedom of choice of any personality. If the path of initiation leads to violation of free choice through one single personality, then this path is the path of black magic. Black magic is such use of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness with objective to achieve satisfaction of one's own desires and lusts which violate the freedom of choice of man.

Man in physical body, perceiving the world of separate objects, is deprived of direct perception of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness and thus is protected from conscious connection with them. When man enters on the path of initiation, he becomes able not only to perceive beings consciously, but also to control them. Man appears in the unequal position in comparison with other personalities which cannot do this. There appears temptation to take advantage of such possibility for one's own benefit. The qualities of initiate are guarantee that he will never use means of black magic for achievement of personal objectives. The use of faculties without appropriate development of qualities leads to black magic.

As there are possible various degrees of the development of qualities and supersensible faculties there are various degrees of initiation also. The more qualities of initiate are developed, the higher is level of his consciousness and the higher is degree of his initiation. Rudolf Steiner describes the following degrees of initiation:

In ancient times, the various degrees of Initiation were described by special names:

First degree: The Raven describes those one who stays at the threshold. The Raven appears in all mythologies. In the Edda, he whispers into the ear of Wotan what he sees afar off.

Second degree: the hidden Disciple, or the Occultist.

Third degree: the Warrior (struggle and strife).

Fourth degree: the Lion (strength).

Fifth degree: the Initiate bears the name of people which he belongs to: Persian or Greek because his soul is widespread upon his whole people.

Sixth degree: the Sun-Hero or Sun-Messenger, because his advancement became as harmonious and rhythmic as movement of the Sun. The Sun presented the rhythmic, living motion of the planet system. The legend of Icarus is related to the Initiation. Icarus tried to reach the Sun too early without necessary preparation and fallen down.

Seventh degree: the Father, because he became able now to educate disciples and to be protector of all men; and because he is the Father of new man, who was born second time in the awakened soul.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 94. An Esoteric Cosmology.
Lecture on 30th May 1906.

The word *teacher* will be used further on for the designation of initiate, who possesses qualities which can be characterized as one quality of freedom from egoism. This quality means that personality does not identify itself with its own manifestation and develops the I-consciousness through free choice which corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. The quality of freedom from egoism is attained, beginning from sixth degree of the initiation, which is called the *Sun-Hero*. Initiate who reached such level of consciousness is free from earthly Karma and can develop his consciousness without incarnation in physical body on the Earth. If teacher makes free choice to be incarnated in physical body on the Earth, then he does this, following rhythm of the development of consciousness in which new possibilities must be manifested for the development of consciousness of man on the Earth. An example of teacher is Gautama Buddha. Teacher with the highest consciousness who was ever incarnated in physical body is Jesus Christ. Qualities which were developed by Jesus Christ are an ideal for any teacher, because they allowed Jesus Christ to attain the highest consciousness for personality in our world structure. Lucifer possessed the highest faculty of knowledge in the beginning of the evolution, but he had no sufficient qualities to use wisdom for unity of all beings. If Lucifer possessed sufficient qualities, then there would be no his Fall. The legend of Icarus also is confirmation that without developed qualities it is impossible to reach initiation. That Icarus learned to fly, means, that he possessed faculties. The fall of Icarus means, that for achievement of initiation of sixth degree it is not enough to have faculties only. The golden rule is valid on any level of consciousness.

In order to tread the path of initiation, it is enough to make free choice leading to the development of qualities. Long before man chooses the path of initiation, there is already teacher. It is expressed in the ancient saying: *When the pupil is ready, the teacher appears*. The level of consciousness of teacher is so high, that he is able to inspire disciple, not being incarnated in physical body. Thereby three laws specified by Rudolf Steiner are always complied with. Waking consciousness of modern man allows him to perceive only one event at once. Teacher is able to perceive several events together at once, and the higher is level of consciousness, the more events teacher is able to perceive at once. Teacher is able to inspire several disciples at once, irrespective of where and in what state of consciousness they are. Therefore teacher has many disciples, as a rule. Disciple going on the path of initiation sooner or later reaches such level of consciousness when he becomes able to perceive teacher. Up to this moment disciple could know nothing about his existence as well. Moreover, man could not know also, that he is already on the path of initiation for a long time. The path of life is already the path of initiation for everyone, whose way of life promotes the development of qualities. For the development of qualities no special conditions of life are necessary. The best conditions for the development of qualities are always those in which man is.

Physical body of man provides protection against direct perception of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness, whose influences are manifested as lusts. The faculty of clairvoyance allows initiate to perceive these beings during lifetime in physical body and his qualities allow him to remain free from their influence. After change of consciousness which is called death every man loses protection of physical body and perception of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness becomes direct experience. If lusts were connected with pleasure received through physical body, then man after death experiences sufferings, to which no sufferings in physical body can be compared, because possibility of satisfaction is absent and lusts as relations with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness still remained. The level of consciousness on which man after death can experience sufferings from his own lusts, is called *Kamaloka* - place of desire, *purgatory*.

Now we would like to develop certain concepts as to how man - ordinary man of our average culture of today - meets the Gods. After death man first goes through Kamaloka, the state in which he gradually gets rid of the habits of earthly life and will be freed from lusts. It is actually only in its first periods that the sojourn in Kamaloka is sometimes frightening and terrible. Later man goes through that period of Kamaloka when he has to purify himself from the more delicate connections with the earthly world. This sojourn in Kamaloka is not only important for man, but the activity of man in the higher states of Kamaloka can also be made use of in the rest of the world as we shall see. After Kamaloka man enters into the Devachan state, where, using the faculties he has won for himself, he works over everything which is necessary in order to build up a new etheric body.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 93a. Foundations of Esotericism.
Lecture on 8th Oktober 1905.

In Kamaloka man loses that waking consciousness which was limited by perception of the world of separate objects. Instead of the world of separate objects man can perceive in Kamaloka those connections with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness which correspond to his sins. Sin or vice is lack of qualities and is connected with lust. When satisfaction of lust passes into habit, connection with beings becomes sin. Jacob Boehme describes four basic kinds of sin:

Sin has seven Kinds, Forms, Species or Sorts; among which there are four special Well-springs or Sources: And the eighth Kind or Sort is the House of Death.

Now observe: The Seven Forms are the seven qualifying or fountain Spirits of the Body; when these are kindled each Spirit generates a special or particular Enmity against God.

Out of these Seven are generated other four new Sons, and they together are the new God, which is wholly against the old God, as two professed Armies of Enemies, which have sworn eternal Enmity one against the other.

The first Son is Pride. The second Son is Covetousness. The third Son is Envy. The fourth Son is Wrath.

Jacob Boehme. The Aurora. The Day-Spring or Dawning of the Day in the East.
The Fourteenth Chapter. How Lucifer, who was the most beautiful Angel in Heaven,
is become the most horrible Devil.

Sin is nothing else but relations of consciousness of man with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness manifested through satisfaction of lusts. As man after death has not physical body, then he perceives lusts in Kamaloka as real beings, which have forms reminding physical forms of animals. Consciousness of initiate permeates Kamaloka already during lifetime in physical body, not causing him sufferings because initiate possesses certain degree of the following seven virtues:

Justice, abstinence from judgment, spiritual strength, cleverness, faith, hope, love.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 88. About astral world and Devachan.
Lecture on 2nd December 1903.

Manifestation of sin is possible on any level of consciousness. The Fall of Lucifer was caused by pride of his own wisdom. Lucifer had free choice to manifest only those possibilities of choice for personalities in his kingdom, the consequences of which he could himself to become conscious of. Instead of this, the choice was made, which allows personalities to choose from possibilities of rhythm of the development of consciousness directly irrespective of to what consequences this could lead. Thus, personality in the kingdom of Lucifer can manifest good and evil without limitations. As long as the manifested world structure exists, no personality can have perfect qualities. Even personality with the highest consciousness, Jesus Christ, whose qualities it is possible to consider as ideal for all personalities, has no perfect qualities also. There are no restrictions in the development of qualities for personality. Qualities allow personality to manifest good through free choice. However, as there are no restrictions for personality in the development of qualities and manifestation of good, there are no restrictions in the development of sin and manifestation of evil also. Therefore, when one speaks about virtues it is always meant certain degree of the development of qualities. As mankind is one unity, qualities of personality are characteristic of how far personality is conscious of itself to be united with other personalities. Sin is characteristic of how far consciousness of personality is separated from other personalities. As all qualities are connected with each other, because they all correspond to manifestation of good, it is not important, the development of which quality to begin from. The development of one quality leads to the development of other qualities as well.

Qualities and conditions of the occult training

The expression *occult training* should be understood as training which is not perceived by physical sense organs and in this sense it is hidden, or secret. Nothing is changed for man outwardly when he starts the development of qualities. The attainment of qualities creates conditions which are necessary for the development of supersensible faculties in occult training. As no personality can have perfect qualities, so nobody can satisfy conditions of the occult training perfectly. The chief thing, however, is that man would have perpetual striving for the development of qualities and thus is striving to fulfil conditions of the occult training. Let us consider connection of the development of qualities with conditions of the occult training.

Justice and health

The more man is conscious of himself as member of whole mankind, the more he is conscious of his connection with all personalities and the more he will manifest justice in relation to them. The quality of justice is opposite to the struggle for existence and man, possessing this quality, will not make choice without reckoning with other personalities. Therefore his choice will not assist strengthening of the war of all against all. Striving for satisfaction of the lust of benefit which leads to the war of all against all should not be mistaken for striving to be rich. To be rich in occult language means to possess qualities and faculties, which correspond to qualities. In this sense to be rich in physical life means to possess qualities to attain all what is necessary for the development of consciousness in physical body according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. The fulfilling of duties in physical life promotes the development of the quality of justice and can be even harmful to personal health. Therefore the first condition of the occult training is health. This means, that man learns to undertake all what is possible for restoration and preservation of health, without refusing from fulfilling of his life duties.

Abstinence from judgement and membership in the whole of life

Any judgement based on personal sympathies and antipathies, means judgement from position of separation from other personalities. All personalities are connected among each other. The higher is consciousness of unity with all personalities, the less is urge to judge on basis of personal sympathies and antipathies. Personal judgement is never ultimately true, because, in order to judge truly it is necessary to have consciousness which encompasses consciousness of all personalities, what it is not possible in the manifested world structure. Ultimately true judgement it is possible only for all personalities together. What single personality can reach in life is never a merit of only one personality. Single personality always uses achievements of other personalities, quite often depriving them of favourable conditions for the development of consciousness. The second condition of occult training will be awareness of oneself as of integral member of mankind and by that as a member of the whole life.

Spiritual strength and reality of thoughts and feelings

Spiritual strength allows man to resist temptations to satisfy lusts. The opposite to strength is weakness which leads to lusts. Man constantly is exposed to temptations in his astral body what is expressed in striving for satisfaction of pleasures, for example, through excessive eating, drinking, sex, possessions and so on. Those who eat too much will manifest lusts in their astral body. All illnesses have their origin in lusts of the astral body. Therefore all religions prescribe purification from lusts through fasting. The concept of *fasting* should be understood, first of all, as refusal, abstinence from lusts. If man gives no food to physical body, then his physical body will weaken. In similar way, if do not feed lusts with thoughts, feelings, words and deeds, then lusts will be weaken also. However, if man do not takes in food and cherishes, for example, thoughts and feelings of satisfaction of sexual pleasures, then physical body will be destroyed very quickly. Therefore fasting means refusal to give food to lusts. That is why the quality of spiritual strength can be also called as quality of the refusal from lusts. Manifestation of strength and weakness begins with thoughts and feelings of man. Therefore the third condition of the occult training is to be conscious that thoughts and feelings are realities, and have not lesser importance, than words and deeds.

Cleverness and spiritual balance

As no single personality can possess perfect qualities there is always possibility to make a mistake through free choice. However the more the qualities are developed, the less probable is possibility of mistake, because personality makes its choice according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind, instead of according to its own personal urges and objectives. How great the wisdom of one single personality could be, it can be only some part of wisdom of the whole mankind. The quality of cleverness is attained through experience of mistakes. Mistakes are possible on any level of consciousness, therefore manifestation of pride, greed, envy and anger are also possible on any level of consciousness. The quality of cleverness can be called quality of flexibility because it brings previous qualities to harmony and allows personality to become conscious creator of its own destiny. Cleverness promotes fulfilling of fourth condition of the occult training which is called spiritual balance. This means balance between what is inside and outside. Consciousness of the true 'I' of man takes place inside human being, but the 'I' itself is not only inside, it is everywhere, and human being is part of the 'I'. Cleverness allows keep balance between requirements of the outer world and inner development of qualities.

Faith and following taken decision

Clever, reasonable personality becomes so flexible in the development of its qualities that this allows it to develop quality of faith. The quality of faith means faith of perpetual development of consciousness through free choice which leads to knowledge of the internal infinite source of everything. How perfect an achievement may seem to be, it is only a stage in the development of consciousness of mankind. Any achievement will be always only some semblance of what could be attained. The quality of faith excludes dogmas which are created through personal understanding of religions and religious books. Any religion reflects only a stage on the path of the development of consciousness of mankind. With the changing of consciousness personal understanding of religions and religious books are changing also. Faith allows man to follow taken decision steadily if decision corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Following taken decision constitutes fifth condition of the occult training.

Hope and thankfulness

The quality of faith is connected with quality of hope of the development of consciousness through free choice. In what situation personality may be, there is always possibility for it of free choice which leads to knowledge of good. Therefore the sixth condition of the occult training is thankfulness to everything, what personality meets on its path of life. Free life of personality is gift of the absolute Spirit and it is only possible owing to life of the whole world structure. Free choice of personality could be directed against other personalities, but without the development of its consciousness it is impossible the development of all other personalities, because mankind is one unity. Therefore there is no bad personality. Personality can become evil itself, but this will mean, that evil was necessary for the free development of consciousness of personality through knowledge of evil.

Love and unity of previous conditions

Love can be manifested only through free choice which leads to unity of all beings. If man makes free choice which leads to compassion, to sympathy, to participation, to unselfish assistance to others, then such free choice also leads to unity of personalities, and, consequently, to unity of all beings. Only personality, which has possibility of free choice to manifest good and evil without any compulsion can manifest love. And the mission of man as personality on the Earth planet is to learn to manifest love. Love must become natural power of man, his striving and his purpose, and could be understood as the power to give without expectation of any return. An example of manifestation of love was given by Jesus Christ. Similar as Jesus Christ was incarnated in physical body in order to help the development of consciousness of mankind on the Earth, personalities with the developed quality of love will be incarnated in the eighth sphere in order to help the development of consciousness of the stayed behind personalities, which became evil itself. Quality of love allows manifest all qualities as one whole. Therefore the seventh condition of the occult training is fulfilling of all previous conditions together.

There are certain relations between qualities, fulfilling of conditions of the occult training and seven members of man. As all members of man can exist and can be developed in harmony only through the interrelations between each other, then the proper development of qualities and fulfilling of conditions of the occult training can take place only through the interrelations between each other.

<i>Qualities</i>	<i>Conditions of occult training</i>	<i>Members of man</i>
Justice	Health	Physical body
Abstinence from judgement	Membership in the whole of life	Etheric, life body

Spiritual strength	Reality of thoughts and feelings	Astral body
Cleverness	Spiritual balance	'I' (Self)
Faith	Following the decision	Self-Spirit, Manas
Hope	Thankfulness	Life-Spirit, Buddhi
Love	Unity of conditions	Spirit-Man, Atman

Quality of love is quality of sacrifice and giving because man gives his personal richness of qualities and faculties to the development of all beings. In the Gospel of St. Mathew it is called to enter into the kingdom of heaven, following Jesus Christ.

And, behold, one came and said unto him, Good Master, what good thing shall I do, that I may have eternal life? And he said unto him, Why callest thou me good [perfect]? There is none good [perfect] but one, that is, God: but if thou wilt enter into life, keep the commandments. He saith unto him, Which? Jesus said, Thou shalt do no murder, Thou shalt not commit adultery, Thou shalt not steal, Thou shalt not bear false witness, Honour thy father and thy mother: and, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself. The young man saith unto him, All these things have I kept from my youth up: what lack I yet? Jesus said unto him, If thou wilt be perfect, go and sell that thou hast, and give to the poor, and thou shalt have treasure in heaven: and come and follow me. But when the young man heard that saying, he went away sorrowful: for he had great possessions. Then said Jesus unto his disciples, Verily I say unto you, That a rich man shall hardly enter into the kingdom of heaven. And again I say unto you, It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.

Matthew 19:16-24.

Jesus Christ speaks first of all about the commandments which lead to eternal life. Man whose consciousness will be preserved after death of physical body will have eternal life. In these commandments it is contained much more, than could be noticed by superficial reading.

The commandment *do not murder* means do not cause harm or evil to nobody neither to oneself nor to anybody else. It is possible, when free choice of man corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. If man will learn not to do harm first of all to himself, having cleared himself from lusts, then he also will learn not to do harm to others. *To lust after* means to strive for pleasure just for sake of pleasure. Therefore the commandment *not to commit adultery* means *do not lust after*, and corresponds to continence in the satisfaction of lusts of the astral body. The commandment *do not steal* corresponds to quality of justice or to compliance with the law of Karma, because fair man is content with that, what it is allowed him to have by his Karma, and the law of Karma is justice. Man who lies, manifests astral beings which destroy his astral body, therefore lie is equivalent to murder on the astral level of consciousness. Father and mother in the commandment *honour thy father and thy mother* mean not only physical parents. As everything is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness, man is obliged by his existence first of all to the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. From this point of view, they also are father and mother of man in the manifested world structure. The respect for the hierarchies of consciousness is developed through comprehension of that, by what man is obliged by them in his life. Then consciousness of man becomes permeated first of all by feeling of thankfulness and he learns to use in his life only that, what is necessary for the development of his consciousness and consciousness of others. If man takes more to himself, than he really needs, then he deprives others of possibility of the development of consciousness. Therefore the commandment *honour thy father and thy mother* will correspond to the commandment *do not be (live) excessive*.

The first five commandments correspond to five vows of Yama: *do not kill, do not lie, do not steal, do not be (live) excessive, do not lust after*. They were mentioned by Patanjali in his work *Yoga-sutras* as follows:

Non-killing, truthfulness, non-stealing, continence, and non-receiving, are called Yama.

Patanjali. *Yoga Sutras*. 2.30.

Continence is interpreted usually as abstinence from waste of sexual energy, and *non-receiving* - as non-acceptance of gifts and non-accumulation of material possessions. If man wastes his sexual energy because of pleasure this means, that he has lust. If there will be no lust there will be no waste of sexual energy also. Therefore continence means, first of all, *do not lust after*. *Non-receiving* does not mean that it is necessary to refuse of use of gifts and material things. *Non-receiving* means that it is not necessary to take too much and corresponds to the vow *do not be (live) excessive*.

The correspondence between the commandments of Christianity and the vows of Yama originates from fact that in the life or etheric body of man there are five life currents. They become perceived by each man with certain level of consciousness. Sins, which are opposites to the vows of Yama, act on these life currents destructively. Through destruction of life currents, man kills life in himself. Jesus Christ and Patanjali specify five commandments because they are able to perceive ethetic currents and destructive action of sins on them. The expression *to enter into life* will mean *to enter into consciousness of the life body*. In order to become conscious in the life or etheric body, man must first of all comply with vows of Yama. They must become part of consciousness of man. From here it is possible to understand, why Yama is also god of death. For those one, who does not comply with specified commandments, kills life in oneself, gets in the power of god of death and, consequently must die.

<i>Commandments of Christianity</i>	<i>Vows of Yama</i>
Do not murder	Do not kill
Do not bear false witness	Do not lie
Do not steal	Do not steal
Honour father and mother	Do not be (live) excessive
Do not commit adultery	Do not lust after

The sixth commandment *love thy neighbour as thyself* specifies the fact that the development of consciousness of one man depends on the development of consciousness of others. In this commandment it is possible to notice the difference between teaching of yoga and Christianity. The vows of Yama are commandments of the achievement of perfection for single personality. The commandments of Christianity are commandments of the achievement of perfection for all together. The sixth commandment is connected with conceptions of *kingdom of heaven* and *kingdom of God* between which there is essential difference. The kingdom of heaven is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. Relations between the hierarchies of consciousness are manifested in rhythms of the development of consciousness of mankind, providing new possibilities of free choice of the development of consciousness to personality. In order that personality could enter into kingdom of heaven, it must make free choice, proceeding not from its own egoism, but from rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Personality becomes then similar to the hierarchies of consciousness. That is called to *enter into the kingdom of heaven*.

To become perfect and to enter into the *kingdom of God* means for personality not only to become similar to the hierarchies of consciousness, but also means to include in its own consciousness the consciousness of all hierarchies of consciousness and, thus, to know

everything what is possible to know in the manifested world structure. However no personality can become perfect if there is even only one personality which still is not perfect. If though one personality is not perfect, then there is always free choice which is unknown to other personalities. This means that not all is known in the manifested world structure. Therefore conception, that single personality, irrespective of other personalities, can become united with the absolute God, can merge with the Absolute or can attain consciousness of itself as the absolute Spirit, is a mistake. To enter into the *kingdom of God* means the same, as to attain consciousness of itself as the absolute Spirit. For this purpose it is not enough to develop one's own consciousness by the achievement of richness of qualities and faculties and to enter into the kingdom of heaven. It is necessary to direct the personal richness of qualities and faculties to the development of all. To enter into *kingdom of God* it is possible only for all personalities together when the richness of every personality becomes property of all.

The occult or secret training is always connected with the development of qualities. In ancient times to the occult training was admitted only those one who already had certain degree of corresponding qualities. As consciousness of man was less developed than it is now, then presence of teacher in the physical body was the necessary condition for the development of supersensible faculties.

The supersensible organs of perception

The development of supersensible faculties is based on the fact, that each time when man develops some virtue or quality, the new faculty of perception which corresponds to quality will be developed also. The development of qualities is connected with the development of astral organs of perception which are called *charkas*, *sacred wheels* or *lotus flowers*. Each man has these organs of perception, however, in order to perceive supersensibly in right manner, it is necessary not only to learn to use organs of perception, but it is necessary that they are properly developed. Skill to use chakras is a faculty. If one makes exercises for the development of chakras without appropriating development of qualities, then attained faculties of supersensible perception will be distorted, and man will fall prey to illusions, accepting what is desirable for real. This occurs because the faculties of perception will be developed through connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness from which man becomes dependent. As a rule, man becomes then immoral man striving for satisfaction of not apparently rough, but all the more refined lusts, and his health, both psychic and physical, will be destroyed. The proper development of chakras can occur owing to the development of qualities in every moment of life. For the development of qualities are not necessary neither special conditions, nor specially appointed time, those life conditions which there are now, are also the best.

In Indian writings it is possible to find various methods of the development of chakras. It is necessary to notice, that knowledge about chakras remained secret for a long time, by virtue of danger to get in dependence on beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. Such knowledge was passed over to disciple orally when his consciousness were enough developed. Only when common level of consciousness of mankind was changed, this knowledge could become accessible to every man.

Chakras are astral formations and they are situated in the astral body of man. This always must be considered, when position of chakras will be specified in the area of physical organs of man. Though chakras are single formations, they cannot exist by themselves, and represent one whole. Between chakras there is a plenty of connections, the main of them are called *spokes of sacred wheels* or *petals of lotus flower*. For independent development of chakras it is enough to have knowledge about petals of six lotuses. Knowledge about petals of seventh lotus can become actual only when all six chakras are already developed.

<i>Chakras, sacred wheels, Lotus flowers</i>	<i>Number of petals or spokes</i>	<i>Position</i>
Muladhara Base or Root Chakra	four	Base of backbone
Swadhisthana Sacral Chakra	six	Lower abdomen
Manipura Solar Plexus Chakra	ten	Stomach
Anahata Heart Chakra	twelve	Heart
Vishuddha Throat Chakra	sixteen	Larynx, throat
Ajna Brow or Third Eye Chakra	two	Forehead
Sahasrara Crown Chakra		Top of the head

Rudolf Steiner specifies the following relations between supersensible faculties and petals of lotus flowers:

The two-petalled [lotus flower] enables us to train the will; the sixteen-petalled [lotus flower] to penetrate into foreign thoughts; the twelve-petalled [lotus flower] to recognize the feelings life; the four-petalled [lotus flower] is connected with the regenerative and productive force of man.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 94. An Esoteric Cosmology.
Lecture on 9th July 1906.

The proper development of supersensible faculties is connected with purification and strengthening of certain connections between chakras. Lusts are astral formations which weaken and destroy connections between chakras what is manifested in various diseases. Therefore the proper development of chakras begins first of all with redirection of attention from satisfaction of lusts to the development of qualities. Qualities must become natural part of character of man. If man must make conscious efforts in order to live according to qualities, then this mean, that necessarily degree of the development of his qualities is not attained yet.

The description of relations between qualities and single chakras can be found not only in ancient sources. For example, Caroline Myss in book *The Anatomy of the Spirit* describes seven sacred truths, and Deepak Chopra in book *The Seven spiritual laws of Success* specifies seven laws the following of which leads to health and well-being of every man. The basic difference of these two descriptions is that Caroline Myss more attention pays to the relations between personalities, and Deepak Chopra to the relations between personality and the absolute Spirit. The degree of compliance with sacred truths or laws corresponds to level of the development of qualities and is connected with the development of chakras.

<i>Chakras, Lotus flowers</i>	<i>Seven Sacred Truths</i>	<i>Seven spiritual laws of Success</i>
Muladhara Base or Root Chakra	All is one	The Law of Pure Potentiality
Swadhisthana Sacral Chakra	Honor one another	The Law of Giving

Manipura Solar Plexus Chakra	Honor oneself	The Law of Karma
Anahata Heart Chakra	Love is divine power	The Law of Least Effort
Vishuddha Throat Chakra	Surrender your personal will to divine will	The Law of Intention and Desire
Ajna Brow or Third Eye Chakra	Seek only the truth	The Law of Detachment
Sahasrara Crown Chakra	Live in the present moment	The Law of Dharma (purpose in life)

Let's consider the law of Dharma. Dharma has many meanings which are connected with each other. Especially close connection exists with concept of Karma. Man making free choice has possibility to become conscious of himself as the absolute Spirit. This is destination, ultimate purpose of the development of man in the manifested world structure. Because man makes free choice, man creates Karma. How far free choice of man corresponds to his purpose is determined by his Dharma. The action determined by free choice which most of all corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind will also correspond to the destination most of all, and in this sense will be the most right action. Therefore Dharma means right action also. Dharma is the result of Karma of the past, and is the basis for the Karma of the future. Karma and Dharma are interrelated to each other as fruit and seed, and they are inseparable from the freedom of choice. To follow the law of Dharma means to make free choice according to present rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind or, in other words, to live in the present moment.

<i>Rhythm of the development of mankind and free choice of man</i>		
<i>Past</i>	<i>Present</i>	<i>Future</i>
Karma	Dharma	Karma

The development of qualities and faculties of man occurs through use of forces of thinking, feeling and willing. These forces of soul are interconnected between each other. When man wishes something he manifests feelings to wish and has thoughts about wish. Desire is manifested through free choice, and to make free choice means to manifest the will through the absolute Spirit. In his day waking consciousness man, as a rule, does not become conscious of connections between these three forces of soul and can not control them consciously. The relations between them are regulated by the hierarchies of consciousness. If man will become conscious of connections between thinking, feeling and willing he will be conscious of the connections between the hierarchies of consciousness, through which these forces of soul are manifested. From here follows the necessity of the development of qualities which allow man to rule over thinking, feeling and willing. These qualities are connected, first of all, with the development of two-petalled, twelve-petalled and sixteen-petalled lotus flower.

Man develops the two-petalled lotus flower when he strives to become conscious of his thoughts, feelings and willing. The striving for conscious control is also that, what it is necessary for the development of this lotus. The development of the twelve-petalled and sixteen-petalled lotus flower has a feature that it is necessary to develop only half of the petals because other petals were developed in previous rhythms of the development of consciousness.

The development of the twelve-petalled lotus flower

For the proper development and use of the twelve-petalled lotus, it is necessary to develop the following six qualities:

Control of thoughts	Logical consistency of thoughts
Control of actions	Initiative of actions
Endurance (perseverance)	Calmness, Equanimity
Forbearance (tolerance)	Positivity
Impartiality toward everything that life brings	Faith or trust
Inner balance (equanimity)	Harmony

Control and logical consistency of thoughts

Man gets control over thoughts when he is able to direct the power of thinking to one single object and to hold it on this object. Any object will be suitable and the simpler is the object, the better it will be. Thus the change of thoughts forms logical sequence which corresponds to object. Those outer and inner influences which can cause extraneous thoughts are excluded from consciousness so long until man will not choose to allow them to be a part of his consciousness. The choice of man will remain logical and substantial even if it is influenced from outside by illogical and not concerning object thoughts. Thus all illogical what can reach his consciousness will be transformed into logical sequence. The power of thinking is accustomed to remain under control of man even then, when he begins to perceive beings of the supersensible world and this allows him to remain independent of their influence.

Control and initiative of actions

Man must learn to give similar direction to actions. All actions of man must begin from inner initiative, from conscious free choice. Any action will be brought under control of will. Subsequent actions become logical continuation of previous actions. Conscious ruling of man reaches all deeds both small and great. The will power must remain under control of man also when he meets beings of the supersensible world. Man must be able to follow strictly one's own will and not to be influenced by beings of the hierarchies. Lusts lose their influence on man and together with this the striving for satisfaction of lust ceases.

Endurance and equanimity

Endurance means that life of feelings is brought to harmony. Man keeps persistence and consistency in achievement of goals he has set himself. No obstacles divert him from goal as long as it is regarded to be the right goal. Obstacles become the requirement for him to overcome them. His feelings remain in harmony what allows him with equal equanimity to meet joy and sorrow, pleasure and unpleasure on his path to the goal. Man reaches certain degree of equanimity and calmness in life of feelings concerning pleasures and sufferings. He does not strive to suppress feelings, but he does not allow them completely to hold sway over his consciousness and degree of their outer manifestation is under his control.

Tolerance and positivity

Forbearance or tolerance towards people and beings allows man to find positivity in all things. Tolerance is connected also with understanding. Evil and good also can coexist because the freedom of choice exists. Evil is only untimely good and result of the manifestation of evil can be transformed into good. Therefore instead of condemnation man strives to understand and to reach positivity in judgements about phenomena of life.

Impartiality and faith

Impartial, unbiased man is ready to check up his opinion and view concerning the phenomena of life in every moment. He is always receptive to something new and does not allow the past to predetermine his judgement about new phenomenon in advance. If he has some opinion and corresponding intention, then he also has the power of faith in them. Power of faith allows him to remain opened for any new phenomenon and no obstacles and failures can deprive him of this power. Therefore impartiality means availability of faith.

Inner balance and harmony

Inner balance is attained through the harmonious development of previous qualities. Man keeps balance in any situation of life and do not allows neither the highest joy nor the deepest sorrow to deprive him of his inner balance. He attains harmony in inner and outer life and gets ready for the occult training.

The development of the sixteen-petalled lotus flower

In order to develop the sixteen-petalled lotus flower it is necessary for man to develop consciously the half of the petals also. For this purpose man must attain certain degree of consciousness concerning *ideas and conceptions, decisions, words (speech), outer actions, arrangement of life, strivings in life, life experience, inner contemplative life*. This degree of consciousness corresponds to the properties of the eightfold path of Buddha which includes: *right opinion, right judgement, right word, right course of action, right place, right habits, right memory, right contemplation*.

<i>Right opinion (view)</i>	<i>Control of ideas and conceptions</i>
<i>right judgment</i>	<i>Control of decisions</i>
<i>Right word (speech)</i>	<i>Control of words, speech</i>
<i>Right course of action</i>	<i>Control of outer actions</i>
<i>Right place or location</i>	<i>Consciousness of the whole of life</i>
<i>Right habits</i>	<i>Control of endeavours in life</i>
<i>Right memory</i>	<i>Consciousness of life</i>
<i>Right contemplation</i>	<i>Control of inner life</i>

Rudolf Steiner specifies that Buddha was first man, who in physical body developed all these properties in himself:

It is once occurred that in one only man, namely in the personality of Gautama Buddha, all these qualities of the eight-fold path were thorough present. Thereby this personality gave the impulse, that now all men can appropriate these properties to themselves.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 123. The Gospel of St. Matthew.
Lecture on 7th September 1910.

The objective of the eightfold path is deliverance of man from those connections with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness which were established through lusts and desires in previous incarnations. Lusts and desires make man dependent on beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. This dependence is characterized by the word *Samskara*. Samskara does not cease to exist through death and it is kept from incarnation to incarnation in physical body. Lusts are rooted in the astral body of man. Therefore to be released from Samskara, man first of all must free his astral body from lusts. Deliverance from Samskara leads to deliverance from necessity of birth in physical body.

'The cause of suffering in the world' - so said Buddha - 'is that something of which man knows nothing has remained behind from earlier incarnations. What he has from earlier incarnations is the cause of his ignorance concerning the world; it is the cause of suffering and pain, sorrow and worry of man. But when he becomes conscious of the forces which are available in his astral body, he can, if he so will, acquire a knowledge that has remained independent of all that what was earlier - his own knowledge.'

This knowledge the great Buddha wished to impart to men. And he imparted it to them in the so-called Eightfold Path. There he wished to indicate those forces, which man should develop in order to attain, in the present cycle of human evolution, knowledge that is uninfluenced by the ever-recurring births. Thus by the power he had himself acquired, Buddha raised his soul to that what is attainable through the most intensive forces of the astral body, and in the Eightfold Path he wanted to show mankind the way by which one can come to some knowledge, which is uninfluenced by Samskara. He described the path as follows.

Man attains this kind of knowledge about the world when he acquires a right opinion of things, a view that has nothing to do with sympathy or antipathy or preference of any sort, but he must try according to forces to acquire the right opinion of each thing, purely according to what presents itself to him outwardly. That is the first principle: the right opinion of a thing.

As second, it is necessary that man must become independent of what has remained from earlier incarnations; that we endeavor to judge also in accordance with our right opinion of a thing and not according to any other influences, but only according to what is our right opinion. Thus the right judgment is the second principle in question.

The third is that if we communicate something to the world we must strive to give proper expression to what we desire to communicate to the world, acquired through our right opinion and right judgment of it; that we put in in our words nothing else but only what is our right opinion, and not only in our words but namely in every manifestation of human being. This is the right word in sense of Buddha.

At fourth place it is necessary that we must strive to carry out our deeds, not according to our sympathies and antipathies, not according to something dark which burrows as Samskara within us, but we allow become deed to that, what we apprehended as our right opinion, right judgment and right word. This is the right course of action.

What man needs at fifth place in order to free himself from what is living within him is the right status, the right position in the world. We may best make clear to ourselves what Buddha meant by this, if we would say to us: There are so many people who are dissatisfied with their tasks in the world, who believe that they could be better at some other position. But a man should use possibility to derive from the situation into which he is born or into which fate has placed him, the best that is possible, i.e. to acquire the right place (location). Whoever feels no satisfaction in his position in which he is placed, will not be able to derive from it the power, which will bring him to the right activity in the world. This is what Buddha called acquiring the right place (location).

The sixth principle is that we should make increasing efforts to ensure that what we acquire through right opinion, right judgment and so forth, shall become habit in us. As we are born into the world we have certain habits. A child gives evidence of this or that inclination or habit. But man should strive not only to retain habits coming from Samskara, but to acquire those habits which gradually become his own proceeding from right opinion, right judgment, right word, and so on. These are the right habits, which we should acquire.

The seventh principle is that we should bring order into our life through not invariably forgetting yesterday when we have to act to-day. If we had to learn our skills anew each time then we would never accomplish anything. A man must strive to develop recollectedness, memory (mindfulness), regarding all things of his existence. He must always turn to account

what he has already learnt, he must link the present with the past. Thus, speaking in the sense of Buddha, man has to acquire the right memory along the Eightfold Path.

The eighth principle is that what man acquires if without partiality for one opinion or another and without being influenced by what is remaining to him from former incarnations, he surrenders himself purely to the things of the world, immerses himself in them and lets things alone speak to him. This is right contemplation.

This is the Eightfold Path, of which Buddha said to his confessors that its recognition leads to result, which lets the thirst for existence with its attendant suffering gradually to be extinguished, and lets to impart to the soul something that brings liberation from all that what comes from past lives and what enslaves the soul.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 114. The Gospel of St. Luke.
Lecture on 17th September 1909.

The eightfold path leads not only to deliverance from lusts, but also to deliverance from personal desires. Desire is always expressed through his free choice when man strives to attain something. When man would be free from personal desires? Only then when rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind is manifested in free choice of man. Qualities of the eightfold path allow man to become conscious of possibility to make free choice in which there is no personal desire to attain something. However before to start with the elimination of personal desires, it is necessary to become free from lusts. Otherwise an effort to restrain oneself from desires will lead to disorder of health.

The degree of the development of qualities

The development of qualities must reach such degree, that they become natural part of character of man, become as one whole. The development of character of man begins with free choice which leads to the development of qualities. The consequences of free choice will be relations between the hierarchies of consciousness, manifestation of which will correspond to desirable qualities in man. Free choice must be repeated as long until manifestation of qualities becomes a habit. Rudolf Steiner describes degree of the development of four qualities as follows:

In spiritual science one speaks of four attributes, which must be acquired on the so-called probation path, in order to ascend to the higher knowledge. The first of them is the faculty of discriminating in thoughts between what is true and mere opinion. The second attribute is the right estimation of what is true and real compared against the appearance. The third faculty consists in the exercising of the six attributes already mentioned previously: control of thought, control of actions, perseverance, tolerance, faith and equanimity. The fourth attribute is the love of inner freedom.

A mere intellectual understanding of what is included in these attributes is of no value. They must be so incorporated into the soul that they establish the inner habits.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 10. Knowledge of the higher worlds and its attainment.
Some Effects of Initiation.

All transient outer phenomena which man perceives through physical sense organs are manifestations of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. Behind these relations there are beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. Fruit and plant which grows from fruit are various manifestations of the hierarchies of consciousness. The hierarchies of consciousness are that true what remains, when the form of phenomena changes. That what is true always exists in basis of the transient phenomenon that is why it is more valuable than phenomenon itself. However that, what is transient, exists for that, what is eternal, and evolution is possible because of existence of that, what is transient. Acting through that, what

is transient, man acquires qualities which allow him to have consciousness of that, what is eternal. In order that man could attain inner freedom, it is necessary, that his free choice corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Love to inner freedom is love to what is eternal. Eternal, imperishable in man is the absolute Spirit. Man attaining all the higher levels of the hierarchies of consciousness can reach consciousness of himself as the absolute Spirit only gradually.

Man who does not strive particularly for the development of supersensible faculties or has no time to develop them, always has possibility of conscious development of qualities in everyday life. Life in physical body is the best school for the development of qualities. It always provides possibility of choice for the development of qualities through use of forces of thinking, feeling and willing. Those one, who through life in physical body develops one's own qualities, will have supersensible organs of perception in correspondence with rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind.

Man, who wishes to acquire supersensible faculties still during life in physical body, must develop them through exercises in concentration and meditation. Concentration is to understand here as the directing of attention to certain ideas and concepts which are connected with well-known relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. Meditation is such grasping of feelings, concepts, ideas, thoughts which leads to consciousness of their essence.

Imagination, inspiration, intuition

Three types of meditation: imagination, inspiration and intuition are most suitable for modern man. As all is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness, then concepts of three types of meditation can be specified as follows. Imagination is meditation which leads to consciousness of single beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. Meditation which leads to consciousness of relations between beings of the hierarchies of consciousness is inspiration. Intuition is meditation which leads to consciousness of essence of the hierarchies of consciousness. Through intuition man becomes conscious of that, what beings of the hierarchies of consciousness are conscious of and thus he includes consciousness of beings in his consciousness. The exercises in imagination, inspiration and intuition develop use of forces of thinking, feeling and willing. The development of qualities allow to regulate their use so, that man becomes master of three forces of soul, uses them in full consciousness and remains independent from single beings of the hierarchies of consciousness.

Man has possibility to develop faculties and qualities in physical body, and thus he is protected by physical body from direct perception of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. If man consciously developed qualities in himself, then they remain his property also when he starts to perceive beings of the hierarchies of consciousness directly. Qualities allow him to remain independent of their influences. Man who begins the occult training without sufficient development of qualities, risks to get into dependence on beings, without the slightest idea about such dependence. Only faculties cannot guarantee safety of his freedom.

The exercises in imagination, inspiration and intuition are described by Rudolf Steiner in books *How to attain knowledge of the higher worlds?* and *Occult science in outline* in detail. There are also described dangers and difficulties which should not be neglected. Here will be given two examples of symbolic images.

From the geometry of Euclid it is known, that the sum of three angles of any triangle is always equal to two right angles. Triangle cannot be drawn or seen by physical eyes because it is impossible to draw or to see with physical eyes line, for line is length without breadth. It is possible to draw an image of triangle however this is not triangle itself. This will be symbolic image which depicts relations between those beings of the hierarchies of consciousness which cannot be seen by physical eyes. Such image of triangle can be evoked

mentally in consciousness. If to change angles or sides of triangle mentally, the sum of angles of triangle is kept the same. Then it is possible to imagine equilateral triangle as general image of all possible triangles. It is possible to attach to it feeling of balance and harmony which originates from keeping in consciousness of such image. This will be imagination. Then it is possible to remove image from consciousness and to be aware only of that pure activity of soul which creates such image. This pure activity of soul is connected with relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which are expressed in image of triangle. This will be inspiration. If to keep in consciousness that, what remains after removal of this pure activity of soul, then in consciousness of man will be revealed consciousness of beings of the hierarchies to which corresponds image of triangle. Man has then in consciousness thinking without thoughts generated by pure activity of soul. This will be intuition.

Through intuition it is possible to find out connection of image of equilateral triangle with the mission of the Earth which can be fulfilled by man through establishment of balance between the forces of willing, feeling and thinking.

In occult symbolism this mission of Earth has always been expressed in a special way by means of a geometrical figure. Amongst geometrical figures you will find none which corresponds to cooperation in a sense of balance so exactly as the equilateral triangle. If you draw an equilateral triangle you will find the three sides are equal, the three angles equal, the vertices are equidistant from each other and all are equidistant from the center. The center of an equilateral triangle is an absolute symbol of activity of balance, so that when the occultist beholds an equilateral triangle he can see in it a symbol of the absolutely balanced cooperation of that, what had the hegemony in three former incarnations of our Earth respectively. The deeds of the 'I' in man signify nothing else but the creation of an operative, an active center in nature of man whereby this state of balance can be prepared from within outwards. Man indeed is called to high destiny on our Earth namely to bring about from within outwards, through his whole being, first of all a balance between that what was predominant respectively in various ways and at various times.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 121. The Mission of the Individual Folk-Souls In Connection with Teutonic Mythology. Lecture on 11th June 1908.

The hierarchies of consciousness which are not perceived by physical sense organs constitute the so-called occult writing which could be learned to read and understand. Through imagination man learns to perceive beings of the hierarchies of consciousness in symbolic images. Symbolic images are thereby letters of the occult writing. Inspiration allows man to know the relations between beings of the hierarchies of consciousness and thus to read and understand the occult writing. Intuition allows man himself to have consciousness of the hierarchies of consciousness.

Consciousness of man is developing and according to consciousness changes the form of manifestation of man. Another symbolic image will be symbol of the form of man of the future. This symbolic image which is possible to find on the cover of the book is called the *Three-legged, Triskelion*. It is an ancient symbol of the island of Sicily representing the head of man with wings and three legs. This does not mean that man of the future will have physical legs and wings which will grow from his head. They are only symbolic expression of those relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which will be manifested as organs of man in the future. Rudolf Steiner describes these relations in the following way.

Bevor der Mensch sich aufrichtete, gab es eine Zeit, wo er auf allen vieren ging. Das ist der Ursprung des Rätsels, das die Sphinx aufgab, Sie fragte: Welches Wesen geht in seiner Kindheit auf allen vieren, in der Mitte seines Lebens auf zwei, im Alter auf drei Beinen? Ödipus antwortet ihm: Das ist der Mensch, der in der Tat als Kind auf allen vieren geht und als Greis sich auf einen Stock stützt. In Wirklichkeit bezieht sich das Rätsel und seine Lösung

auf die Entwicklung der ganzen Menschheit: Vergangenheit, Gegenwart und Zukunft, wie man sie in den alten Mysterien kannte. Vierfüßig in einer verflossenen Epoche seiner Evolution, hält sich der Mensch heute aufrecht auf zwei Beinen. In der Zukunft wird er fliegen und wird sich tatsächlich dreier Hilfsmittel bedienen: Die zwei Flügel, die sich aus der zweiblättrigen Lotusblume entwickeln werden das Organ seines Bewegungswillens sein, und außerdem das umgewandelte Werkzeug der linken Brüstseite und der linken Hand. Solcherart werden die Werkzeuge der zukünftigen Fortbewegung sein.

Ebenso wie die rechte Seite und die rechte Hand werden die gegenwärtigen Zeugungsorgane sich zurückbilden, und der Mensch wird, wie wir es weiter oben gesehen haben, seinesgleichen durch das Wort hervorbringen. Sein Wort wird im Ätherkörper seinesgleichen formen.

Before man assumed the upright posture there was a time when he moved on all fours. Such is the origin of the riddle that was given by the Sphinx. It asked: Who is the being which in infancy walks on all fours, in middle age on two, in old age on three legs? Oedipus answers it: This being is man, who indeed as a baby crawls on all fours, and as an old man leans on a stick. In reality, riddle and answer refer to the whole evolution of mankind, past, present and future, as it was known in, the ancient Mysteries. Quadraped in a former epoch of his evolution, man stands today upright on two legs. In the future he will fly and will indeed make use of triple organs, namely the two wings developed from the two-petalled lotus will be the organ of his will of movement, and besides, the transformed organ of the left half of the chest and of the left hand. Such a kind will be the organs of movement in the future.

The present organs of reproduction will atrophy as well as the right side and the right hand, and man will give birth to his like through the word. His word will produce like his own in etheric body.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 94. An Esoteric Cosmology.
Lecture on 30th May 1906.

An attainment of the higher level of consciousness in comparison with previous levels always means, that what was carried out by the hierarchies of consciousness on the previous level of consciousness, now man must carry out by himself. In the Vulcan state of consciousness the level of consciousness of man will be so high, that he will be able to form consciously his own kind through himself. Personalities, which stayed behind in the development of consciousness, will be able to develop their consciousness owing to the sacrifice of other personalities. Owing to the faculty to produce his own kind through himself man will provide possibility for personalities in the eighth sphere to be incarnated on the higher level of consciousness. Personalities with high developed consciousness will make free choice to connect the development of their consciousness with the development of consciousness of personalities of the eighth sphere.

The Guardian of the Threshold

Mastering of forces of thinking, feeling and willing makes man able to regulate connections between these forces of soul consciously. If previously the hierarchies of consciousness must provide harmony between them, then on certain level of consciousness man himself must regulate the relations between thinking, feeling and willing. Such level of consciousness man attains through the development of qualities and exercises in imagination, inspiration and intuition. This causes certain changes in relations between consciousness of man and hierarchies of consciousness. The consequences of these changes are that in the etheric body of man are formed three centres of consciousness: in the area of head, throat and heart. These centres of consciousness together with chakras allow man to have consciousness outside physical body. Thus, man reaches the threshold between sensible-physical world and

supersensible world. The proper achievement of this threshold is connected with experiences which are called the *encounter with lesser and greater Guardian* of the threshold.

Before man as a disciple is led to that point at which he can work on his etheric body at will, he must at least, to a certain extent be able to evaluate Karma, be able to achieve self-knowledge. Meditation therefore should not be undertaken without continual self-knowledge, self-observation. By this means will be achieved that at the right moment man will behold the Guardian of the Threshold: the Karma which he has still to wear away. When one reaches this stage being in normal state it merely means nothing else but knowledge of his still available Karma. If I begin to work into my etheric body, I must make it my aim to compensate my still existing Karma.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 93a. Foundations of Esotericism.
Lecture on 27th September 1905.

The lesser Guardian of the threshold is a real being in which the Karma of man is reflected and in which thoughts, feelings and desires are manifested, that do not correspond to rhythms of the development of consciousness of mankind. This is the astral double of man which possesses consciousness and can influence free choice of man. In the astral double are reflected all those connections of man with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness which correspond to his vices. Perception of the lesser Guardian of the threshold allows man for the first time to know himself as such as he has made of himself through his free choice. If man attained sufficient degree of the development of qualities in order to pass over to the higher level of consciousness, then from now on he must transform his astral double by himself consciously. If previously the hierarchies of consciousness provided protection against influence of the astral double, then now man must do it himself through control of thinking, feeling and willing. Man endangers to come under influence of the astral double and become dependent on vices which he himself manifested.

If man concedes to influence of the astral double, then his astral consciousness becomes deformed and free choice of man will be influenced from now on by his astral double. If qualities of man are developed high enough and he is able to regulate himself the connections between thinking, feeling and willing, then man has possibility to become conscious of that ideal to which he can direct the development of his consciousness. This is the encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold. Thoughts, feelings, willing of man on this level of consciousness are real beings, and his further path depends on his free choice whether to strive or not to the attainment of consciousness of the greater Guardian of the threshold. It appears to man as an ideal of consciousness which can be attained if man will follow rhythms of the development of consciousness of mankind. In this ideal are reflected those qualities of Jesus Christ which allowed him to attain the highest consciousness among personalities in the manifested world structure. Thus, the encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold is the encounter with the Christ.

Man has then free choice to follow the Christ-principle - the principle of union of all personalities. If he chooses not to follow it, then further path of the development of consciousness of man can become even more egoistic, than it was till now. On this path it is possible to find satisfaction of the greatest egoism therefore this path is called the *black path*. Man who has chosen the black path will stay behind rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind in the future. It is absolutely not obviously that man will choose to follow the principle of Christ. Through the astral double man becomes accessible to the temptations of satisfaction of personal egoism which are immeasurably exceeded those, which man can encounter in physical body. Before the encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold man was engaged in the self-perfection. He could develop qualities and faculties and improve his Karma irrespective of what qualities and faculties could develop other personalities. To follow the Christ-principle means to direct all richness of personal qualities

and faculties on rendering the assistance in perfection of other personalities. The consequence of following the Christ-principle will be the development of consciousness of personality according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind.

Jesus Christ is integral part of reality. If there is real personality it is possible to become conscious of its existence, to perceive it and, consequently, to encounter with it. Christ cannot be seen with the physical eyes however it is possible to perceive him with supersensible organs of perception. Any system of self-perfection which leads to knowledge of the supersensible reality, will lead to perception of the reality of Jesus Christ also. Any system of self-perfection which leads to proper development of qualities and faculties of man, will also lead to the encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold. To pass the greater Guardian of the threshold will mean to attain consciousness of freedom from egoism.

One of the most ancient systems of the development of consciousness is yoga. It existed already during the first old Indian culture period. During this period of the development of consciousness of mankind, the relations between physical, etheric and astral bodies of man were different, than they are now. Therefore the system of yoga which Patanjali described in *Yoga-Sutras* differs from yoga of the first old Indian culture period. Patanjali expounded the stages of the yoga system in such a way that they become suitable to changed consciousness of man. In *Yoga-Sutras* are described eight stages of yoga:

Yama, Niyama, Asana, Pranayama, Pratyahara, Dharana, Dhyana, Samadhi are the limbs of Yoga.

Patanjali. *Yoga-Sutras*. 2.29.

Why the yoga system is stated in eight stages, it is possible to understand if to consider, that the development of consciousness of mankind goes through the seven states of consciousness: Saturn, Sun, Moon, Earth, Jupiter, Venus, Vulcan. These states of consciousness correspond to the seven stages of yoga. The eighth stage of yoga is connected with that, that the personalities which have stayed behind in the development of consciousness will form the eighth sphere. In order that the personality could attain the self-perfection, it must attain consciousness of itself as of the absolute Spirit. However to attain consciousness of oneself as of the absolute Spirit can only all personalities together. Until there exists the eighth sphere, no personality can reach perfection. The eighth sphere must be transformed into the sphere of perfection. This state of transformation corresponds to the eighth stage of yoga, that unites the previous seven. Thus, in the stages of yoga are contained the preconditions for the achievement of perfection of all personalities together. The highest consciousness of this perfection has Jesus Christ. Therefore the proper development of consciousness according the yoga system will lead also to the encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold.

During the first old Indian culture period the personality of Christ was known as the Vishva-Karman. In order to perceive Christ during this period man had to be free from the terrestrial Karma and develop his consciousness outside the physical body. In the physical body man who perfected himself through yoga, could perceive with his consciousness other personality which is called Krishna. Consciousness of Krishna is that highest consciousness which man can attain if he will be engaged in self-perfection through the establishment of harmony between the manifestations of three Gunas: Sattva, Rajas and Tamas. Modern man is so connected with luciferic and ahrimanic beings, that he is not capable any more to reach this harmony by himself. After the incarnation of Christ, man in the physical body can reach this harmony of Gunas, if he follows the principle of love manifested through Christ. Only through the help of Christ he can reach the harmony of Gunas. The encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold becomes the necessity for man striving for the perfection through the yoga.

To understand that, what is meant in yoga system and to know the consequences of the exercises of yoga can only that man who already possesses the certain level of consciousness and faculties of supersensible perception. Therefore for safe development of consciousness by means of the eight stages of yoga it is necessary the presence of the Guru - the teacher in the physical body. Without such Guru the exercises according to the yoga system of Patanjali will lead to the infringements of health. To follow the yoga system of Patanjali there are necessary the direct communication with the Guru and special conditions of life. Therefore independently to follow the yoga system of Patanjali to the modern man it is possible only in exceptional cases.

The Buddhism is another system of self-perfection in which also is provided the possibility of the encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold. It is possible to find the following words in the text of Dhammapada:

Do not what is evil. Do what is good. Keep your mind pure. This is the teaching of Buddha.

The Dhammapada. The path of perfection.

Chapter 14. The Buddha (183).

The free choice of man manifests the good or evil, depending on the conformity to the rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. When the mind of man is pure, then man is free from lusts and can know intuitively. The pure mind allows man to perceive the rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind and to make the free choice according to it. As Jesus Christ is the personality with the highest consciousness, then his free choice most of all corresponds to the rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Therefore man with pure mind is able to become conscious of the greater Guardian of the threshold.

Man who properly develops the qualities and faculties of the eightfold path attains consciousness of Buddha. The consciousness of Buddha is consciousness of love and compassion which is free from egoism and the highest consciousness of love and compassion among all personalities has Jesus Christ. Therefore if the encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold does not occur, then that means that qualities of man are insufficiently developed to attain consciousness of freedom from egoism.

Man may not have the supersensible faculties at all and reach the freedom from egoism during life in the physical body. It is not well known fact, that Mother Teresa (Agnesa Gonxhe Bojaxhiu), having passed through the death, has also passed the greater Guardian of the threshold and reached the level of the teacher. She could follow the Christ-impulse during the life in the physical body. To follow the Christ-impulse means, that man leads the life so, that it corresponds to the development of quality of the freedom from egoism and to consciousness of unity of all people. If to consider the supersensible faculties, which has Gautama Buddha in the physical body, then it is possible to find out, that Mother Teresa had not them. However, if to compare their qualities, it is possible to find them equal, because they were enough to reach the level of the teacher. The way of the development of qualities was different. Gautama Buddha developed the qualities the eightfold path in the solitude through the meditation and contemplation. The development of qualities of Mother Teresa occurred through the help to other people in their everyday life. Both, however, have developed the quality of love and reached the freedom from egoism. Both can be called saint because the concept of saint means that man has the quality of the freedom from egoism. In general, everyone who has reached consciousness of the freedom from egoism, it is necessary to call saint. As concerns the supersensible faculties, then to develop them for man who possesses the qualities, does not makes the great difficulty. Between the births of Gautama Buddha and Mother Teresa in the physical body has passed about 2500 years. During this time interval the qualities of Buddha have received the further development, and he has reached the level of consciousness which exceeds the level of consciousness of Mother

Teresa. But if to compare the qualities which Gautama Buddha and Mother Teresa have at the end of their life in the physical body, then their qualities corresponded to the qualities of consciousness of the freedom from egoism. Thus, to have the supersensible faculties is not necessary to attain the new level of consciousness.

The personal message

You can develop the supersensible faculties of perception by yourself. For the proper development of supersensible faculties it is necessary for you to acquire the corresponding qualities. The life always provides for you the possibility for the development of qualities. The conscious development of qualities and supersensible faculties leads you to the initiation. The level of your consciousness will be determined by the level of the development of your qualities.

The main conclusions

The initiation leads to the continuity of consciousness of the eternal life. The initiation is acquired through the development of qualities and faculties. The faculties are determined by how the personality can use the relations with the hierarchies of consciousness through the free choice for the manifestation of good and evil. How far the personality applies faculty to manifest only good, is determined by the qualities, properties or virtues of the personality. The golden rule says: For every single step that you take in seeking knowledge of hidden truths, you must take three steps in perfecting your character toward the good. The qualities acquired by man on one level of consciousness, remain valid on any other level of consciousness. The path to the initiation is opened to any man irrespective of, whether he strives through the free choice to manifest good or evil. The access to knowledge which man can reach on the path of the initiation depends not so much on his faculties, but rather on his qualities. The knowledge attained on the path to the initiation, must not violate the freedom of choice of no personality. If the path of the initiation leads to the violation of the free choice of the personality, then that is the path of black magic. The black magic is the use of the beings of the hierarchies that violates the freedom of choice of man, with the objective to achieve the satisfaction of one's own lusts and desires. The supersensible organs of perception, the Chakras or the lotus flowers are the astral formations and are situated in the astral body of man. The proper development of Chakras occurs through the acquirement of qualities. For the development of the supersensible faculties for modern man are suitable the methods of imagination, inspiration, intuition. The lesser Guardian of the threshold is the astral double of man. The greater Guardian of the threshold is the ideal of the development of consciousness of man. The encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold is the encounter with the Christ. To pass the greater Guardian of the threshold means to attain the qualities of the freedom from egoism. The life always provides the possibilities of the development of qualities of the freedom from egoism.

Chapter 6

The journeys out of the body

The first changes which occur to man who is engaged in the development of supersensible faculties, become noticeable to him in sleep as a rule. The life of dreams emerges in symbolic images which become ever more regular. Man gradually becomes able to remember dreams first and to experience them consciously afterwards. The conscious dreaming means in the beginning the conscious experience of symbolic images in the astral body. In unconscious sleep the astral body of man influences the etheric or life body in the restoring way. Such influence of the astral body is necessary to understand as the influence of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness manifested in the astral body of man. However, the astral body of man is not able yet to carry out by itself the restoring activity and at the same time to support the waking consciousness of man in the astral body. To be conscious in the astral body and not to lose life forces man must be able to restore them by himself. Thereby if man does not acquire the six qualities necessary for development of the twelve-petalled lotus flower, then he risks to be connected with certain beings and to become dependent from them.

If man builds all these qualities in himself, then such a rhythm comes into his internal life that the astral body does not need to do the regeneration in the sleeping any more. Since such a balance comes by these exercises into the etheric body that it can restore and protect itself. Who begins the occult training without education of these six qualities, he runs the risk and at night is put out to the worst beings. Who has practiced, however, six qualities for a while, he may begin to develop his astral senses, and then he starts sleeping with consciousness. His dreams are no more arbitrary, but they win regularity; the astral world climbs up before him. Now he has the ability to perceive all what is psychic (mental) of his surroundings in pictures. He gets a relation to the soul-reality. One calls this picture consciousness the imagination. First the disciple wins the imagination in the sleep, later however he must be able to cause this state at any time of day. He learns to take the experiences of the sleep in the waking consciousness. But only then this ability is valuable for the occultist if he can look the aura of the living beings full-conscious.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 94. Popular Occultism.
Lecture on 9th July 1906.

The connection with beings

The connection with beings from which man can become dependent is preserved as long as man consciously - by himself or by means of other personalities - can break it. The dependence from beings, established in one life in physical body, is not broken through death and is preserved in next birth. Such connection with beings could allow man to develop wonderful faculties and do not care about restoring activity of his astral body, However consciousness of man remains thus on the same level. Though such man can be ahead of modern man in the development of his faculties, he will stay behind in the development of his consciousness because rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind will be changed. The dependence from beings will not allow him to have the level of consciousness appropriating to new rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Man can then have only that consciousness which corresponds to the level of consciousness of dependence from beings of the hierarchies of consciousness.

An example of such dependence from beings can be found in the book of Robert Allan Monroe *The Journeys Out of the Body*. The author, after he has detected in himself the faculty

to be self-conscious outside physical body, describes his experience. For an understanding it is important to consider the following experience in that condition of consciousness which author calls *Locale II*:

And yet, at times, in visiting Locale II, a very unusual event periodically occurs. It makes no difference where in Locale II, the event is the same.

In the midst of normal activity, whatever it may be, there is a distant Signal, almost like heraldic trumpets. Everyone takes the Signal calmly, and with it, everyone stops speaking or whatever he may be doing. It is the Signal that He (or They) is coming through His Kingdom. There is no awestruck prostration or falling down on one's knees.

Rather, the attitude is most matter-of-fact. It is an occurrence to which all are accustomed and to comply takes absolute precedence over everything. There are no exceptions.

At the Signal, each living thing lies down-my impression is on their backs, bodies arched to expose the abdomen (not the genitals), with head turned to one side so that one does not see Him as He passes by. The purpose seems to be to form a living road over which He can travel. I have gleaned the idea that occasionally He will select someone from this living bridge, and that person is never seen or heard from again. The purpose of the abdominal exposure is an expression of faith and complete submissiveness, the abdomen being the most vulnerable part of the body or the area that can suffer damage most easily. There is no movement, not even thought, as He passes by. Everything has come to a momentary standstill, full and complete, while He passes.

In the several times that I have experienced this, I lay down with the others. At the time, the thought of doing otherwise was inconceivable. As He passes, there is a roaring musical sound and a feeling of radiant, irresistible living force of ultimate power that peaks overhead and fades in the distance. I remember wondering once what would happen to me if He discovered my presence, as a temporary visitor. I wasn't sure I wanted to find out.

After His passing, everyone gets up again and resumes their activities. There is no comment or mention of the incident, no further thought of it. There is complete acceptance of the event as an ordinary part of their lives, and this is the great yet subtle difference. It is an action as casual as halting for a traffic light at a busy intersection, or waiting at the railroad crossing when the signal indicates that a train is coming; you are unconcerned and yet feel unspoken respect for the power represented in the passing train. The event is also impersonal.

Is this God? Or God's son? Or His representative?

Robert A. Monroe. *Journeys Out of the Body*.
Chapter 8. Cause The Bible Tells Me So.

Monroe could not find an answer to his questions and that is why. Everything is manifested through beings of the hierarchies of consciousness, which have this or that level of consciousness, life and form. A being with higher level of consciousness is always able to become conscious of that, what a being with lower level of consciousness is conscious of. A being with lower level of consciousness may not be conscious of an existence of a being with higher level of consciousness at all. And, the higher is consciousness, the higher and finer is the level of life energy and form through which consciousness of being can be manifested. The highest manifested being in the world structure is his higher 'I', his individuality. Life always means an exchange of consciousness and life energy between beings. All is alive and conscious. And the purpose of life for man is the development of such level of consciousness on which he can become most full conscious of himself as the 'I'. In order to fulfil his own desires, man must make free choice. The free choice is carried out either by beings which constitute his own being or by beings which are outside of being of man. During fulfilment of desire to get satisfaction of lust by beings which are outside man, occurs such exchange of consciousness and life energy which is experienced by man in certain sensations of pleasure. Thereby, however, beings become a part of being of man, connecting to his physical,

energetic, astral or spiritual limbs. A being becomes part of human being and forms united life or energy ring with man. Man must always pay for satisfaction of his egoistical desires with his consciousness, with his life energy. The energy spent for connection with beings which carry out desire of man, is spent from now on not on the development of consciousness of man, but on the maintenance of connection with beings. Therefore a choice of man becomes dependent from the connection with beings. Man changes his freedom, his development of consciousness for connection with beings, for fulfilment of desire, for personal pleasure.

Monroe became dependent from such beings, wishing to make out-of-body journeys. Thereby such dependence will not be broken through death. Beings carry out his desire to travel outside of the body giving him the energy necessary for this and in exchange take away the energy necessary for development of his consciousness. And the being, which gives him energy directly, is part of consciousness or servant of energetically even more powerful being, the encounter with which is described in given citation. Therefore, Monroe cannot see neither the energy nor the being itself, which gives him the energy to travel out of the body, nor its master, one of those beings which according to the Indian terminology are called *Asuras*. *Asuras* have the level of consciousness of the Archai or the Primal Beginnings. Monroe is compelled, expressing full submission, to lay down with his stomach up and to turn his head to one side. In the area of stomach there is the energetic centre of willing of man and in his head - the centre of thinking and consciousness. The given citation describes not only the state of external submission, but also submission of willing, consciousness and feeling of man in exchange to travel out of the body. Man, not becoming conscious of it, becomes servant of being which is immeasurably lower, than his higher 'I'. Calling to travel outside of the body in his books Monroe, without being aware of it, is calling for to establish connection with beings, which use the energy of consciousness. Thus he carries out not so much his own willing, but rather willing which originates from being with which he is connected. From here it could become clear the whole sense of breathing exercises made through the mouth for the achievement of the state to travel out of the body and which are described by Monroe. These exercises serve to the establishment of connection with being which gives the energy to travel out of the body in exchange of the energy of consciousness. It also may become clear why in all breathing exercises of Hatha-Yoga an in-breathing is made only through the nose. For the inhalation through mouth, establishes connection with beings which use the energy of consciousness of man.

It is possible to specify some general characteristic features when under the influence of beings the authors of books or articles on the out-of-body experience call to travel out of the body. First of all, the call for the out-of-body experience itself or its eulogy is already the call for the connection with beings. Then, it is not mentioned how to get energy for the out-of-body experience and how to preserve independence from beings. Instead the methods are specified which lead to the connection with beings. Nothing is said about necessity of the development of qualities, which allow become conscious of the methods of restoring the energy. Man who is really conscious of how to get the energy and how big is the risk to become dependent from beings will not call for the out-of-body experience.

The premises of magic

Consciousness of the symbolic images which man can have in dreaming at first is the rest of dim twilight consciousness which man had in the Moon state of consciousness. In this state man was clairvoyant, but not self-conscious, therefore his free choice still corresponded to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Man began to attain self-consciousness since the Lemurean period of the development of consciousness on the Earth. The more man in physical body acquired self-consciousness, the more he lost the natural faculty of supersensible perception. During the Atlantic period of the development of

consciousness man was still able to perceive beings and interact with beings directly. The conscious use of beings for the development of consciousness, according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind, is called *magic*. During the Atlantic period man had faculties to become the natural *sorcerer (magician)*. Man became the black sorcerer if he used beings for personal objectives that which not correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind and, consequently, violated the freedom of choice of other men. The black magic was the reason why the Atlantic period of the development of consciousness ended with the catastrophe.

Toward the middle of the Atlantean period of development a great disaster gradually began to manifest itself within mankind. The secrets of the initiates ought to have been carefully guarded from such men who had not purified their astral bodies of error through preparation. When these men acquire a certain insight into hidden knowledge, into the laws by which the higher beings guide the forces of nature, they then turn them at the service of their perverted needs and passions. The danger was all the greater, since men, as already described, came into the realm of lower spiritual beings which, unable to participate in the regular Earth development, acted therefore contrary to it. These spiritual beings influenced men constantly by inflowing in them interests that were, in truth, directed against the well-being of mankind. But men had still the ability to put the forces of growth and reproduction of animal and human nature into their own service. - Not only ordinary men, but also a number of the initiates succumbed to the temptations of lower spiritual beings. They went so far as to put in their service the mentioned supersensible forces in a way that ran counter to the development of mankind. And for this service they sought associates who were not initiated and who applied the secrets of the supersensible working of nature entirely for lower ends. The consequence was a great corruption of mankind. The evil spread further and further. And since the forces of growth and reproduction, when wrested from their natural topsoil and used independently, stand in a mysterious mutual connection with certain forces that work in air and water, mighty, harmful nature forces were unfettered by human deeds. This led to the gradual destruction of the Atlantean region through terrestrial catastrophes of air and water. The Atlantean mankind - insofar as it did not perish in the storms - was compelled to emigrate. On the one side, Europe, Asia, and Africa received gradually the shapes they have today. On the other side emerges America. To these lands went great migrations. For our present day the most important of these migrations were those that went eastward from Atlantis. Europe, Asia, Africa, became gradually populated by the descendants of the Atlanteans.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 13. An Outline of Occult Science.
Chapter 4. The Development of the World and Man.

For the development of consciousness in magic it was used the direct connection of man with beings with an objective to learn to preserve the waking consciousness out of the physical body. Having learned to keep consciousness out of the physical body, it is possible to continue the development of the 'I'-consciousness, without to be incarnated in physical body any more. Thereby man endangers to get in the dependence from beings and to become a black sorcerer. Magic as system of the development of consciousness was widespread on the American continent. The knowledge of magic was secret and was passed over from benefactor, teacher - Nagual, to the disciple directly, forming the lineage of sorcerers. The premises of magic were published in books of Carlos Castaneda where they were described as taught to him by his teacher, the Nagual Don Juan:

I have written in that manner about the premises of sorcery just as don Juan explained them to me, within the context of his teaching.

In his teaching scheme, which was developed by sorcerers of ancient times, there were two categories of instruction. One was called "teachings for the right side," carried out in the ordinary state of awareness. The other was called "teachings for the left side," put into practice solely in states of heightened awareness.

These two categories allowed teachers to school their apprentices toward three areas of expertise: the mastery of awareness, the art of stalking, and the mastery of intent.

These three areas of expertise are the three riddles sorcerers encounter in their search for knowledge.

The mastery of awareness is the riddle of the mind; the perplexity sorcerers experience when they recognize the astounding mystery and scope of awareness and perception.

The art of stalking is the riddle of the heart; the puzzlement sorcerers feel upon becoming aware of two things: first that the world appears to us to be unalterably objective and factual, because of peculiarities of our awareness and perception; second, that if different peculiarities of perception come into play, the very things about the world that seem so unalterably objective and factual change. The mastery of intent is the riddle of the spirit, or the paradox of the abstract - sorcerers' thoughts and actions projected beyond our human condition.

Don Juan's instruction on the art of stalking and the mastery of intent depended upon his instruction on the mastery of awareness, which was the cornerstone of his teachings, and which consist of the following basic premises:

1. The universe is an infinite agglomeration of energy fields, resembling threads of light.
2. These energy fields, called the Eagle's emanations, radiate from a source of inconceivable proportions metaphorically called the Eagle.
3. Human beings are also composed of an incalculable number of the same threadlike energy fields. These Eagle's emanations form an encased agglomeration that manifests itself as a ball of light the size of the person's body with the arms extended laterally, like a giant luminous egg.
4. Only a very small group of the energy fields inside this luminous ball are lit up by a point of intense brilliance located on the ball's surface.
5. Perception occurs when the energy fields in that small group immediately surrounding the point of brilliance extend their light to illuminate identical energy fields outside the ball. Since the only energy fields perceivable are those lit by the point of brilliance, that point is named "the point where perception is assembled" or simply "the assemblage point."
6. The assemblage point can be moved from its usual position on the surface of the luminous ball to another position on the surface, or into the interior. Since the brilliance of the assemblage point can light up whatever energy field it comes in contact with, when it moves to a new position it immediately brightens up new energy fields, making them perceivable. This perception is known as seeing.
7. When the assemblage point shifts, it makes possible the perception of an entirely different world - as objective and factual as the one we normally perceive. Sorcerers go into that other world to get energy, power, solutions to general and particular problems, or to face the unimaginable.
8. Intent is the pervasive force that causes us to perceive. We do not become aware because we perceive; rather, we perceive as a result of the pressure and intrusion of intent.
9. The aim of sorcerers is to reach a state of total awareness in order to experience all the possibilities of perception available to man. This state of awareness even implies an alternative way of dying.

A level of practical knowledge was included as part of teaching the mastery of awareness. On that practical level don Juan taught the procedures necessary to move the assemblage point. The two great systems devised by the sorcerer seers of ancient times to accomplish this were: dreaming, the control and utilization of dreams; and stalking, the control of behavior.

Moving one's assemblage point was an essential maneuver that every sorcerer had to learn. Some of them, the Naguals, also learned to perform it for others. They were able to dislodge the assemblage point from its customary position by delivering a hard slap directly to the assemblage point. This blow, which was experienced as a smack on the right shoulder blade - although the body was never touched - resulted in a state of heightened awareness.

Carlos Castaneda. The Power Of Silence.
Introduction.

Knowledge which was published by Carlos Castaneda is not theoretical and is based on the direct supersensible perception it is as spiritual-scientific as, for example, knowledge described by Rudolf Steiner. The difference exists in different supersensible perception of the reality. The spiritual essence of the description of the manifested reality is, however, the same. Carlos Castaneda describes the reality manifested through separate, infinite and at the same time grouped in bands and clusters emanations, each of which has self-consciousness. This is the description of the hierarchies of consciousness, or the hierarchies of beings. The emanations originate from the source called the *Eagle*, which is the manifested world structure. Carlos Castaneda describes the perception of the Eagle as follows:

There is nothing visual about the Eagle. The entire body of a seer senses the Eagle. There is something in all of us that can make us witness with our entire body. Seers explain the act of seeing the Eagle in very simple terms: because man is composed of the Eagle's emanations, man need only revert back to his components. The problem arises with man's awareness; it is his awareness that becomes entangled and confused.

At the crucial moment when it should be a simple case of the emanations acknowledging themselves, man's awareness is compelled to interpret. The result is a vision of the Eagle and the Eagle's emanations. But there is no Eagle and no Eagle's emanations. What is out there is something that no living creature can grasp.

Carlos Castaneda. The Fire From Within.
Chapter 3. The Eagle's emanations.



The description of the Eagle must be understood as symbolic image which reflects the reality, manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness. The image corresponds to the drawing made by Rudolf Steiner. The drawing is an imaginative image of the manifested world structure. It is possible to find also some analogy with the "flying" Eagle who "bears" three main levels or three main stages of consciousness on itself. The lower dark parts correspond to the level of consciousness which allows man to become conscious of only one object simultaneously. The middle dark part corresponds to the level of consciousness which allows man to become conscious of several objects simultaneously. This is the level of consciousness of the teachers which corresponds to the level of consciousness of the freedom from egoism. The upper dark part corresponds to the level of consciousness which can be called *cosmic consciousness*. The trinity is presented by the three lower parts, "wings" and

"tail" of the Eagle. The middle lower part corresponds to Christ, the lower part, to the side of which the "flight" of Eagle is directed, corresponds to Lucifer, and the remained lower part corresponds to Ahriman. Thus, the development of consciousness in the world structure inclines towards the wisdom of Lucifer. The duality is presented by the dark and white places in the drawing. The surface of dark places corresponds to the time which man spends on one level of consciousness before he ascends onto the next upper level. The access to the next main level of consciousness is determined by qualities of man which he acquires by himself. The white places correspond to the uncountable intermediate levels of consciousness in the world structure which are between the three main levels of consciousness.

The same level of consciousness can be attained by means of different systems. The methods used in different systems, can be various, but principles of the development of consciousness are always the same. Rudolf Steiner describes, for example, two methods of initiation: the method of immersing of consciousness inside the human being and the method of the widening of consciousness in outer cosmos. Carlos Castaneda describes the same, speaking about the movement of the assemblage point inside and outside of the energetic cocoon. Rudolf Steiner describes the following stages of the development of consciousness, which were mentioned by Carlos Castaneda also:

Such are the stages which today, as at all times, have to be lived through by those men who wish to soar themselves up to clairvoyant investigation, who wish to look through the veil which is drawn over the real world in the earthly elements. These stages are described now: the feeling of freedom concerning one's second personality, like that of a sword in its sheath, the feeling of this personality being outside the physical body, as if the sword were drawn out of its sheath; the encounter with the Guardian of the Threshold; the experiencing of the beings of the elements, that is, experiencing the great moment when the beings of Fire, Air, Water and Earth become beings among whom we walk and with whom we associate as in ordinary life we associate with men; and then, living through the moment when we experience the primeval being of these beings of the elements. These are the stages which could be experienced at all times and which can still be experienced today. These are the stages - already often described in another way, for they can be described in many ways, and still the description always remains imperfect! - leading upwards into the spiritual worlds.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 113. The East in the Light of the West, the Children of Lucifer and the Brothers of Christ. Lecture on 24th August 1909.

Carlos Castaneda describes, for example, the losing of the human form to which the correspondence also could be found in writings of Rudolf Steiner. The losing of the human form occurs when consciousness of man attains such level, that he is capable to control the forces of thinking, feeling and willing consciously. This corresponds in the book of Rudolf Steiner *How to attain knowledge of the higher worlds?* to liberation of the forces of thinking, feeling and willing from their natural interrelations.

In the same book it is possible to find the description of conscious control of thinking, feeling and willing and creation of the centre of consciousness in the etheric body in the area of head, throat and heart. The art of the mastery of the forces of thinking, feeling and willing Carlos Castaneda describes as follows: *the mastery of awareness* as the riddle of the mind, *the mastery of stalking* as the riddle of the heart, and *the mastery of intent* as the riddle of the spirit. Such mastery leads to the attainment of consciousness described through three positions of the assemblage point: *the position of reason*, *the position of no pity* and *the position of silent knowledge*.

<i>Positions of the assemblage point</i>	<i>Centres of consciousness in the etheric body</i>
Reason	Area of head

No pity	Area of throat
Silent knowledge	Area of heart

Rudolf Steiner describes how man after death must relinquish all such ideas, concepts, feelings, which do not correspond to the reality and which constitute his waking consciousness. The reality is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness. Man, losing his physical body after death, begins to perceive beings of the hierarchies of consciousness directly. If during life in physical body consciousness of man was build through the concepts that do not correspond to the reality, for example, through the concepts of materialism, then after death he must lose such consciousness. He relinquishes all concepts which were connected with physical time and space. The evolution is the development of consciousness therefore man after death must relinquish the concepts of old consciousness in order to have possibility to attain new consciousness in following rhythms of the development of consciousness of mankind. This corresponds to the symbolic description of the Eagle which devours the awareness of man at the moment of death:

He [don Juan] said that the old seers, risking untold dangers, actually saw the indescribable force which is the source of all sentient beings. They called it the Eagle, because in the few glimpses that they could sustain, they saw it as something that resembled a black-and-white eagle of infinite size.

They saw that it is the Eagle who bestows awareness. The Eagle creates sentient beings so that they will live and enrich the awareness it gives them with life. They also saw that it is the Eagle who devours that same enriched awareness after making sentient beings relinquish it at the moment of death.

“For the old seers,” don Juan went on, “to say that the reason for existence is to enhance awareness is not a matter of faith or deduction. They saw it”.

“They saw that the awareness of sentient beings flies away at the moment of death and floats like a luminous cotton puff right into the Eagle's beak to be consumed. For the old seers that was the evidence that sentient beings live only to enrich the awareness that is the Eagle's food.”

Carlos Castaneda. The Fire From Within.
Chapter 3. The Eagle's emanations.

In order to develop the ‘I’-consciousness, personality must become conscious of its separation from other personalities. Personality must become conscious of itself as the ‘I’ separated from the outer surroundings. This also creates the basis for self-importance. Self-importance must not be underestimated and not to be overestimated. The world structure cannot be manifested without personalities, but also personalities cannot exist without the manifested world structure. Self-importance is the basis for the achievement of consciousness of the freedom from egoism. It is also the basis for the achievement of the freedom of egoism, the basis of the dependence from beings and the basis of black magic. From here originates the necessity of such strategy of the development of consciousness which it is called in magic as the path of warrior.

“Self-importance is not something simple and naive,” he [don Juan] explained. “On the one hand, it is the core of everything that is good in us, and on the other hand, the core of everything that is rotten. To get rid of the self-importance that is rotten requires a masterpiece of strategy. Seers, through the ages, have given the highest praise to those who have accomplished it.”

Carlos Castaneda. The Fire From Within.
Chapter 2. Petty Tyrants.

The art of stalking

In order to reach the level of consciousness of the freedom from egoism, it is necessary to develop qualities. The attainment of qualities makes man the warrior on the path of the achievement of the freedom from egoism. Qualities determine the level of the impeccability of warrior and the level of energy which warrior can reach owing to his qualities. For the development of qualities of the warrior in magic it was used stalking - the art of the control of behaviour in the outer life.

Don Juan said then that in the strategic inventories of warriors, self-importance figures as the activity that consumes the greatest amount of energy, hence, their effort to eradicate it.

“One of the first concerns of warriors is to free that energy in order to face the unknown with it,” don Juan went on. “The action of rechanneling that energy is impeccability.”

He said that the most effective strategy was worked out by the seers of the Conquest, the unquestionable masters of stalking. It consists of six elements that interplay with one another. Five of them are called the attributes of warriorship: control, discipline, forbearance, timing, and will. They pertain to the world of the warrior who is fighting to lose self-importance. The sixth element, which is perhaps the most important of all, pertains to the outside world and is called the petty tyrant.

He explained that one of the greatest accomplishments of the seers of the Conquest was a construct he called the three-phase progression. By understanding the nature of man, they were able to reach the incontestable conclusion that if seers can hold their own in facing petty tyrants, they can certainly face the unknown with impunity, and then they can even stand the presence of the unknowable.

Carlos Castaneda. The Fire From Within.
Chapter 2. Petty Tyrants.

The art of stalking leads to the attainment of qualities, and thus, leads to the optimal redistribution of life energy. Qualities allow to keep consciousness on one level and to fixate position of the assemblage point optimally. Qualities attained in during life in physical body are preserved at the encounter with unknown and unknowable out of the physical body. The free choice of the personality is unknowable because it can not be known in advance even to the absolute Spirit, otherwise such choice would not be free. The unknown is manifested in the relations of the hierarchies of consciousness as the results of free choice of personalities, which are knowable. Life in physical body allows develop qualities, not perceiving beings of the hierarchies of consciousness directly. The encounter of man with the free choice of other personalities is the encounter with unknowable. And those warriors who encounter with the free choice of petty tyrant were put to special probation. Don Juan characterizes the petty tyrant in the following way:

“Just what is a petty tyrant?”

“A petty tyrant is a tormentor,” he [don Juan] replied. “Someone who either holds the power of life and death over warriors or simply annoys them to distraction.”

Carlos Castaneda. The Fire From Within.
Chapter 2. Petty Tyrants.

Sufferings which any tyrant can cause to man during life in physical body will be small in comparison with those sufferings which man can experience out of the physical body due to the connection with beings, for example, in Kamaloka. Out of the physical body man encounters with such beings, in comparison with those any tyrant in physical body will be petty. Hence, a description - *petty tyrant*.

The fastest development of qualities occurs when man in any life situation learns to make impeccable free choice which does not violate the freedom of choice of other personalities. It is most difficult to preserve impeccability when free choice of tyrant is directed against well-being, health and life of man itself. Therefore the encounter with tyrant provides the best conditions for the development of qualities of the warrior. Qualities allow man to make impeccable free choice which corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind and does not violate the freedom of choice of other personalities, including the free choice of tyrant. For realization of this are used the seven basic principles of stalking, which are described by Carlos Castaneda on the example of Florinda:

Florinda said that her benefactor gave all of them the example of what he meant, first by acting out his premises, and then by giving them the warrior's rationales for his actions. In her own case, he, being a master of the art of stalking, acted out the ploy of her disease and cure which not only was congruous with the warrior's way, but was a masterful introduction to the seven basic principles of the art of stalking. He first drew Florinda to his own battleground where she was at his mercy; he forced her to discard what was not essential; he taught her to put her life on the line with a decision; he taught her how to relax; in order to help her regroup her resources, he made her enter into a new arid different mood of optimism and self-confidence; he taught her to compress time; and finally he showed her that a stalker never pushes himself to the front.

Florinda was most impressed by the last principle. To her it summarized everything she wanted to tell me in her last-minute instructions.

Carlos Castaneda. Eagle's Gift.
Chapter 14. Florinda.

Stalking is the art of the control of behaviour, and behaviour is determined by free choice of man. Therefore the art of stalking is also the art of how to make choice which is free from egoism. This allows stalk how far man is free from the vices. Vice means the lack of qualities and specifies such connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness which does not correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Free choice must be carefully considered by man, because it is made through the absolute Spirit, creates Karma and can manifest evil. It becomes the command of the absolute Spirit and hence the Eagle's command which fixates the position of the assemblage point.

Consider this very carefully; our command becomes the Eagle's command.

Carlos Castaneda. The Fire From Within.
Chapter 7. The Assemblage Point.

The assemblage point is perception of the world structure according to the present level of the 'I'-consciousness of man reflected through his etheric cocoon. The level of the 'I'-consciousness of man it is namely that, what establishes and fixates the position of the assemblage point. It is determined by how far man is conscious of his 'I' as the absolute Spirit. As the absolute Spirit is perfect, then the more the qualities of man will be perfect, the more consciousness of man will correspond to consciousness of the absolute Spirit. The development of qualities allows make choice which is free from egoism, leads to the control of behaviour and to fixation of the assemblage point.

The principles of stalking can be described in the following way:

Act on one's own territory.

First of all, it is necessary always to start to act from that situation which exists now and which is the most known.

Discard what is unnecessary and make decision

Everything what can lead to personal benefit and to violation of the free choice of other man must be discarded. All possibilities of choice are known to the absolute Spirit, therefore only the absolute Spirit can know all possible results of free choice. The best result may be attained then, when to address to the absolute Spirit with the request to help to become conscious of and to make the best choice according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. In the Christianity this principle is expressed in words: *Not my will, but thine, be done* (St. Luke, 22:42).

Follow decision.

It is necessary to stay consequent and to follow the decision taken. This means make life to be conformed with decision. Any decision will have consequences which can correspond or not correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Therefore to follow decision means also to take responsibility for the development of consciousness in the manifested world structure.

Relax and attain balance.

Relaxation helps to establish balance between thinking, feeling and willing. It allows to be tuned on rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. If the free choice will correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind, then the efforts for its fulfilment also will be minimal.

Keep faith in decision.

The free choice which corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind, makes man self-confident, allows regroup his own resources and leads to the development of the quality of freedom from egoism.

Compress time.

Time is manifestation of rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind through beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. To compress time means to act on such level of consciousness on which the best result is attained. Therefore the more an action will correspond to rhythm of the development of mankind, the more will be compression of time.

Do not push yourself to the front.

To push oneself to the front means to follow one's own egoism, instead of rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. The stalker allows rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind to act through himself therefore the stalker does not push himself to the front.

The quality of freedom from egoism means the quality of impeccability. It allows man to have internal strength in order to move the assemblage point from within and to develop the supersensible faculties properly by himself.

Internal strength meant a sense of equanimity, almost of indifference, a feeling of being at ease, but, above all, it meant a natural and profound bent for examination, for understanding.

The new seers called all these traits of character sobriety.

"The conviction that the new seers have," he [don Juan] continued, "is that a life of impeccability by itself leads unavoidably to a sense of sobriety, and this in turn leads to the movement of the assemblage point."

"I've said that the new seers believed that the assemblage point can be moved from within. They went one step further and maintained that impeccable men need no one to guide them,

that by themselves, through saving their energy, they can do everything that seers do. All they need is a minimal chance, just to be cognizant of the possibilities that seers have unraveled.”

All that is required is impeccability, energy, and that begins with a single act that has to be deliberate, precise, and sustained. If that act is repeated long enough, one acquires a sense of unbending intent, which can be applied to anything else. If that is accomplished the road is clear. One thing will lead to another until the warrior realizes his full potential.

Carlos Castaneda. The Fire From Within.

Chapter 11. Stalking, Intent and the Dreaming Position.

The art of dreaming

If stalking allows develop qualities in physical body, dreaming allows to develop organs of supersensible perception out of the physical body. Unlike stalking, dreaming leads to the direct contact with beings, that is why, it is extremely dangerous practice of magic. The main danger consists is that for conscious dreaming are necessary expenses of energy, which man must be able to restore by himself in order to preserve his health and his independence from beings.

The sleep is the starting point for the consideration of the development of spiritual senses. The physical and etheric bodies of sleeping man are in bed, the astral body and I are outside them. If now man starts to become seer in sleep, then the forces, which have procured the restoration in physical and etheric body up to now, are took away from the body. They must be substituted in another way, if no great danger should originate for the physical and the etheric body. If this namely does not happen, these bodies come with their forces very much down, and amoral beings seize theirs. Hence, it can happen that although men develop the astral clairvoyance, but will become the immoral men.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 94. Popular Occultism.

Lecture on 9th July 1906.

Methods of the restoration of energy which can be used in dreaming were always secret and Carlos Castaneda only mentioned them indirectly. Man who allows himself to publish such methods, must take responsibility, as well as be able to help any man in case of misuse of methods. The danger to become the black sorcerer is too large to make these methods opened for everyone. Therefore such methods were passed from teacher to disciple orally. During conscious dreaming man must use these methods of restoration of energy in order not to harm his health. If one is not able to do this by oneself, then man will inevitably become dependent from beings, which Carlos Castaneda describes as inorganic beings.

The beings of elements of Earth, Water, Air and Fire belong to the inorganic beings. All beings of one element are controlled by one chief being - the king or the hierarch. According to the Indian tradition, the kings of beings of the Earth, Waters, Air and Fire are called accordingly Kshiti, Varuna, Vayu and Agni.

So we have a world of elemental beings around us with a king. Among the Indians the king of the gnomes is called Kshiti, the highest of the gnomes; the highest being among the undines: Varuna; the highest being among the sylphs: Vayu, and everything having its consciousness in fire is directed by the king of fire: Agni. In all activity connected with fire, water and so on we have to do with these particular Deva-beings. All the fire we have here on Earth is the substance that is woven out of the beings which belong to Agni. Ceremonial magic is the lowest kind of sorcery and consists in making use of certain tricks on the physical plane in order to create definite forms and beings on the astral plane. Schools exist today in which ceremonial magic is still exercised. Such usages cause great attraction towards the astral world and very frequently result in suicide, because then man is almost exclusively

active in the astral world and has become unaccustomed to accept the physical world for its own sake. He has developed an inclination towards the other world and the physical body is often a hindrance.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 93a. Foundations of Esotericism.
Lecture on 30th October 1905.

Carlos Castaneda describes his encounter with inorganic beings of the element of Water. The encounter with the manifestation of the king of the element of Water in dreaming which is described as the world of shadows in the book *The Art of Dreaming* nearly deprived Carlos Castaneda of possibility to live in physical body. Only owing to the help of other magicians of the lineage of Don Juan he managed to avoid the fate to stay in the world of the inorganic beings. Carlos Castaneda describes four gates of dreaming in detail. Every gate need to be reached and passed through. To reach the gates of dreaming means to reach certain level of supersensible experience and to pass them means not only to have those experiences which are described by Carlos Castaneda, but, first of all, to preserve one's own independence from beings.

In that sense the special danger have the fifth gate of dreaming. It is connected with the elemental beings of Earth, Water, Air and Fire. Man reaches the fifth gate of dreaming when he can consciously experience that, what the elemental beings experience. Man passes through the fifth gate of dreaming if he is able to stop this experience consciously. The danger of this gate of dreaming is that for consciousness of the elemental beings there is no experience of time. Therefore man, who reaches the fifth gate, cannot to determine by himself, how long he is in this state already. He risks stay in this state of consciousness until there exists the world of the elemental beings. Therefore before entering into this state, it is necessary to establish such relations with beings of the hierarchies, whose level of consciousness is higher than the level of consciousness of the elemental beings. This will allow man to interrupt the dreaming. For this purpose it is necessary, that man possesses sufficient qualities which define his impeccability.

The direct contact with inorganic beings provided to sorcerer possibility to use consciousness of the inorganic beings. Risking of getting into dependence from beings, the sorcerer could search for the answers to questions through them. Here there is the danger to mistake delusion for truth. These beings are able to reflect truly that delusion to which man already gives himself up subconsciously, but which he still is not conscious of in his waking consciousness. The sorcerer could accept his own delusion for what is true, if his qualities were not sufficient developed. The inorganic beings have no freedom of choice therefore their consciousness is true and they cannot lie.

The inorganic beings cannot lie.

Carlos Castaneda. The Art of Dreaming.
Chapter 7. The Blue Scout.

The contact with the inorganic beings gave the sorcerer opportunity to use the energy of inorganic beings. The reason why the sorcerer despite of dangers had to use the energy of inorganic beings is explained in the following way:

"Can you explain to me, don Juan, why sorcerers have to take energy from the realm of inorganic beings?"

"There is no other viable energy for sorcerers. In order to maneuver the assemblage point in the manner they do, sorcerers need an inordinate amount of energy."

I reminded him of his own statement: that a redeployment of energy is necessary in order to do dreaming.

"That is correct," he replied. "To start dreaming sorcerers need to redefine their premises and save their energy, but that redefining is valid only to have the necessary energy to set up dreaming. To fly into other realms, to see energy, to forge the energy body, et cetera, et cetera, is another matter. For those maneuvers, sorcerers need loads of dark, alien energy."

Carlos Castaneda. *The Art of Dreaming*.
Chapter 9. The New Area of Exploration.

The rule of the Nagual

The whole world structure is united set of the manifested beings, which have this or that level of consciousness. And the world structure itself, or the Eagle, possesses the highest manifested consciousness. In Carlos Castaneda's book *The Eagle's Gift* in the chapter *The Rule of the Nagual* is described in detail an image of the infinite Eagle who devours consciousness of man. There it is also described the rule according to which there is a possibility to pass to the next higher level of consciousness on the path to freedom. The essence of the rule is that for the group of sorcerers under the guidance of Nagual there is possibility to leave physical body, preserving waking consciousness and then to develop waking consciousness further out of the physical body. This rule could be applied only to the group of sorcerers who attained certain qualities and faculties and who have prepared the next group of sorcerers for the continuation of lineage. Only joint consciousness of sorcerers allowed them to reach the higher level of consciousness. For this purpose the following method was used:

Don Juan commented that by choosing total freedom, the new seers unwittingly continued in the tradition of their predecessors and became the quintbeing of the death defiers.

He explained that the new seers discovered that if the assemblage point is made to shift constantly to the confines of the unknown, but is made to return to a position at the limit of the known, then when it is suddenly released it moves like lightning across the entire cocoon of man, aligning all the emanations inside the cocoon at once.

"The new seers burn with the force of alignment," don Juan went on, "with the force of will, which they have turned into the force of intent through a life of impeccability. Intent is the alignment of all the amber emanations of awareness, so it is correct to say that total freedom means total awareness."

"Is that what all of you are going to do, don Juan?" I asked.

"We most certainly will, if we have sufficient energy," he replied. "Freedom is the Eagle's gift to man. Unfortunately, very few men understand that all we need, in order to accept such a magnificent gift, is to have sufficient energy. If that's all we need, then, by all means, we must become misers of energy."

Carlos Castaneda. *The Fire From Within*.
Epilogue.

This method was possible to apply only when all sorcerers reached such level of the development of qualities which allowed them to be free from Karma, created on the Earth. The moment of the alignment of all emanations is the moment of deliverance from the earthly Karma. Man continued the development in the etheric and astral body after he has left the physical body by such method. The peculiarity of this method is that man could not be incarnated in physical body on the Earth any more, until he could reach the level of consciousness of the freedom from egoism. This is connected with the use of *the fire of Kundalini*. The Kundalini fire is that being which connects various levels of consciousness. In other words, between the various levels of consciousness there is always Kundalini fire. All limbs of man: physical, etheric, astral bodies and so on are also connected between each other through the fire of Kundalini. The Kundalini fire keeps consciousness of man in the physical

body and allows him to return back into physical body from conscious dreaming at awakening.

In order to pass from the physical level of consciousness over onto the astral level of consciousness, it is necessary to withdraw partially the fire of Kundalini between the physical and etheric bodies and to use it for perception in the astral body. The alignment of all emanations in the etheric cocoon of man leads to the full and final withdrawal of the Kundalini fire from the physical body. After that, the etheric cocoon of man ceases to exist and together with this ceases to exist the physical body too, because relations between the hierarchies of consciousnesses, manifested as physical and the etheric bodies are not connected through Kundalini fire any more. If man can control the fire of Kundalini and keep the connection between the etheric and astral body consciously, then the etheric body is also preserved. However after the full withdrawal of the Kundalini fire man cannot be incarnated in physical body any more until he will reach the level of consciousness of the freedom from egoism. Qualities of the freedom from egoism allow man to restore the fire of Kundalini between the physical and etheric bodies consciously. If man begins to apply the methods of use of the Kundalini fire without attainment of sufficient qualities, then this will have only fatal consequences for him. What is the fire of Kundalini explains Rudolf Steiner:

Thus, what connects the astral body with the physical body and its organs, and what leads it back again? There exists a kind of tie, the connection, which is the intermediate matter between the physical and the astral matter. And this is called the fire of Kundalini.

Now, in the high-developed man in whom the Chakras are moving, there takes place yet another process. He has possibility to withdraw the fire of Kundalini from the organism arbitrarily; at the same time the opposite currents open themselves from within: Man can now regulate from within arbitrarily that, what earlier flowed only from outside in; now the whole process can be brought about arbitrarily. Now man has attained the perfect possibility of the disposal of the astral body.

The fire of Kundalini is thus the intermediate matter which connects single states with each other.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 88. About astral world and Devachan.
The development stages of mankind. Berlin, 29th December, 1903.

The rule of Nagual was used by all Naguals prior to Carlos Castaneda. They left the Earth together with the group of other seers and preserved their waking consciousness. The objective was to achieve that level of consciousness which means the freedom from egoism. The rule of Nagual was realized in the beginning of the Continental period and already after five hundred years from the beginning of the ancient Indian culture period the first group of sorcerers left the Earth. From here it is possible to imagine how old was the spiritual school which can be called the energetic school and which proceeded to exist almost up to the beginning of the third millennium.

The last Nagual who followed this rule, was Don Juan. Not all seers, who tried to leave the Earth by such method, have reached the objective. It is possible to tell, that all female warriors reached the desired level of consciousness. However some male warriors stayed behind on the intermediate levels of consciousness and could not preserve their independence from beings.

Why Carlos Castaneda has not followed this rule, could become clear if to consider, that the level of consciousness of the whole mankind to the beginning of the third millennium was so changed, that each man by himself can reach consciousness of the freedom from egoism. The path of the development of the 'I'-consciousness out of the physical body, on the one hand, was the fastest, and on the other hand, was one of the most dangerous for the achievement of consciousness of the freedom from egoism. With the change of the level of consciousness of mankind this path lost its actuality what meant the end of the spiritual energetic school of the lineage of Don Juan. Summing up of the results of this spiritual school

was one part of the mission of Carlos Castaneda. He has fulfilled this part of his mission after he described the experiences of this school in books. Carlos Castaneda acted according to the spiritual law which can be expressed in following words: *At the transition from one rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind to another, the former spiritual methods must become available in the new rhythm as well.*

The ordinary rational consciousness is already able to answer whether Carlos Castaneda and Don Juan were the black sorcerers. The conscious use of beings, which violates the freedom of choice of man, is called the black magic. The word *black* in expression *black magic* is not just an allegory, it reflects the special way of activity of the black sorcerer. To make his actions invisible to certain type of the Karmic beings which are responsible for the fulfilment of Karma, the sorcerer must contact beings which make his astral body black that is not radiating light, and, thus, invisible, whence comes the expression *black magic*. Of course, no sorcerer can escape his Karma, but through the connection with beings, it is possible to delay and by that even to make the Karmic payment worse. Beings which are able to make the astral body of sorcerer black are called Luciferic and Ahrimanic beings. Any man who consciously or unconsciously strives to fulfil his egoistical desire already uses the Luciferic and Ahrimanic beings which make his astral body darker also. The inorganic beings described by Carlos Castaneda, provide the example of such beings. The astral body of man with spiritually developed consciousness who acts unselfish, even with the help of the Luciferic and Ahrimanic beings, will not become darker.

If Carlos Castaneda and Don Juan were the black sorcerers, then it would have no sense for them to publish knowledge which remained secret through thousands of years. No money will force black sorcerer to open knowledge which can be directed by other men against him and on which his own well-being and his life depends. In order to earn money black sorcerer possesses much more effective means, than publication of secret knowledge in books. The sorcerers possess faculties which can cause miracles. Miracle is manifested through the use of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. For example, it is possible to move physical body on the large distance instantly in order to help. However, this faculty can be used for personal enrichment and to make harm other men also. In order not to provide the manifestation of evil, the higher faculties are not demonstrated and are not used publicly by man who has appropriating qualities. If such faculty is used nevertheless then it is applied according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind.

The reason why Carlos Castaneda published secret knowledge is the change of the common level of consciousness of mankind. The common level of consciousness of mankind has changed thanks to the Christ. And the mission, which fulfil Carlos Castaneda and Don Juan completely correspond to that, what Jesus Christ does. To prove this can each man who has reached certain level of the development of consciousness, for the understanding, it is sufficient to use ordinary rational consciousness.

Some of the warriors of the lineage of Don Juan stayed on the intermediate levels of consciousness located below the level of consciousness of the freedom from egoism and are not able to develop their consciousness further by themselves. This means they got into dependence from beings which use their energy and which are immeasurably lower than their higher 'I'. In order to leave physical body in such a way which was used by the warriors of the lineage of Don Juan, each of them must possess certain qualities and faculties. It is possible to claim, that each of the warriors who left physical body passed the first, the lesser Guardian of the threshold. This also means that according to their qualities, each of such warriors was completely free from beings, which determine the earthly Karma of man. According to their faculties each warrior was, at least, capable to unite his energy with the energy of other warriors consciously. And the next objective was to pass the second, the greater Guardian of the threshold and to reach consciousness of the freedom from egoism. Man, after he deprived himself with the protection of physical body, after he freed himself

from the earthly Karma and after he took in his own hands the further development of consciousness, encounters with such Luciferic and Ahrimanic beings which possess unbelievable large power of temptation. To resist such temptations, it is not enough to have only the faculties, it is necessary to possess the qualities. No faculty of the out-of-body experience gives man the freedom from beings. Some warriors of the lineage of Don Juan had not sufficient qualities to develop consciousness further by themselves and to remain independent from beings. It becomes necessary to help them. And the mission of Don Juan and Carlos Castaneda is to help them to become free.

Consciousness of Don Juan is now on such level, the qualities of which are sufficient to pass the greater Guardian of the threshold. But he does not do this consciously, for if he will do this, then some warriors of his lineage will remain bound with beings and will be left to themselves. The part of his mission is to give the warriors energy, which would be enough to break the connection of warrior with being which forms the mutual energy ring with the warrior. To break the connection with beings means also to restore the connection with rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Not only warriors of the lineage of Don Juan bound themselves with beings. Sorcerers, who have bound themselves with beings which encounter in the state of conscious dreaming, are in even worst situation, than the stayed behind warriors of the lineage of Don Juan. Sorcerers, despite of their faculties, are on the level of consciousness below the level of consciousness of the ordinary man on the Earth. The warriors of the lineage of Don Juan though they are on the higher level of consciousness, but, unlike ordinary man on the Earth, they cannot develop their consciousness further by themselves, despite of their faculties. And concerning possibility of the development of consciousness ordinary man on the Earth is in better situation, than the stayed behind sorcerers and warriors.

The ordinary man develops his consciousness, passing from one life on the Earth to another, passing through the gates of death and birth. The stayed behind warriors of the lineage of Don Juan can not neither die nor be born on the Earth any more for they are on such level of consciousness which does not allow it. The sorcerers, who remained on the level of consciousness of dreaming, also cannot die, for it is not allowed by the connection with inorganic beings, and therefore they cannot be born in order to develop their consciousness further on the Earth. And the mission of Don Juan now is to give sorcerers the necessary energy in order to break their connection with beings. In order to break the energetic ring with the inorganic being sorcerer needs the energy from outside for his own energy is used by inorganic being. After breaking of the connection with inorganic being the sorcerer dies, what is expressed in the alteration of his waking consciousness. As man after death of physical body loses those concepts which do not correspond to the reality, likewise the sorcerer passing through the gates of death is freed from that consciousness which connected him with inorganic being and did not allow him to develop his waking consciousness. The sorcerer has an opportunity to be born the physical body on that level of consciousness on which he can develop his consciousness further on the Earth.

Carlos Castaneda fulfilled a part of his mission after he described the experience of the sorcerers of the lineage of Don Juan in his books. The modern-day man on the Earth has now possibility to become familiar with this experience. The danger is that he lacking the appropriating qualities could wish to encounter the inorganic beings and to establish connection with them without becoming conscious of such connection. Then the connection with beings will be manifested so, that man will have self-conceit and feeling of self-importance. It will seem to him that he freely travels out of the physical body, being an expert on inorganic beings, not worrying about the energy at all. Such dreamers do exist, and they advise to follow their example, not being conscious, that they are already bound on the inorganic beings. The rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind has changed so, that ancient methods do not correspond to the level of consciousness of the modern-day

man any more. The end of the old rhythm of the development of consciousness is characterized also by the fact that the calendar of people Maya ends in the year of 2012.

Carlos Castaneda's consciousness is also on such level the qualities of which are enough to pass the second, the greater Guardian of the threshold. But he does not do this consciously. For if he will do that, those who is bound to the beings, will be left to themselves. To such men belong also those who look for the connections with beings consciously or unconsciously. Carlos Castaneda voluntary fulfils the mission of giving man such knowledge which in case of the encounter with inorganic being would help man to return back in physical body. This occurs on such level of consciousness which ordinary man has not reached consciously yet therefore in waking consciousness this knowledge, as well as the encounter with Carlos Castaneda during dreaming, could stay unconscious to him.

The Christ and the magic

Jesus Christ has the highest consciousness among personalities that is why he is the greatest sorcerer who was ever incarnated in physical body on the Earth. He let miracles happen, described in Testaments, according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. The modern-day man, who chooses magic as system of the development of consciousness, has in the Testaments description of deeds of the sorcerer with the highest qualities and faculties. And it is possible to touch once more the question why the individuality of Christ manifested itself in physical body of Jesus from Nazareth and accomplished the greatest magic deed on Golgotha.

Considering this question from the point of view of the connection with beings, it is possible to claim, that at the time of the event of Golgotha man on the Earth already was connected with the Luciferic and Ahrimanic beings so strongly, that beings which constitute the etheric, or the life body of man, could not support physical body of man on the Earth any more. The Earth itself could not support physical body of man any more. This means, that man without physical body would appear in the situation similar to situation of the sorcerer whose consciousness remained on the level of dreaming and who is unable to develop consciousness by himself, even unable to pass through the gates of death any more. Passing through the gates of death, man has possibility to establish again consciousness of himself as the 'I', as the highest being in the manifested world structure, to return again to the Earth and to develop his consciousness further until he will become conscious of his higher 'I'. Man would become only an executor of will of the Luciferic and Ahrimanic beings which would fulfil his egoistical desires in exchange for his energy of consciousness. The higher 'I' would become the slave of lower beings through man. Man could not become conscious of himself as the manifestation of his own higher 'I'. Because such connection with beings was established by man voluntary from his own higher 'I', striving for the satisfaction of the personal desires, then to restrain the power of such beings could only a being which has access to the 'I' of every man. Such being could be only such 'I' which is manifested on the level of consciousness of the unity of the 'I' of all men. Since only the 'I' can have access to another 'I'. Thus, through the deed on Golgotha, Jesus Christ connected himself with the Earth, the etheric body of each man was withheld on the Earth by the force manifested through the Christ, and the power of the Luciferic and Ahrimanic beings over man was withheld by force of the Christ in such limits, that man has possibility to develop his 'I'-consciousness further on the Earth. And since the deed on Golgotha, man can attain the consciousness of his higher 'I' by becoming conscious of the impulse of the Christ and by following it.

Consciousness of Christ is the highest consciousness of freedom from egoism which personality can have. It is impossible to pass the greater Guardian of the threshold, not having followed the Christ-impulse which leads to the union of all personalities. Consciousness of

Christ is a measure of how far personality has reached consciousness of the freedom from egoism. Don Juan and Carlos Castaneda can pass the greater Guardian of the threshold when they will fulfil their mission on deliverance of those men which have already connected or only are going to connect themselves with beings. It is necessary to fulfil these missions before the end of the Continental period of development of consciousness of mankind on the Earth. Otherwise the connection of men with beings, will destructive influence rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. For example, the connection of sorcerers, who remained on the level of consciousness of dreaming, with elemental beings is manifested in typhoons which have destructive effect on the American continent.

On the present-day level of consciousness each man in which situation on the Earth he could be, can through the conscious use of the methods of imagination, inspiration and intuition, by conscious control of the forces of feeling, thinking and willing, through the conscious development of qualities attain knowledge of the higher worlds. And the shortest path to knowledge of the higher worlds is the path of the conscious following the Christ-impulse which leads man to the freedom from egoism.

The fact that man is incarnated in physical body on the Earth means that he requires the development of qualities, which he lacks in order to become free from egoism. An attempt to use certain faculties in order to become self-conscious out of the body, without appropriating qualities, leads to the connection with beings. The Earth, owing to the deed of Christ, provides man unique possibility for the development of consciousness through the development of qualities without encounter with such beings directly, being protected by physical body. Faculties characterize the use of beings. Qualities characterize the freedom from beings, the freedom from one's own egoism. The development of faculties for man who possesses appropriating qualities, does not cause great difficulty.

The further development of consciousness after passing the lesser Guardian of the threshold, after deliverance from the earthly Karma occurs in the direction of the encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold that is with Christ. At the same time man encounters with Lucifer and Ahriman. This means, that man encounters with temptations which immeasurably surpass those which ordinary man could encounter in physical life on the Earth. Man is protected by physical body from direct influence of Luciferic and Ahrimanic beings. It is not obvious, that man will make decision to follow the Christ-impulse for this means the full refusal of one's own egoism, conscious dedication of the whole being, the whole life not to personal arbitrariness, but to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Which decision will be taken by man on this level of consciousness depends on his qualities and temptation to use attained faculties for satisfaction of personal desires is extremely great. Consequence of the following the Christ-impulse is the further development of consciousness of personality according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Carlos Castaneda and Don Juan fulfil their missions, following the Christ-impulse. They will pass the greater Guardian of the threshold after the fulfilment of their missions.

Carlos Castaneda and Don Juan could never fulfil their missions, if they could not take the huge amount of energy from the Earth in order to free sorcerers from their connections with beings. However to take the necessary amount of energy from the Earth can only such man, whose consciousness corresponds to consciousness of Christ, which permeated the consciousness of the Earth. That, what Carlos Castaneda and Don Juan do for deliverance of sorcerers, corresponds to that, what Jesus Christ does for deliverance of the whole mankind on the Earth. With the changes of rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind the rule of the Nagual ceased to be actual. The following the Christ-impulse became actual, what it is possible to express in words: *before to attain the freedom for oneself all possible must be done in order to assist others to attain the freedom.*

The personal message

You can use the system of magic which is not actual for the development of consciousness any more. Thereby you are exposed to risk to become the black sorcerer. You can also follow the Christ-impulse which is the most actual, the fastest and the safest way of the development of the 'I'-consciousness on the Earth.

The main conclusions

The symbolic or imaginative consciousness becomes noticeable in the sleep as a rule. To be conscious in the astral body and not to lose the life forces, man must be able to restore them by himself. Magic is a system of the development of consciousness in which direct connection with beings is used. Qualities allow man to preserve independence from beings. The use of beings for objectives which do not correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind, leads to black magic. The premises of magic as of system of the development of consciousness were described by Carlos Castaneda. The art of stalking allows develop qualities of the freedom from egoism in physical body. The art of dreaming allows develop the supersensible faculties out of the physical body through the direct contact with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. Not to get into dependence from beings and not to lose life forces in dreaming, it is necessary to know methods of the restoration of energy. The rule of Nagual was realized during the first ancient Indian culture period. It allowed develop consciousness out of the physical body, not being incarnated in physical body on the Earth any more. The objective of such development was the attainment of the level of consciousness of freedom from egoism. The rule of Nagual lost its actuality with the change of the level of consciousness of mankind in the fifth European culture period. The following the Christ-impulse, which leads man to knowledge of the unity of mankind and to the freedom from egoism, became actual now.

Chapter 7

The mission of Rudolf Steiner

The Christ-impulse leads man to freedom from egoism through becoming conscious of the unity of mankind. Therefore knowledge of the Christ leads man to the freedom also. Christ can be perceived only supersensibly. To modern-day man it remains either to believe in his existence blindly, or to attain knowledge of the Christ through spiritual science. Man can perceive Christ directly, having developed the supersensible organs of perception. For this purpose he must know how to develop the supersensible organs according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. And the mission of Rudolf Steiner was to assist man in achievement of such level of consciousness on which he can attain knowledge of the higher worlds. This level of consciousness allows man to know Christ directly.

Rudolf Steiner is well known as the founder of the Anthroposophical society. However, as there is difference between mathematical society and mathematics, so it is necessary to make distinction between the Anthroposophical society and the anthroposophy also. Belief, that Rudolf Steiner is the founder of the anthroposophy, is not correct because the founder of the anthroposophy was Socrates. To be anthroposophist or theosophist does not mean membership in Anthroposophical or Theosophical society. In a similar way to how the word *theosophy*, translated from the Greek language, means 'divine wisdom', and not the 'knowledge, wisdom or teaching about God', so the word *anthroposophy* means the 'human wisdom'. In this sense to be the anthroposophist will mean to have consciousness of wisdom. It can be attained by modern-day man through such use of forces of thinking, feeling and willing which lead to imagination, inspiration and intuition. Studying of knowledge of the higher worlds published by Rudolf Steiner, is the first step on the way to the anthroposophy as wisdom in man. Socrates was first man in physical body who reached that wisdom which could be called the anthroposophy.

The Theosophical literature supporting itself on the Neoplatonic sources and on Plotin, has attached its chronological researches to the assumption that with Socrates the historical moment was given in which earlier from the divine beings inspired wisdom which used man as tool immersed itself in man, in Anthropos, and gradually became his possession, his task, his duty. Socrates still had to suffer death for that, that he imparted the truths from the Mysteries to his disciples.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 92. The occult Truths of ancient Myths and Sagas.
Lecture on 21st October 1904.

After in Socrates was manifested possibility to become conscious of wisdom through the forces of thinking, feeling and willing in waking consciousness, this possibility became possession of every man now. Prior to Socrates man could have access to wisdom having passed through initiation. One kind of initiation occurred through immersing in the inner being of man. Thus man established the connections with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness which are manifested in his astral, etheric and physical body. The other kind of the initiation consisted in establishment of the connections with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness which are manifested in the outer surroundings of man. On both ways man could enter into state of consciousness in which he could get into dependence from beings and become the vehicle of evil. Therefore the initiation was secret and was carried out in the Mysteries. Evil which could be manifested through the use of knowledge from the Mysteries by man, who has not passed through the initiation, could be so great, that the death penalty was imposed for the disclosure of knowledge from the Mysteries.

Socrates was the first man, who without the initiation has access to the knowledge, available to man in the Mysteries. Very few people could believe at that time that man was able to have knowledge from the Mysteries, not participating in them. As Socrates passed it to their disciples he had to die, because it was believed, that he spreads knowledge from the Mysteries.

Socrates had to die because it was believed that his teachings were given out from the Mysteries. The death penalty was always imposed for the betrayal of the Mysteries.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 88. About the astral world and the devachan.
Berlin, 2nd November 1903.

Socrates refused to keep secret the truths which were available to him in waking consciousness. He considered the knowledge so valuable that he sacrificed his own life in order to impart it to his disciples. The qualities of refusal and sacrifice are characteristics of the quality of love. However these qualities open an access to anthroposophy as the wisdom in man also.

Plato

Plato was one of the disciples of Socrates. Owing to Plato's dialogues it is possible to know about what and how Socrates taught his disciples. Socrates put questions about the riddles of existence in such a way that disciple could find the answer, proceeding from his own forces of thinking, feeling and willing. Thereby it is not so important which personality asks question, but question itself and that fact, that disciple finds an answer by himself. Disciple does not strive to receive revelation in other states of consciousness, but in waking consciousness learns to look for revelation in himself.

Plato was that personality which afterwards was incarnated as Rudolf Steiner. That fact, that the same personality was incarnated as Plato and Rudolf Steiner, it is possible to make public because there is permission of this personality for it. Without such permission to speak about these incarnations publicly would be violation of the freedom of choice. In the Anthroposophical society an opinion exist that Rudolf Steiner was incarnated as Aristotle in his previous life. Such opinion is based on personal statements of people, instead of on research through imagination, inspiration and intuition. On certain level of consciousness man who strives for initiation, receives knowledge that he has a teacher. Since that time, man also attains ability to communicate not only with his teacher, but also with other teachers. The level of consciousness of personalities which were incarnated as Aristotle and Plato, are on the level of consciousness of the freedom from egoism. Both personalities are teachers. However each teacher has his own mission also. Let us consider first, what mission has that personality which was known as Aristotle.

The development of consciousness of man occurs in rhythms of the development of consciousness of mankind which are manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. In every rhythm can be manifested only those possibilities for free choice which are possible in the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. Therefore the ideas, theories, inventions are not manifested incidentally, but always only then, when they correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. The higher is the level of consciousness of man, the more possibilities of free choice and their consequences he can become conscious of. The level of consciousness of teacher significantly exceeds the level of consciousness of modern-day man. Before modern-day man in physical body can become conscious of any idea, this idea is realized by teacher. The teacher, without violating the freedom of choice of man, is able to inspire man in physical body in order that he could become conscious of the ideas which are necessary for the development of consciousness of mankind on the Earth. And the mission of personality which was incarnated as Aristotle,

consist in assisting to modern-day man to become conscious of certain ideas in science. For example, the French mathematician Laurent-Moise Schwartz was inspired by that personality, which was incarnated as Aristotle.

Another mission has personality which was incarnated as Plato. Rudolf Steiner characterizes Plato in the following way:

Plato, who was born in Athens in 427 B.C., conceived as a disciple of Socrates that the trust in the life of thought was consolidated within him through Socrates. What the entire previous development tended to bring into appearance reaches the high point in Plato. It is the conception that in thought life the world spirit reveals itself.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 18. The Riddles of Philosophy.
The world views of the Greek thinkers.

In a similar way to how Buddha developed the qualities of the eightfold path in himself, which no man in physical body had not possessed yet, so Plato reached the highest development of forces of thinking, feeling and willing which at his predecessors were in a stage of developing. Besides Plato passed through the initiation in Mysteries and possessed faculties of the supersensible perception. He could establish the harmony between cognition through the forces of thinking, feeling and willing and supersensible organs of perception. Thus, Plato with equal efficiency could be an initiate and not an initiate. With Buddha, for example, it was not the case. Buddha was not interested for the developing of the sensible world. In Buddha prevails the seer who strives to leave the sensible world as soon as possible and forever enter into supersensible world. And everywhere, where the teaching of Buddha was spread, there was no interest for the development of the sensible world. Plato's teaching is not directed on the supersensible world only. He teaches that the sensible world is the outer manifestation of the ideas of the supersensible world. Therefore, in order to comprehend the sensible world, it is necessary to comprehend the world of the ideas as the world of supersensible beings. Rudolf Steiner describes Plato's world view as follows:

We must only clearly realize that the spirit of Plato is directed in the first place toward the world of Ideas. We must not, however, conceive, my dear friends, that the Ideas in Plato are the abstract monster which ideas are for us to-day, if we are given up to the ordinary consciousness. For Plato, the Idea was to some extent almost what the Persian Gods, the Amschaspands had been, who as active genii assisted Ahura Mazdao. Active genii attainable only in imaginative vision - such in reality were the Ideas in Plato - being-like. Only he no longer described them with the vividness with which such things had been described in former times. He described them as it were like the shades of beings. And because the ideas were taken by men in an ever more and more shadow-like way, the abstract thoughts are coming up through this. But Plato, as he lived on, nevertheless grew deeper in a certain way, so that one might say: well-nigh all the wisdom of that time poured itself out into his world of Ideas. We need only take his later Dialogues, and we shall find something what is astronomical-astrological, cosmological, wonderful psychological, what concerns the history of peoples, all this is found in Plato in a kind of spirituality which, if I may so describe it, refines and shadows down the spiritual to the Idea.

But in Plato everything is alive. And in Plato above all things is living the view: the Ideas are the foundations of all what is present in the sense-world. Wherever we turn our gaze in the sense-world, whatever we behold, it is the outward expression, outward manifestation of Ideas.

Withal there enters into Plato's world view yet another element which has indeed become well known to all the world in a catchword much misunderstood and much misused - in the catchword of Platonic love. The love that is spiritualized through and through, that has laid aside as much as possible of that egoism which is so often mingled with love - this

spiritualized devotion to the world, to life, to man, to God, to the Idea, is something that permeates the Platoic view of life through and through. It is something that recedes in certain ages, something however that lights up again repeatedly afterwards.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 238. Esoteric Studies of Karmic Relations.
Volume 4. Lecture on September 1924.

The basic concepts of the teaching of Plato are ideas and love. Ideas could be understood as supersensible beings, which are conceivable in imagination, inspiration and intuition, and love, as quality of the freedom from egoism. In the state of involution mankind became conscious of all ideas which are manifested as single beings in the state of evolution. For example, the idea of trinity was realized by mankind in the state of involution, and in evolution the trinity is manifested in every being as consciousness, life and form. An example of manifestation of the idea of trinity is also the idea of triangle. Euclid in *Elements* defines line as length without breadth.

A line is breadthless length.

Euclid. Elements. Book I. Definitions.

As it is impossible to see a line which does not have width at all with physical eyes, so it is also impossible to see a triangle with physical eyes. But the idea of triangle is a real supersensible being. All relations, which man can become conscious of as the relations between sides and angles of the triangle, are the manifestations of being of the idea of triangle. Euclid possessed the faculty to perceive supersensible beings of the hierarchies of consciousness in symbolic images. This allowed him to describe relations between the hierarchies of consciousness by concepts, available to man through his forces of thinking, feeling and willing. Thus, the statements in *Elements* of Euclid are based not only on logical thinking, but also on direct supersensible perception. Generally speaking, behind the basis of ancient writings are supersensible faculties of perception. Modern-day man can understand the ancient religious writings properly through the concepts of the spiritual science and owing to the developed supersensible faculties of perception. Otherwise man is forced to find logical contradictions and to reject the ancient religious writings, or to accept them as infallible dogmas. The natural faculties of the supersensible perception were preserved until the fourth, Graeco-Latin culture period. The transition from supersensible to sensible perception occurred gradually.

The cognitive capacity of mankind has developed gradually. Attention has repeatedly been drawn to the fact that in the Atlantean epoch a large part of mankind was able to gaze into the spiritual worlds clairvoyantly and it was said that certain remnants of this old clairvoyance were still present in post-Atlantean times. If we would descent back from the Atlantean epoch, in the ancient India period, in the ancient Persian period, in the Egypt-Chaldean period, even as late as the Graeco-Latin age we would find numbers of men, many more than modern mankind would ever imagine, who possessed the heritage of this old clairvoyance, to whom the astral plane was open, who could see into the hidden depths of existence. The seeing of the etheric body of man was quite usual in the Graeco-Latin age for numbers of men however the seeing namely of portion of the head of man surrounded by an etheric cloud that of cause has gradually become entirely concealed in the inner portion of the head-part.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 114. The Gospel of St. Luke.
Lecture on 16th September 1909.

The faculties of the sensible perception are various by men. The same is true for supersensible perception also. The faculty to perceive ideas as supersensible beings belongs to

the higher faculties of supersensible perception. Man has lost such natural faculties first of all. Man had still the lower faculties which allowed perceive some beings in nature. And there were also men who worshipped these beings and used them for personal objectives. Such men were called *barbarians*. The level of supersensible perception depends on the level of the development of qualities of man. Qualities allow man to remain free from the influence of beings and that is why most clearly to perceive them. The use of knowledge by man who possesses supersensible faculties, but has insufficiently developed qualities, can lead to the manifestation of greatest evil. Therefore Plato, as initiate, makes decision which can be expressed in the following words: *Men become the barbarians increasingly. We must guard knowledge against the barbarians.*

This spiritual knowledge was preserved earlier in the Mysteries in the form of some few symbols or objects and was transmitted secretly. There were no libraries where knowledge in today's scientific sense was systematically analyzed from all sides and preserved. Ever more ordinary man becomes a barbarian regarding the spiritual world. He could no longer understand the symbols of the secret knowledge. The level of consciousness of Plato allowed him to have access to so-called *spiritual library*. One is to understand such a spiritual library as relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which man is able to perceive as knowledge about the ideas. This spiritual knowledge was manifested by those personalities which no longer required for their development of consciousness to be incarnated in physical bodies.

Plato organized for the first time in the history of mankind a *school-library*, which at the same time was school of spiritual knowledge and also library. On the one hand it was some kind of spiritual library of the ideas and on the other hand it was similar to earthly library of today. Knowledge that was studied and preserved in this school-library was protected by certain rituals. Not everyone could have access to knowledge of this school-library, but only those men who developed enough their forces of thinking, feeling and willing. The first guardians of this library were the initiates, who were the successors of Plato. The further life activity of Plato was directed to assistance in the development of consciousness of those men, who consciously sought for the access in the supersensible world through the forces of thinking, feeling and willing. Plato himself develops the qualities which allow him to reach the sixth degree of initiation, the degree of the *Sun-Hero*. How high is consciousness of such degree of initiation, it is possible to imagine from the following citation:

The Sun-Hero encompasses the whole race of mankind as single atoms in his consciousness. He grasps with his consciousness the entire race.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 94. Cosmology.
Theosophy on the basis of the Gospel of St. John.
Lecture on November 1906.

It is necessary to point out to one feature which characterizes all degrees of initiation, beginning from the sixth degree. It consists in that, that before the incarnation of Christ in physical body of Jesus from Nazareth it was impossible for man to reach it in physical body. In order that man, who has developed the quality of freedom from egoism, could attain consciousness of the sixth degree of the initiation, he had to pass through the gates of death first and continue the development of consciousness without being incarnated in physical body on the Earth. Then, after new birth in physical body he could pass through initiation and attain the sixth degree of the initiation. Jesus Christ, having passed through the event on Golgotha, permeated with his consciousness the consciousness of the Earth. This allows any man in physical body attain the sixth degree of initiation, if he follows the Christ-impulse. Consciousness of Jesus Christ permeated not only the Earth, but also three kingdoms of consciousness, and he reached the highest consciousness among personalities. This allows any man in physical body on the Earth to attain any level of consciousness which is available for

man at all, if he follows the Christ-impulse. The Christ-impulse leads all personalities to the unity through becoming conscious of one's own 'I' as the absolute Spirit.

The basis of Christianity is not a teaching, but the free choice of Christ, which manifested relations of love, which lead every man to the unity with other personalities, irrespective of race, nation, sex, state and religion. From here it is possible to understand the distinction between Christianity and teachings of other systems of the development of consciousness. In Buddhism, for example, it is said about attainment of *Nirvana*. Nirvana means such state of consciousness in which personal Karma is blotted out is absent. Personal Karma can be absent, when the free choice of personality corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. To attain the state of Nirvana before the incarnation of Christ in physical body it was possible only having got rid from the incarnations in physical body. Hence there followed a striving to break the chain of incarnations. Thus, in Buddhism prevails the striving to develop consciousness out of the physical body. In the yoga system of Patanjali it is pointed out to the state of *Kaivalya*. This state is also the state of consciousness out of the physical body in which man is freed from personal Karma. However there exists the Karma of mankind too. To attain the full deliverance for single personality through the unity with the absolute Spirit it is only possible, when personalities will reach deliverance all together. The striving to personal perfection, irrespective of perfection of other personalities, leads to the development of the highest egoism, leads to freedom *of* egoism, instead of freedom *from* egoism. To help mankind to attain the freedom from egoism, are necessary the incarnations of teachers in physical body.

The level of consciousness of Plato allowed him not to be born in physical body any more, and to develop his consciousness in the spiritual world of the hierarchies of consciousness. In the occult language the words *richness*, *possessions* mean spiritual knowledge, qualities and faculties. Those man who had them, was *rich*, had the *great possessions*. Those men who had not them, but strived for them, were called *poor in spirit* or *poor*. Man, who does not perceive the spiritual world, is not poor in spirit yet. In order to be poor in spirit, it is necessary to be conscious of own poverty, to be conscious of own dependence from beings of the hierarchies of consciousness, which does not allow to perceive the spiritual world. In this sense Plato was rich man. Not every man of that time was able to use richness of Plato, because only few men could retain independence from beings. Others had to wait, until they will be helped in restoration of the balance of the connections with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. This help was given to man through the activity of Christ in physical body of Jesus from Nazareth. The impulse which leads to the unity of all personalities was given to mankind. The modern-day man can understand this impulse in waking consciousness through his forces of thinking, feeling and willing.

After his death Plato continues the development of consciousness out of the physical body. He attains the sixth degree of initiation and experiences the event of Golgotha in the spiritual world. Through the event on Golgotha the new impulse was given to the development of the 'I'-consciousness of man in physical body. Consciousness of Christ has permeated the etheric body of the Earth and allowed to counterbalance the connections of man with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. If previously man could reach the initiation only in the Mysteries, then after the event on Golgotha every man has possibility to reach by himself the knowledge of higher worlds still during life in physical body. The development of consciousness of Plato after death leads him to the encounter with the greater Guardian of the threshold which can be characterized with the following words:

Jesus said unto him, If thou wilt be perfect, go and sell that thou hast, and give to the poor, and thou shalt have treasure in heaven: and come and follow me.

Matthew 19:21.

Plato makes his choice and was born as Rudolf Steiner in the fifth European cultural period of the development of consciousness of man. Plato had free choice not to be born in physical body on the Earth any more. He possessed sufficient level of the development of quality of the freedom from egoism in order to attain consciousness of the initiate of the seventh degree, the degree of *Father*, not being incarnated in physical body on the Earth any more. Therefore it was not necessary only for his own development. However after the event on Golgotha man has got possibility to attain the seventh degree of initiation in physical body on the Earth through rendering assistance to mankind in the development of consciousness. And Rudolf Steiner for the first time in the history of mankind attains the seventh degree of initiation in physical body on the Earth.

In the fifth European culture period mankind has such level of consciousness, that every man can direct his forces of thinking, feeling and willing to the knowledge of the physical world only, and to the knowledge of the supersensible worlds. For this purpose man needs to have, first of all, the knowledge that the outer physical world is an expression of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. The consistency of this knowledge can be always proved by logical thinking. Besides it is necessary for man to have such methods of direct attainment of this knowledge which corresponds to his forces of thinking, feeling and willing. In the fifth European culture period Rudolf Steiner could transmit knowledge of the supersensible worlds to everyone who will to accept it. If his incarnation occurred earlier, then not every man would be able to use this knowledge, because this would not correspond to the level of the development of consciousness of mankind.

Hroswitha of Gandersheim

Personality which was born as Plato had no other births in physical body prior the birth as Rudolf Steiner. The level of consciousness of Plato allowed him, without being born in physical body to inspire other personalities in physical bodies. An example of such personality is Hroswitha of Gandersheim who during life of Rudolf Steiner was incarnated in physical body as Karl Julius Schröer. However to draw conclusion from the works of Rudolf Steiner, that the sequence of births in physical bodies: Plato - Hroswitha - Schröer is proper, is already incorrect because Schröer has finished his life as feeble-minded. If this sequence of births would be correct, then it would be also correct that Plato as initiate, in his incarnation as Schröer would finish his life in senility, what for the qualities of initiate is impossible. This could only mean that Plato was not an initiate at all. However the indication that Plato was an initiate, it is possible to find, for example, in the *Secret doctrine*:

Plato, being an Initiate, had to use the veiled language of the Sanctuary, and so had the Magi of Chaldea and Persia through whose exoteric revelations the Persian legends were preserved and passed to posterity.

H. P. Blavatsky. The Secret Doctrine. Volume 2. Part I. Commentaries. Stanza XII. The oldest Persian traditions about the Polar and the submerged continents.

If Plato were to be born as Schröer then it would mean not spiritual evolution but spiritual degradation of personality of an initiate. The candidates for becoming the feeble-minded man do not possess the necessary qualities and are not admitted to initiation at all. Qualities of an initiate, in contrast to his faculties, are preserved in any incarnation. Though it is also correct that an initiate cannot unfold all his spiritual forces and faculties in some incarnation, however it is impossible that his qualities could so degrade that he would die in senility. In order better to understand, about what incarnation there is a talk, it is necessary to consider the following citation:

And there was a certain difficulty in Plato's being to accept Christianity, for he himself represented in a certain sense the highest point of the pre-Christian world view and even the external facts revealed that the real Plato-being could not easily dive down into Christianity. For what was it that dived down into Christianity here in the sense-world? It was Neo-Platonism. However this was something altogether different from true Platonism. Although a kind of Platonising Gnosis and the like was formed but there was no real possibility of taking over into Christianity the immediate Plato-being. Thus it was difficult for Plato himself, out of all the activity which he bore within him as the Plato-being and which he must now bring with him again into results - it was difficult for him to dive down in the world in any way. He had to return back the activity [of true Platonism].

And so it was that he reincarnated in the tenth century of the Middle Ages as the nun Hroswitha (Hroswith), that forgotten but great personality of the tenth century, who did indeed receive Christianity in a truly Platonic sense and who carried into the Mid-European-being tremendous much of Platonism.

She belonged to the Convent of Gandersheim in Brunswick and carried infinitely much of Platonism into the Mid-European-being. This basically it was only possible at that time for a woman to do. Had not Plato-being appeared with a feminine character and coloring it could not have accepted Christianity in that time. But also the Roman culture that was in all the education of that time had to be accepted, if I may put it so, it had to be accepted perforce. And so we see the nun Hroswitha evolving into the remarkable personality, who was writing Latin dramas in the style of the Roman poet Terence, dramas which are of extraordinary significance.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 238. Esoteric Studies of Karmic Relations.
Volume 4. Lecture on 23th September 1924.

Nowhere in the text is said something about a birth, but only about an incarnation. Incarnation in physical body must not necessarily occur through birth in physical body. And in this citation it is said about incarnation of Plato-being which did not occur through birth in physical body. The difficulty of proper understanding of this citation is connected with difficulty of understanding of the supersensible activity of Plato as an initiate, whose level of consciousness is significantly higher than the level of consciousness of modern-day man. In the *Secret Doctrine* Plato is mentioned as man of the fifth round of life, as *Fifth-Rounder*, while the development of consciousness of modern-day man still occurs in the fourth round of life.

Gautama Buddha, it was held, was a Sixth-Rounder, Plato and some other great philosophers and minds, "Fifth-Rounders".

H. P. Blavatsky. The Secret Doctrine. Volume 1. Commentaries. Stanza VI - Continued.
A few early Theosophical misconceptions concerning planets, rounds, and man.

This means that modern-day man will reach such level of consciousness, which Plato had, only in the following, the fifth round of life. Therefore it is hard to modern-day man to imagine the abilities of consciousness of such initiate, as Plato.

Plato-being, or being of Platonism, are such relations of the hierarchies of consciousness which were manifested by Plato through his free choice and which, as independent beings, have own consciousness. Every man who makes free choice manifests beings. These beings can act further also after man already left his physical body. And the higher is consciousness of man, the more influences can render beings manifested through free choice, according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. And when, for example, something is said about being of Platonism, about being of Middle Ages, about being of Christianity, about being of certain period and so on, then are meant those relations between beings of the hierarchies which were manifested through free choice of personalities. Hroswitha of

Gandersheim reached consciousness of being of Platonism and was inspired by Plato. Plato acted then from the spiritual world, not being born in physical body. In order to write dramas which were written by Hroswitha of Gandersheim it is absolutely not necessary to have consciousness of an initiate. Consciousness of an initiate is necessary in order to inspire Hroswitha of Gandersheim from the spiritual world.

Plato considered man as manifestation of the idea of personality which exists separated from mankind. This created certain difficulty of the acceptance of Christianity in Platonism. However no personality can exist by itself separated from mankind. In the basis of Christianity there is the idea of unity of all personalities, irrespective of in what personality could trust and what religion it could profess. The 'I' of any personality has the same basis called the *Father* in Christianity. Owing to Hroswitha of Gandersheim the being of Platonism was extended to the idea of unity of all personalities. The main danger which exists in any world view is becoming dependent from beings which constitute the being of the world view. In case of Platonism this danger is that man could become dependent from the ideas or become obsessed by the ideas which are supersensible beings. Man must have connections with the ideas, but he must be able to retain his freedom and be conscious of that any idea serves man, and not man serves the idea. The dependence from beings is also the reason of any senility. What can guarantee the independence from beings, are qualities of personality.

If Plato could not manage to return the activity of true Platonism, inspiring other personalities, the spiritual science also could not be accepted. That now there is possibility to study the methods of the anthroposophy, proceeds from the activity of true Platonism the basic concepts of which are ideas and love. The love, manifested through the qualities of refusal and sacrifice, opens an access to the anthroposophy as to the wisdom in man. Wisdom in man leads to consciousness of that fact, that the outer world is an external expression of the spiritual world manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness, or through the ideas. That, what for the first time was manifested in Socrates as the anthroposophy, was made accessible to every man through Plato. In such a way there was prepared possibility of transition from the natural science to the spiritual science.

First human Manu

In course of his life Rudolf Steiner was led to secret school which may be called the successor of first school-library of Plato. The methods which were used in this school-library conform to the methods described by Rudolf Steiner in book *How to attain knowledge of the higher worlds?* The initiates of this school could preserve and develop secret knowledge of many various spiritual schools. Rudolf Steiner could use this knowledge to verify his own spiritual researches. He also could lead this secret school-library further. Here, in this school-library, were the *rich*, the *poor* had no access there. But just the *poor* required the methods which are accessible to everyone and which correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of man. Man had to get access to methods, without entering some society or school. Such methods had to correspond to the Christ-impulse, which leads man to the consciousness of himself as of the absolute Spirit through becoming conscious of the unity of all personalities. And these methods of the imagination, inspiration and intuition were given to man.

Through intuition man knows the being of the hierarchies of consciousness and reaches the higher levels of the 'I'-consciousness. Imagination allows man to learn the being of the hierarchies of consciousness in symbolic images. Inspiration leads to understanding of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness and opens access to the spiritual library. The modern-day man does not require some secret external spiritual school any more in order to attain the higher level of the 'I'-consciousness. Each man has the secret school in himself and the teacher is Jesus Christ, because Jesus Christ has reached the highest 'I'-consciousness

among personalities. Whether man will follow to the Christ-impulse or not, depends on his free choice.

Any free choice of personality is carried out by the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. Thereby are created the new relations between the hierarchies of consciousness, which as spiritual beings, themselves possess consciousness. In this sense the Christ is the 'I'-consciousness of personality of Jesus, which as spiritual being, acts further. If one personality reaches some level of consciousness, then this level of consciousness becomes accessible to other personalities also. To give such methods of the development of consciousness which lead man to the knowledge of Christ, could only an initiate, who himself in full consciousness through the methods of imagination, inspiration and intuition has reached the knowledge of Christ. This is initiation, which can be called *Christian initiation*, which leads man in full consciousness on the Earth to the consciousness of Christ through the imagination, inspiration and intuition. Rudolf Steiner was first initiate of such kind and if Rudolf Steiner attained consciousness of an initiate of the seventh degree, the degree of *Father* in physical body, then attainment of such level of consciousness becomes accessible also to every man in physical body.

From the times of Socrates the anthroposophy as wisdom in man, was realized by few men united in small secret societies, for only few men were then able to become conscious of it and use it. Only when consciousness of man, thanks to influence of the Christ-impulse has developed so far, that everyone could realize and use anthroposophy, Plato in his incarnation as Rudolf Steiner published the Anthroposophical truths and methods. Publication began in the Theosophical society and was continued in Anthroposophical society. Up to the moment, when mankind has accumulated enough means to provide each man with free knowledge, treatment and feed, the distribution of knowledge for money went on in accord with the development of consciousness of man. The incarnation of Ahriman in second half of 1999 designates the moment when the distribution of knowledge for money does not correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind any more. From here proceeds the task to distribute knowledge which was published by Rudolf Steiner for free. Modern-day man must have possibility to get knowledge about hierarchies of consciousness and methods of attainment of this knowledge in order to make the free choice according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. He must have possibility to know his 'I' as the 'I' of the absolute Spirit through forces of thinking, feeling and willing which are available to him in physical body. Without such alternative man will strive for satisfaction of lusts in physical body and will identify his 'I' with his body. The free choice of man will be egoistic and will lead to the war of all against all.

When we have said repeatedly that our seven culture stages will find their end through the War of All against All, we must conceive such a War of All against All, quite differently than we have been accustomed to imagine us the wars. We must envisage once the foundation, the real cause of this war. This foundation or cause is the domination of egoism, of self-seeking and selfishness of men. And we have now progressed so far in our considerations that we have seen what a sharp two-edged sword this 'I' of man is. He who does not fully realize that this 'I' is a two-edged sword will scarcely be able to grasp the entire meaning of the evolution of mankind and the world. On the one hand this 'I' is the cause that men harden within themselves, and that they desire to draw into the service of theirs 'I' everything what can be available to them in the outer things and inner goods. This 'I' is the cause of man's directing all his wishes to the satisfaction of this 'I' as such. One side of this 'I' is such a striving to draw to itself as its own possession a part of the Earth which belongs to all, to drive away all the other 'I's (Egos) from its realm, to fight them, to be at war with them. But on the other hand we must not forget that this 'I' is at the same time something which gives man his

independence and his inner freedom, which in the truest sense of the word elevates man. His dignity is founded in this 'I'. It is the basis of the Divine in man.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 104. The Apocalypse of St. John.
Lecture on 25th June 1908.

Each rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind provides the new possibilities for the development of consciousness of man. The mission of Rudolf Steiner in the fifth European culture period was to give spiritual knowledge and methods of its attainment corresponding to the forces of thinking, feeling and willing of man. This knowledge allows man to understand the Christ-impulse which leads all personalities to the unity, to the knowledge of one's 'I' as the absolute Spirit. If man will not be able to develop qualities or to use this knowledge by himself he will stay behind in his development from rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. After the fifth European culture period will follow the sixth and seventh culture periods. Those men, who will stay behind in the fifth culture period, also will not be able to use possibilities of rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind in the sixth and seventh culture period. The staying behind the development of consciousness will be manifested in free choice of man which leads to the war of all against all. Our fifth continental period of the development of consciousness tends to end with catastrophe through the war of all against all.

The methods of imagination, inspiration and intuition which were given man in the fifth European culture period, will be valid in the sixth and seventh culture period. However by the end of the seventh culture period the relations between the forces of thinking, feeling and willing will so change that mankind again will need help in the development of consciousness. The leading personality, which is incarnated in order to help the development of mankind during entire certain rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind, is called *Manu*. According to the various rhythms, there are also various levels of consciousness of Manu. The lowest level of consciousness which Manu can have corresponds to the degree of initiation of *Father*. Such Manu is able to direct the development of consciousness of mankind of the whole root race. The fifth root race corresponds to our Continental period of the development of consciousness. The personality of Manu of our period was incarnated already at the end of the Atlantic period which ended with water catastrophe.

Atlantis perished in a vast water-catastrophe. The whole continent was gradually flooded, and the mass of peoples migrated eastward towards Europe and Asia. One of the main groups passed from Ireland through Europe to Asia. Everywhere numbers of people remained behind. They were led by a high Initiate in whom they had complete faith. He caused a noble selection through his wisdom he took the best of them with him and settled them in a distant part of Asia, in a place where now the Gobi Desert is located. There a small colony was specially developed in complete isolation. From this colony the colonisers went out into all inhabited lands and founded the cultures of the next Root-race: the ancient Indian, the ancient Persian, the Egyptian-Babylonian-Assyrian, the Graeco-Latin cultures. And then the Anglo-Saxon-Germanic culture arose.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 95. At the Gates of Theosophy.
Lecture on 31st August 1906.

Rudolf Steiner could assist mankind in the development of consciousness, having incarnated in physical body in the fifth European culture period. In the fifth, sixth and also in seventh culture period man can use knowledge and methods given by Rudolf Steiner. By the end of the seventh period, however, new methods and knowledge will become necessary to man. In order to help mankind in the development of consciousness, Rudolf Steiner once more will be incarnated in physical body on the Earth at the end of the seventh culture period of our Continental period. As Rudolf Steiner is first personality who reached the level of

consciousness of Manu in physical body on the Earth, this personality will be also the first human Manu of the sixth root race or of the sixth period of the development of consciousness. All previous Manu were incarnations of personalities which have reached the level of consciousness of Manu out of the physical body on the Earth. It will be also the last incarnation in physical body on the Earth of that personality which was incarnated as Rudolf Steiner. The level of consciousness of this personality is already so high, that the incarnation will not occur through the birth in physical body. Instead of birth in the physical body human Manu will be consciously incarnated in physical body which will be prepared for him by one of the initiate of our Continental period. The initiate will consciously leave his physical body in order to provide it for the incarnation to Manu of the sixth period of the development of consciousness. In this sense this incarnation will be similar to the incarnation of Christ in physical body of Jesus from Nazareth.

In order to train his disciples Manu of the fifth continental period still had to gather them together and separate them from other mankind. For the Manu of the sixth period this will not be necessary any more. The qualities and methods of the imagination, inspiration and intuition allow man to develop the supersensible organs of perception and to become an initiate consciously. The developed supersensible organs of perception, chakras or chakramas, will be necessary for man in order to perceive and communicate with the first human Manu consciously, not being in direct physical proximity from him. Such man can become conscious disciple and assistant of human Manu already at the end of the seventh culture period of our Continental period of the development of consciousness of mankind. For this purpose it is necessary, that man had developed his sixteen-petalled lotus flower properly.

About the chakrams of the astral body: As well as the physical body of man has senses, the astral body of man also has senses. They are located lined up on one line. One of these senses is located above the larynx. These senses are called chakrams, the sacred wheels. They are motionless by the ordinary man, but by the seer they are movable and they rotate. The chakram above the larynx is basically a petal-shaped formation. All astral chakrams are called lotus flowers. The chakram located above the larynx is called the sixteen-petalled lotus flower.

The human Manu of the sixth root race which will lead this race, he who is the first human Manu can talk with men when man is so far that he can speak with the master; and he can do this only when this chakram is completely developed, when the word of man goes over into the stream of the wheels immediately. The ordinary man will reach this in the fourth subrace of the sixth root race. A staying behind would cause that not all of the 16 spokes are developed. Then man could not speak before the master, so that he could not be led by the master on this stage of the evolution. It is especially important to train this chakram, and this depends on whether man will be disaccustomed to wound through the voice.

Men have 16 opportunities - through 16 subraces - to train this chakram. If they do not do this, they go through 16 ways of corruption through the word.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 89. Consciousness, life, form.
Lecture on 5th November 1904.

Rhythm of the development of the Continental period will be replaced by other rhythm that will appear as the sixth period of the development of consciousness on the Earth after catastrophe caused by the war of all against all. The new rhythm will be manifested in the new relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. In the sixth root race or in the sixth period of the development of consciousness, the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which are manifested as the limbs of man will change so much, that the outer appearance of man will be completely different.

Towards the middle of the Sixth Root-Race, in the last third, there will be no physical body. Then the entire man will again be etheric.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 93a. Foundations of Esotericism.
Lecture on 4th November 1905.

To the sixth period is pointed out in the Apocalypse of St. John as the period of the *opening of the seals* (6:1-8:1). Everything, what man could appropriate to himself during the culture periods in the various incarnations, is imprinted in his astral and etheric body as some seal of the manifested relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. The sense organs of perception allow perceive by man only his physical body. When the physical body will not be there any more, then that, what was hidden behind the physical body, will becomes directly perceived. The qualities and vices of man which are imprinted in his astral and etheric body will be perceivable in the outer appearance of man. Mankind of the sixth race will be already naturally separated according to the outer appearance.

So step by step, after the great war of all against all, will reveal itself all that what is now hidden in the soul. Let us think of the beginning of the great war: the soul that has heard the call which the Christ-principle let resounded from a period to period, will live on in all that what is indicated in the "letters". What these periods can give was given throughout seven periods. Let us imagine how the soul waits, how it waits on. It is sealed seven tunes. Each culture period lays one seal upon it. Within you is sealed what the Indians wrote in the soul; within you is also imprinted what the Persians, the Egyptians, Greeks and Romans have written in the soul, and what our own culture period inscribes in it. The seals will be unloosed, that is, the things written there will be revealed outwardly after the great War of All against All. And the principle, the power, which brings it about that the true fruit of our culture periods shall be made manifest in the countenance, this principle, this power we must see in Christ Jesus.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 104. The Apocalypse of St. John.
Lecture on 21st June 1908.

The Christ-impulse worked already, beginning from the first sacrifice of Christ in the third Lemurean period of the development of consciousness on the Earth. However to apprehend this greatest impulse could only those personalities who could counterbalance the influences of Luciferic and Ahrimanic beings. During the Atlantic period Christ made two more sacrifices because the connection of man with Luciferic and Ahrimanic beings became increasingly stronger. This connection became already so strong during the Continental period that the fourth sacrifice of Christ in physical body of Jesus from Nazareth became necessary. The physical body allows man to develop consciousness, not perceiving beings of the hierarchies of consciousness directly. The sense organs of perception do not allow man in physical body to perceive Christ directly also. Man, however, can first of all understand Christ through knowledge of the spiritual science which was published by Rudolf Steiner. The development of the qualities and the forces of thinking, feeling and willing in physical body lead man to the development of the supersensible organs of perception. Through the methods of imagination, inspiration and intuition man can perceive the reality of Christ directly. Man can attain the initiation by himself and become disciple and assistant of the human Manu of the sixth period. The mission of Rudolf Steiner to help the development of the 'I'-consciousness of man will be continued in the sixth period.

The personal message

For the development of the 'I'-consciousness you can use knowledge which was published by Rudolf Steiner. Through methods of imagination, inspiration and intuition you can reach

wisdom which is manifested in you as wisdom of all hierarchies of consciousness. You can attain the initiation by yourself and become disciple and assistant of the first human Manu.

The main conclusions

Rudolf Steiner was the founder of the Anthroposophical society. The founder of the anthroposophy was Socrates. The word *anthroposophy* means *human wisdom*. This wisdom is reached through the control of the forces of thinking, feeling and willing in imagination, inspiration and intuition. Publication of knowledge and methods of the anthroposophy was begun by Rudolf Steiner in Theosophical society and continued in Anthroposophical society. The mission of Aristotle is inspiration of the ideas in the science. The previous incarnation of Rudolf Steiner was Plato. Plato has followed the Christ-impulse and was incarnated through birth in physical body as Rudolf Steiner. Up to the incarnation of Christ in physical body of Jesus from Nazareth to reach consciousness of Manu was only possible out of the physical body. Rudolf Steiner is first personality, which reached the level of consciousness of Manu in physical body on the Earth. The Continental period tends to end with the catastrophe through the war of all against all. In the sixth period which will follow after catastrophe, there will not be a physical body and the qualities and vices of man will be manifested in his outer appearance. Personality which was incarnated as Rudolf Steiner will be the first human Manu of the sixth period of the development of consciousness on the Earth.

Chapter 8

The science and reality

Consciousness of man has one property, without which no concept and no judgment are possible about the reality. This property allows man to become conscious of any set of objects or elements, as one uniform whole, as one unity. From here originates possibility to designate one uniform whole which is coming to consciousness, by words and symbols. For example, single object it is possible to call "one" and to denote it by symbol "1", several objects to call "en" and denote them by symbol "N", and so on. On the one hand, this leads to the concept of number and lays the basis for the natural science. On the other hand, this leads to the concept of reality which is all. Because two "all" cannot exist, such reality must be only one. Irrespective of which name to give this reality, it must have consciousness. If the reality which is all, would not have consciousness, then man as a part of "all", also would not have any consciousness. The concept of reality which has consciousness leads to the theses of the spiritual science as the science of one unified reality.

If in the natural science to accept the assumption, that the laws of nature are an outer expression of internal relations between the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice, then the natural science can be extended to the spiritual science. These relations are expressed in the natural science as relations between numbers. Number is the concept which cannot be seen with physical eyes. It is possible to see an outer designation, a symbol of number, but number itself it is not possible to see. In a similar way, beings of the hierarchies of consciousness cannot be seen with physical eyes, it is possible to see the world of single objects as an external manifestation of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. However just because all is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness, it is possible by means of invisible concept of number to make judgements about visible reality.

Take, for example, the natural numbers. The concept of natural number means, that if there exists the number N , then there exists the greater number $N + 1$ as well. From here there appears the concept about the infinity of the natural numbers. As the manifested world structure is finite then everything, what can be manifested in the world structure, including any concept and its application, will be finite also. In the world structure which has a beginning and an end, it is impossible to apply the concept of natural number N , in order to form the greater number $N + 1$ infinitely. Therefore the concept of infinity of the natural numbers does not correspond to the reality. There is only one infinity which is all. What is not all is finite and is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness. The concept of any number and its application are manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness also.

Any concept, as relations between consciousness of man and the hierarchies of the consciousness, which were created through free choice, will become an illusion when concept does not correspond to the rhythms of the developing of consciousness of mankind and consequently to the reality. Thus the concept of the infinity of numbers is an illusion which does not correspond to the reality. An assumption of an existence of the hierarchies of consciousness can be always confirmed by the supersensible perception, verified by experiment and logical thinking. It conforms to the following words of Rudolf Steiner about the realities of the world:

Thus, the true realities of the world are beings in the different states of consciousness. The fact that we live in the human state of consciousness and from this state of consciousness have no full overview of the realities induces that what is not a reality appears to us as reality.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 148. From the Akasha-Chronicle. The Fifth Gospel.
Lecture on 18th December 1913.

The achievements of natural science in the development of the technics were attained in an experimental way. For this purpose there were enough the concepts about the world as the world of single physical objects. Relations between single physical objects are not illusions, but they are relations the between hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. Due to identification of oneself with physical body there appears an illusion of the world as the world of single physical objects. From here originate the concepts, that the Earth is physical ball, and those relations between objects which are valid at its surface, are also valid on any distance from it. The modern-day technics can be used to verify these concepts.

Man on the Moon

Consider the concept that if man can exist in the diving suit under water on the Earth and in the spacesuit at some distance from the Earth he can also exist at any distance from the Earth, for example, on the Moon. Thereby it remains completely forgotten, that if one dives under water, one stays on the Earth and preserves the connection with the Earth, and if one moves far enough away from the Earth in direction of the Moon, one loses the connection with the Earth. It is not difficult to prove, that modern-day man in physical body was never on the Moon. By means of the technics it is possible to leave traces on the Moon, but all so-called proofs, that man in physical body was on the Moon, can be created without presence of man on the Moon. To verify that modern man in physical body cannot exist on the Moon at all, it would be enough to move away from the surface of Earth at the distance which is less than distance between the Earth and the Moon. Physical body of man is part of the Earth therefore man in physical body can exist only on the Earth. Rudolf Steiner writes the following in this regard:

Man can exist only on this Earth. A pair of hundred miles away from it he would have to die, to wither, as withers the hand which is cut off from the body.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 97. Esoteric Cosmology. The Christian Mystery.
Lecture on 9th February 1906.

Man in physical body cannot exist on the Moon, because on the Moon are manifested other relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which can not support the life of man in physical body. As on the surface of the Earth between the hierarchies of consciousness are manifested the properties of circle, then it is possible to speak about the radius of the Earth just like one speaks about the radius of the mathematical circle. On the distance from the surface of the Earth equal to one radius of the Earth, the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness change as much that destructions of life processes of man begin. These destructions are not critical yet and they can be eliminated on the Earth. The extreme limit where the Earth cannot support man in physical body any more is between seven and twelve radiuses of the Earth. For man in physical body such distance from the Earth would be fatal. With the increasing distance from the Earth man would lose his waking consciousness first and then the state of death would take place. The achievements in the development of the technics allow verify this experimentally.

The death of physical body occurs when the etheric or life cocoon of man is destroyed. The etheric cocoon keeps the physical body and the etheric body of man on the Earth. It forms a part of the etheric body of the Earth and can exist only on the Earth. If the etheric body of the Earth cannot support the etheric cocoon of man there comes the state of consciousness called death. The etheric body of the Earth exceeds the physical size of the Earth therefore man can exist on some distance from the Earth in the space suit. The distance from the surface of the Earth to the Moon is sixty four times more than radius of the Earth. It is more, than the critical twelve radiuses of the Earth are therefore on the Moon can exist only the corpse of man.

It is not difficult to notice, that man who returns back to the Earth after visiting the space station, cannot walk by himself and needs help. The Earth needs some time to restore the normal life activity of man, before he has enough forces to walk by himself again. A pilot of the jet plane who can experience the same or even much bigger gravitational force than cosmonaut during the flight, but at substantially smaller distance from the surface of the Earth does not need such help and is able to walk by himself immediately after landing. Essential, therefore, is not gravitational force but the connection with the Earth.

The connection with the Earth begins to weaken on remoteness from the Earth which is equal to one radius of the Earth. Beginning from the distance which is equal to twelve radiuses of the Earth the connection of the etheric cocoon of man with the etheric body of the Earth becomes so weak that an application of physical measurements of the distance which is normally used on the Earth becomes incorrect. A measure of remoteness from the Earth becomes not the distance, but the level of consciousness.

For the support of the etheric cocoon of man are necessary relations between the hierarchies of consciousnesses created by consciousness of the Earth. No spacesuit and space station can provide the conditions that are able to support the etheric cocoon of man at sufficient distance from the surface of the Earth. Together with destruction of the etheric cocoon it is destroyed such physical consciousness of man which allows consider physical man as existing independent from the Earth. Because physical consciousness of man begins to be destroyed with beginning the distance from the surface of the Earth which is equal to one radius of the Earth, the radius of the Earth can be taken as a measure of the remoteness from the Earth.

The law of universal gravitation

As everything has consciousness, the Earth as a planetary being, also has consciousness. The Earth is conscious of the etheric cocoon of man, of his physical and etheric bodies. Physical body is attracted by the Earth not because there is some gravity but because physical body forms a part of consciousness of the Earth. Between the planets of the Solar system also there is no gravitation, but each planet has its own consciousness which is included in the whole consciousness of the Solar system. Single planets do not exist by themselves, but form a part of the Solar system and relations between them are regulated by the hierarchies of consciousness. One comes to the concept of the gravitation, when one considers the planets not as a part of the Solar system, but as separate physical bodies. However, any phenomenon exists not only as separated, but also as a part of the whole. Therefore, before to make conclusions about the existence of gravitation, it is necessary learn to distinguish, how far the considered phenomenon is separated from other phenomena, and how far it forms a part of the whole:

If for example I put my hand to my forehead, I shall not dream to say: My forehead attracts my hand, but I shall say: It is an inner deed done through that what is founded on the soul-and-spirit. My hand is not independent of my forehead; they are not really two entities – my hand and my forehead. I shall get around to regarding the phenomenon rightly only if I regard myself as a whole.

From this it follows something that is very significant, from this it follows that for every phenomenon we must examine to what extent it is a reality in itself, or mere something which is cut off from some whole. If you regard Sun and Moon, or Sun and Earth, each by itself, you may of course invent additionally a force of gravity, gravitation, just as well as you might invent gravitation by means of which my forehead would attract my right hand. However you consider things which are not totalities, but members of the entire planetary system, if you regard Sun and Earth and Moon.

Isaac Newton made his calculations based on the laws of Kepler and has derived the so-called law of *the universal gravitation* or *force of gravity*. The laws of Kepler are based on observations of the movements of the planets and reflect some relations of consciousness between the planets of the Solar system. Therefore the calculations of Newton can be applied to the planets also. According to his calculations, the attraction between the planets depends on the masses of the planets and on their distances from each other. Thereby, the movement of the planets does not depend from the existence of man on the Earth at all and is not determined by the hierarchies of consciousness, but by the unconscious mass of matter. In such a way, the need of existence of man is excluded from the world structure in general. It is not surprising, that one comes to such concepts, that man could be, only the accidental result of combinations of the particles formed due to the big bang and the evolution of animals in best case. If the law of Newton is justified to apply to the planets, it is already incorrect to apply it to the objects on the Earth, because the law of Kepler is not valid between the objects on the Earth. There is the laboratory experiment of Cavendish to which one refers as to the confirmation of the law of universal gravitation between the objects on the Earth.

The Michell-Cavendish experiment

Henry Cavendish, the member of the royal society of London, published the results of experiment on the definition of average density of the Earth in 1798. Cavendish carried out the experiment on the equipment which has been constructed by John Michell shortly before his death. Because the construction of the equipment predetermined the whole experiment, it will be called further the *Michell-Cavendish experiment*.

It is essential that in the experiment two systems of pairs of the masses in the form of balls were used. The system of pair of the smaller balls was used as torsion balance. The system of the larger balls had to be turned manually so that the larger balls approached the smaller balls. The larger balls were hung up on the iron rods. When the system of pair of the larger balls approached the system of pair of the smaller balls this caused the rotation of the torsion balance. The rotation also occurred when the larger balls were removed and only the iron rods remained.

The cause of the rotation of the torsion balance was explained by the effect of the law of universal gravitation. The law of universal gravitation states that the force of the attraction between any two bodies is proportional to the product of their masses and is inversely proportional to the square of the distance between them. Therefore, it would be completely irrelevant for the effect of the attraction in the experiment whether two large masses approached two small masses, or only one mass with the weight which is equal to or much greater than the total weight of both large masses approached to one of the small masses. Relying on this assumption, Cavendish has not carried out the experiment up to its end. He has carried out only the first part of the experiment with two pairs of balls. The construction of the modern torsion balance resembles the construction of the equipment in the Michell-Cavendish experiment in general therefore one carries out only the first part of the experiment with it also.

The second part of the experiment allows find out the cause of the rotation of torsion balance. The second part consists in using only one mass with the sufficient weight instead of system of two large masses. If to remove one large mass together with rod to which it is fastened and to carry out the experiment with one mass and torsion balance, then one mass will not cause the rotation of the balance. If to add the second mass, then the balance will rotate again, even when all four masses are lined up on the one line. Thus, the cause of the rotation is not the attraction between the bodies, but the interaction of two pairs of masses.

The systems of duality

The Michell-Cavendish experiment allows become conscious of working principle of the system of duality. The system of duality always appears when there are identical manifestations of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness. A symmetrical system, in which two identical objects determine the behaviour of the whole system, can be called the *system of duality*. Everything has consciousness and any two bodies which have identical physical characteristics, such as weight, form, structure and so on, form the system of duality. In Michell-Cavendish experiment one pair of small and one pair of large balls, are two systems of duality.

The concept of duality is connected with the concept of self-consciousness. Self-consciousness means duality of consciousness – the consciousness of oneself in oneself. That what the absolute Spirit is conscious of in itself, itself possesses consciousness and becomes the relative consciousness. The rhythm of duality is manifested through beings of the hierarchies of consciousness and depends on the level of consciousness of these beings. As soon as the system of duality is created, self-consciousness of beings, which are manifested through it, increases. The system of duality becomes one being. The interaction of various systems of duality leads to the conflict of consciousness of beings. Each of the systems of duality strives to keep its consciousness. Thereby either a balance between the systems of duality can be reached or there will be destruction in one of the systems. In Michell-Cavendish experiment the interaction of two systems of duality is manifested as rotation of the torsion balance. If Cavendish would remove one ball from the experiment, then one system of duality would be destroyed, and there would be no rotation of the torsion balance.

The systems of duality can be concentric circles, concentric cylinders, two wires, rings of wire, the coils of wire, two plates, and so on. By changing of the physical characteristics and combining the systems, it is possible to create various *schemes of the interaction of the systems of duality*.

An example of the scheme of the interaction of the systems of duality is the *voltaic pile* which was invented by Alessandro Volta in 1800. The device consists of three kinds of disks made from various materials which are stacked on each other alternately. The disks form the pile at whose ends the wires of copper are fastened. When the wires were connected the phenomenon of electricity appeared. If to denote the different disks by letters A, B and C, then the systems of duality can be denoted as AA, BB, CC. The scheme of interaction of the systems of duality in the voltaic pile can be expressed as ABCABC. In this scheme of interaction between two elements of one system of duality there are the elements of the other system of duality.

In electric battery of the cylindrical form it is also not difficult to find the schemes of interaction of the systems of duality. The cathode, anode and other elements form the schemes of interaction of systems of duality. In electric battery the scheme of interaction can be expressed as ABCCBA where the identical letters correspond to the matter which is distributed in the cylinder. A condenser is an example of such scheme of interaction of the systems of duality.

The phenomenon of electricity is connected with interaction of the systems of duality. The imaginations about an existence of the charged particles, which move to and fro do not correspond to the reality. The reality is manifested through beings of the hierarchies of consciousness, and true explanation of natural phenomena needs to be always searched for in interaction of consciousness of beings. The concepts and theories about particles can lead to the discovering and use of numerical relations in natural science, but they never can explain the true cause of the occurrence of these relations.

The manifestation of magnetism is also the consequence of interaction of the systems of duality. The basic distinction between the phenomena of electricity and magnetism is that magnetism results from interaction of beings whose consciousness is higher than consciousness of beings manifested in the phenomenon of electricity.

For true explanation of the rotation torsion balance in the Michell-Cavendish experiment are not necessary neither the theory of attraction, nor the theory of movement of particles between bodies. Cavendish turned the system of large masses to the different sides in the experiment. The torsion balance also turned correspondently to the different sides because interaction between the systems of duality became weaker and stronger alternately. The same principle of interaction between the systems of duality in electromotor causes the rotation of rotor.

Each of the systems of duality is one unity which strives to retain its self-consciousness. Thereby either a balance will be attained or there will be destruction in one of the systems. An example of destruction is the *short circuit*. It is possible to create such combinations of schemes of interaction which will strive not for balance, but for destruction. To such schemes belong so-called *nuclear reactors*.

The first nuclear reactor was assembled under the supervision of Enrico Fermi in 1942 and consisted of graphite and uranium blocks. The combinations of graphite and uranium blocks created the systems of duality. The beings manifested in such conditions cannot attain balance therefore they strive to destroy the systems of duality. And consciousness of beings which are manifested in nuclear reactors is higher, than consciousness of beings manifested in the phenomena of electricity and magnetism. Therefore the destructions in systems, connected with the nuclear reactor, will be greater than the destructions in systems of electricity and magnetism.

The Michell-Cavendish experiment is based on the assumptions, that the Earth is a physical ball and that there is the law of universal gravitation. From the beginning the experiment is directed not to the search of truth, but to the search of some confirmation of the theory of universal gravitation. And as soon as a confirmation is found, an experiment will be finished. It is characteristics of many experiments in which from the beginning one looks for the confirmations of theories and does not make further attempts for the search of the true cause of the phenomenon.

To notice interaction of the systems of duality in Michell-Cavendish experiment impedes the concept of the law of universal gravitation. In a similar way, the concept of existence of particles, such, for example, as electrons, impedes to notice interaction of the systems of duality in the phenomenon of electricity. The concepts, that physical body of man is made of unconscious electrons, atoms, molecules and other particles the combinations of which are able to make man conscious, are connected with misunderstanding, concerning the concept of *atom*. The word *atom* in translation from Greek language means *indivisible* and designates individuality whose consciousness encompasses all possibilities of the free choice of personality. In this sense everything that can be manifested, is manifested through the individualities, or through the atoms. The concepts of unconscious atom which consist of other unconscious particles are the fantasies of scientists.

One has to do with pure fantasy if one takes the existence of atoms, as envisaged today, to be real. So long as atoms are looked upon merely as counters, or shorthand notes for what the senses actually show, one remains on solid ground. If one penetrates through this sense-perceptible basis, then one has to advance to the spiritual, and then one arrives at the being and weaving of a basic substance which is none other than the corporeality of the Thrones, permeated by the activity of the Spirits of Form.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 122. Secrets of the Bible Story of Creation.
Lecture on 22 August 1910.

In the explanation of the phenomena of electricity it is used the concept of *potential difference*, or *voltage* which corresponds to reality. The beings in the systems of duality strive to preserve their consciousness and this leads to the difference in the manifestation of consciousness of beings. This difference in the manifestation of consciousness of beings in schemes of interaction of the systems of duality corresponds to the concept of potential difference. Nobody was able to see the atoms, consisting of protons, electrons and other particles, neither sensibly nor supersensibly yet, not because they are very small, but because they do not exist in reality. The systems of duality can be perceived as sensibly as well as supersensibly. Therefore they allow make the transition from the natural science to the spiritual science.

The systems of duality, used in the experiments, form a part of consciousness of the Earth. The manifestation of interaction between them depends on the manifestation of rhythm of duality through consciousness of the Earth. Therefore in experiments are calculated not the average density or gravitational constant, but the numerical characteristics of how far the systems of duality belong to consciousness of the Earth. With the increasing distance from the surface of the Earth the Michell-Cavendish experiment would lead to other values of calculations. In general, the more will be the distance from the surface of the Earth, the less the physical laws which are valid on the Earth can be applied to. This is connected with that, that with the increasing distance from the surface of the Earth the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness are changing. They also change with the change of rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Therefore the laws which were valid on the Earth in the past, can already be not valid in the present, or will not be valid in the future any more. Rudolf Steiner pointed to this with the following words:

Thus, we come to see back into a time when other physics existed; and, looking forward into the future, when still other physics will exist. Our modern physics can be only that what there is in our immediate environment, what the phenomena of the present time can reflect to us. Physics must gain it from itself in order not to follow paradoxes, and not only paradoxes but absurdities by studying physical phenomena of our Earthly area, build hypotheses about them, and then apply these hypotheses to the whole world structure. We apply our terrestrial hypotheses to the whole world structure, and forget that what we know as physical is time-limited namely on the Earthly area. That it is space-limited, we have already seen. For the moment we come out to the sphere where the force of gravity ceases and everything streams outward, at that moment our entire physical picture of the world ceases to exist.

We have to say: Our Earth is not only spatially limited but it is spatially limited as physical Quality, and it is nonsense to think that coming out somewhere beyond the null-sphere it would have to be found something, which the same physical laws are applicable to. Just as little there is a possibility to think about the same physical laws as applicable in particular former time and after certain time of the development.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 321. Second Scientific Lecture-Course.
Lecture on 13. March 1920.

The systems of world views

With the change of rhythm of the development of consciousness of man the systems of world view will change also. When man still possessed the natural supersensible faculties, he could perceive life of the planets directly. Natural clairvoyance was lost gradually with the development of the 'I'-consciousness of man. Johannes Kepler still could perceive the Earth as living being, whose consciousness is lower, than consciousness of man. Though the Earth is a planetary being without freedom of choice, it has consciousness significantly higher, than consciousness of modern-day man.

Just as we consider man as a living and ensouled being, we must also consider the Earth. Only because we as so small beings go above the Earth, we do not see that at the same time it has body and soul. However this stems also from the materialistic time. Kepler, for example, who, nevertheless, also knew how to think, still says that he considers the Earth as a big organism. Only he had no occult view over the Earth, hence, he did not know that the winter means waking and the summer means sleeping for the Earth, and he imagined the Earth to himself as a big whale fish instead of to think about it as of the ensouled being who is higher than man. He shifted the relations a little bit down, he viewed the Earth as a whale fish, and in the air movement he saw the in-breathing and out-breathing of an animal.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 150. The World of Spirit and its Projection into the Physical Existence.
Lecture on 8th June 1913.

Kepler could find out some relations between the planets which are known as the laws of Kepler. He could describe them mathematically as relations on the plane. In other words, Kepler could describe on the plane relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which are manifested as the planets of the Solar system. However the actual relations between consciousness of the planets are much more complex, than their projection on the plane. Therefore the laws of Kepler describe only a symbolic image of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. The concept, that this image completely describes reality, is erroneous.

Thus, for example, a metal picture was formed inductively which was summed up in the conception of a central body, the Sun, with the planets revolving around it in ellipses according to a certain law, namely: the radius-vectors describe equal areas in equal periods of time. And by observing the different planets of a Solar system, it was moreover possible to summarize their mutual relations in Kepler's third law: For different planets the squares of the periods of revolution are proportional to the cubes of average distances from the Sun. - This resulted in certain picture. The question, however, was not decided, whether this picture completely fitted the reality, but it was an abstraction taken from reality. To what extent this picture is related to the totality of reality, was not established. But from this picture - not from reality at all, but from this picture - it was deduced all that what basically became then a genetic Astronomy.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 323. Third Scientific Lecture-Course.
Lecture on 4th January 1921.

Also the concept that the planets rotate round the Sun does not correspond to the reality. Such concepts correspond only to the projection of some relations of the reality on the plane. The reality is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness. Beings of the hierarchies of consciousness can be perceived by the supersensible organs of perception directly. Modern-day man can use the concepts of the spiritual science and develop the supersensible organs of perception consciously. Without such development the abstractions will be created in the science. Newton, unlike Kepler, did not perceive the Earth as a living being any more. The law of universal gravitation of Newton is even greater abstraction, than the laws of Kepler, and it is even less able to describe the real movement of the planets. The real movement would be already possible to find out, if to consider the third principle of Nicolaus Copernicus:

It is a quite strange thing with the system of Copernicus. He founded his view on three basic principles from which the today's science has accepted only two, the third one, however, was dropped away. In reality the Sun rushes at large speed through the cosmic space onto the stellar constellation of Hercules. Such a movement, as it is usually described, is simulated only by the fact that the planets co-move. The true Earth's orbit forms a screw line. What it is

called an inclination of the ecliptic, is a gravitation line between the Sun and Earth. One has forgotten that the Earth in the course of one year turns once around the axis of the ecliptic, and this rotation combines itself with the screw rotation. Copernicus still differentiated these both things, but now one does it no more. The co-movement with the ecliptic was dropped away. Thus it does not agree with the facts at all if one says the Earth turns round the Sun. A screw movement is available in truth.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 98. The Natural and Spiritual Essence,
Their Working in Our Visible World.
Die Interrelation of Worlds and Essences. Lecture on 29th April 1908.

The movements of the planets need to be understood as the changes of relations between beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. These relations were manifested as consequence of the development of consciousness of personalities through their free choice. That there are various planets, results from free choice of personalities which have the various levels of consciousness. The existing relations between the planets are necessary in order man could develop his consciousness in physical body on the Earth by himself. Man cannot have consciousness in physical body on other planets because he would lose it already on significantly smaller distance from the surface of the Earth. In order to have waking consciousness on other planets, man must learn to reserve it out of the physical body. This was known already in ancient times. That level of consciousness where man can exist in physical body on the Earth was defined in the antiquity as the plane of earthly physical consciousness of man. As man in physical body cannot leave this plane of consciousness it was said *the Earth is flat*. And as in this plane it is possible to return to that place from which one started to move in one direction it was also said *the Earth is a flat disk*. Depending on whether sensible or supersensible perception organs are used the Sun or the Earth was set in centre of the Solar system.

A world system will be built in one or another way depending on whichever point of departure, whichever perspective is chosen. If, within our world system, one asks, where the center of our world system is placed in relation to what the purely physical senses can observe, then it is the Copernican system! If one asks about the arrangement of our Solar system which comes from the ruling areas of the spiritual Hierarchies, we must still place the Earth in the center, we then get other boundary lines; the planets then are something quite different, namely they are the boundary marks for the ruling areas of the different spiritual Hierarchies.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 110. The Spiritual Hierarchies and Their Reflection in the Physical World. Zodiac, Planets, Cosmos. Lecture on 15th April 1909.

The Earth was considered to be in the centre of the manifested world structure because it was viewed as the centre of activity of the spiritual hierarchies. The centre of the manifested world structure is that highest level of consciousness on which it is possible to know the finite number of personalities in the manifested world structure. The whole world structure is in the Earth state of consciousness, and the Earth is a planetary being whose consciousness is in the centre of consciousness of the world structure. This means that the highest consciousness for personality in the Earth state of consciousness could be attained only on the Earth. The attainment of consciousness of the centre of the world structure by all personalities depends on the development of consciousness of man on the Earth.

In the world system of Claudius Ptolemy, in contrast to the world system of Copernicus, the Earth planet is placed in the centre of the world structure and is motionless. This corresponds to that, that the centre of the Earth as the level of consciousness on which it is possible to know the finite number of personalities in the manifested world structure, is unchanged. Any system of the world view is not absolutely true and is only an image which

reflects a part of the reality. The reality is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness. Depending on what consciousness is taken as a basis, there will be this or that system of the world view.

The Ptolemy's chart of heavens is usually set against of that of Copernicus, whereby one declares the first mentioned as erroneous. It is false. Both are equally true. Ptolemy's chart is related to the astral plane and on this plane the Earth is in the center of the planets and the Sun itself is a planet. The chart of Copernicus is related to the physical plane where the Sun stands in the center. All truths are relative according to time and place. The Ptolemy's system will be rehabilitated in one of the next epochs to follow.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 94. An Esoteric Cosmology.
Lecture on 28th May 1906.

Man in the physical body cannot retain his consciousness not only on some distance from the surface of the Earth in the direction from the centre, but also and on some distance from the surface of the Earth in the direction to its centre. Beings of all hierarchies of consciousness participate in the manifestation of the form of the Earth. The interaction between the hierarchies of consciousness tends to create such a form of the Earth planet which is not solidified, but is in constant change and strives to manifest the properties of a circle. The properties of a circle are manifested on any level of consciousness and are expressed in such a way that man remains on the same level of consciousness, repeating the changes of consciousness until he can attain the higher level.

The changes of consciousness of man in the plane of earthly physical consciousness are connected with changes in consciousness of the Earth and occur in circle in a sense that consciousness strives to come back in the same states. If to compare the changes in consciousness of the Earth to the movements in ocean, one of which are waves, it is possible to draw an analogy with the top of moving wave, which constantly twists in itself in order to manifest the properties of a circle and never can manifest them completely. The changes of consciousness of the Earth occur so quickly, that it is possible to perceive with physical organs only solidified imprint of the manifestation of the properties of the circle. This leads to the perception of the Earth as the physical ball.

It is necessary not to mistake the properties of circle for the properties of physical ball. On the physical ball from some material are manifested the properties of circle, but the ball can be drilled through. The properties of circle are manifested on the Earth too, but the Earth is not the physical ball filled with matter. The Earth planet cannot be drilled through even if the technics would be created which is able to drill to the depth equal to the radius of the Earth. In the centre of the Earth there is no heated core, but the centre of the Earth corresponds to that level of consciousness on which it is possible to know the number of personalities in the manifested world structure. Beginning from the certain distance from the surface man cannot retain his waking consciousness in physical body inside the Earth.

Everything what is on the Earth constitutes a part of consciousness of the Earth and it is incorrect to draw the conclusion about the whole from the behaviour of the part. This means that carrying out measurements and experiments on the Earth it is incorrect to draw the conclusion that the Earth is something like a physical ball. Man becomes conscious of the changes in consciousness of the Earth called the *rotation of the Earth about its axis*, but these changes do not result from the rotation of a physical ball. They occur together with the changes of consciousness of all other planets and stars according to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind.

Physical body of man forms a part of the Earth and cannot exist separately by itself outside of the plane of earthly consciousness. The terrestrial mineral or metal is also a part of the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness of the entire Solar system therefore it can exist not only on the Earth, but also and on other planets of the Solar system. However the

concept, that man in physical body can make journeys to other planets by means of technics, is erroneous.

The universes and human form

Also the concept that aliens can arrive to the Earth by means of technics is erroneous. Such concept is connected, as a rule, with observation of the phenomenon known as the *unidentified flying object* - UFO. Besides the descriptions by the eyewitnesses which are quite often true, there exist superstitions and incorrect explanations concerning UFO. The wrong explanation generates in turn the concepts about the incomers from space.

Attempts were made to explain, for example, the occurrence of so-called *crop circles*. However what sense does it make for the incomers from space to waste the enormous resources, to create the flying objects, to overcome huge distances to the Earth and all that in order only to create the crop circles? The crop circles can arise quite naturally, as an illness of the Earth just as a skin inflammation strives to keep the round form. There are also cases when the crop circles are created by man in order to joke and to draw attention.

Three kingdoms of consciousness are manifested in our world structure. In each kingdom exists only finite number of the *universes*. Each universe possesses such a property, that there is one form of existence in it, as the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness, which allow personality to have the 'I'-consciousness, to become conscious of itself as the 'I'. Such form of existence is a characteristic of the universe and each universe has its own form of existence for personality. The form of existence must be understood as a being without freedom of choice. Human form is such form of existence in our universe. It allows man to have the 'I'-consciousness in physical body. Our universe consists of the *star systems*. The Solar system is one of the star systems. In order to exist on the planets of Solar system consciously, it is necessary for man to have the waking consciousness out of the physical body.

Each universe is finite and has its own borders. The peculiar relations between the hierarchies of consciousness and the forms of existence are inherent to each universe. These properties determine also the confines of different universes. There are universes which, like our universe, have manifold forms of the manifestation of life. There are also universes which are monotonous and identical in their structure. The universes can adjoin and overlap each other. The universes possess a property to be manifested only in their own borders, because the forms and laws of manifestation of the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness are too different. However, everywhere where the common relations exist between the hierarchies of consciousness, it is possible to become conscious of the forms of existence of different universes.

Our universe is situated in immediate neighbourhood to five other universes. With three of them our universe has the common parts of touch or intersection of the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness, on two others it only borders. Modern-day man perceives the images of the different universes most easily in colours. In such a way our universe can be characterized by *green* colour. This must not be taken literally. The colour is not the precise mapping of the universe as it is, but only some trait inherent in it and which man is able to perceive. The neighbour that has the largest touch part with our universe is the *yellow* universe. Our next neighbour is the *blue* universe and then follows the *pink* universe. It is already difficult to distinguish in colours the other two universes.

The universes possess retain their integrity even in the parts of intersection with each other. They exist in their own levels of consciousness, as it were, parallel. However the forms of existence of each of these universes could in some degree perceive manifestations of the form of existence of other universe. Any possible cases of encounter with UFO also are related to these phenomena. Most often man can watch UFO in the form of *yellow* or *orange flying*

saucers. These flying saucers are namely the form of existence of the nearest to us yellow universe, which has the largest touch part with our universe. Man is able also to distinguish the manifestations of the blue universe. These are the *blue columns* which have light similar to the light of the lightning and which like lightning, slowly and smoothly cross the whole horizon. The common touch part with the pink universe is so small, that the physical level of consciousness does not allow modern-day man to observe the forms of existence inherent in this universe.

A picture of the blue column is placed on the book cover. The blue columns can be observed as green because the green colour is inherent in our universe. In their own universe they have the blue colour. The biggest probability of observation of the flying saucers exists in the region of South America. The blue columns are manifested in the North Pole area. However, because of the existence there of the polar lights which are the results of the processes of our universe and has nothing to do with manifestations of other universe, the blue columns usually are mistaken for the polar lights. Because the manifestation of the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness in the universes changes, the borders of their touch parts are not fixated what in turn leads to the displacement of the observation areas of UFO.

The alien spaceships, which arrive on the Earth planet do not exist as such. There are parallel forms of existence of other universes which man is able to distinguish. In yellow universe such form of existence are the so-called flying saucers. This is not the spaceships in which the aliens arrive on the Earth planet, this is the phenomenon inherent in other universe. The flying saucers are the form of existence which allows personality to be in the yellow universe and to have the 'I'-consciousness. They must not be considered as the aliens living according to the laws, inherent in our universe. They are the form of existence of the quite different universe.

Speaking in percentage terms, only on 10% these flying saucers consist of those relations between the hierarchies of consciousness, to which the concept of *matter* could be applied. On 54% they consist of the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness to which in our universe the concept of *energy* is the closest. The remaining 36% make up the relations between the hierarchies of consciousness which are not manifested in our universe. The blue columns differ from the phenomena of our universe even more therefore it is difficult to describe them through the relations inherent in our universe.

The development of science

Everything, what is manifested exists in order that personalities could develop their consciousness. The concept, that the world structure can exist independent from personalities and hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice does not correspond to the reality. Science must be extended through the concept, that all is situated in consciousness of one unified reality. Then it is possible further development of the natural science through its extension to the spiritual science. Otherwise the development of the natural science will be not progressive, but rather regressive.

Today we can predict the course of the science. The external science will not be able of the spiritual deepening how much the attempts also be made. It will go more and more over into that, what is the higher manual for the technical skill, into the means of the control of the external world. For the Pythagoreans the mathematics was still one more means to look into the interrelation of the higher worlds, into the world harmony; for today's man it is the means to equip further the technics and by that to control the external world. Making itself secularized, non-philosophical - that will be the course of the external science. All men will have to get their impulses from the spiritual development. And this spiritual development

smashes the way to the spiritual Christianity. The spiritual science will be that, what is able to give the impulses for any spiritual life.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 102. The Influence of Spiritual Beings on Man.
Lecture on 13th May 1908.

The development of consciousness of man can be not only progressive, but also regressive in the following sense. All possibilities of manifestations of the hierarchies of consciousness were determined through the free choice of the whole mankind in the state of involution. In the state of evolution the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice are manifested in rhythms of the development of consciousness of mankind. Each rhythm provides its own possibilities for the free choice of personality. Next new rhythm will be manifested beside the previous rhythm. The new rhythm will be progressive in a sense that it provides the new possibilities for the development of consciousness of personality through its free choice. Thereby the previous rhythm becomes regressive in a sense that it gives to personality a possibility of free choice to stay behind the rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. The staying behind the rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind is manifested in dependence of personality from the beings of the hierarchies of consciousness.

The development of technics is characteristics of the achievements of natural science. Before the beginning of third millennium the rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind provided such possibilities for the accumulation of means through the development of technics that it was possible to provide each man with free knowledge, medical treatment and nourishment. From the beginning of third millennium the further development of technics becomes regressive in this direction because the means are already accumulated, but are used for the satisfaction of lusts, the main of which are the lusts of power and benefit. For the regressive natural science remains nothing else but to develop technics further, to create even faster computers, the means of transportation and communication. This will lead man to dependence from technics and the dependence from technics generates such rhythm of life, which man cannot sustain. No development of technics can enable man in physical body to be on other planets. The technics can only help to create the suitable conditions of life for the development of consciousness of man in physical body.

Spiritual science is based on direct supersensible perception. It states not the theories, but the facts of the supersensible reality. And one of the facts of the supersensible reality is that the development of the whole world structure depends on free choice of personalities immediately. With acceptance of this fact it will be reached an understanding of the spiritual principles which provide the basis for the creation of essentially new technics. An example of creation of such technics was given by John Keely at the end of XIX century.

If beside the culture on the physical plan the moral culture does not go along with it, then the physical achievements act destructive. Through the development of morality man will be able to generate quite different forces than those, which are available on the physical plan now. Keely set his engine in movement through vibrations which he agitated in his own organism. Such vibrations depend on the moral nature of man. This is the first morning ray for that, what will come out as the technics of the future. In the future we will have machines which will be set in movement only if the forces come from men, who are moral. The immoral men will not be able then to set such machines in movement. The pure mechanical mechanism must be transformed into the moral mechanism.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 97. Cosmogony. The Christian Mystery.
The Testament of John as Document of the Initiation.
Lecture on 12th February 1906.

Any free choice of personality is unknowable because otherwise it could be known in advance and would not be free. Something unknown and knowable in the manifested world structure can be only that what is manifested through free choice. And this is relations between the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. The representatives of the natural science have a choice to accept or reject the assertions of the spiritual science. If the transition to the spiritual science will not be made then the further following the previous rhythm of the accumulation of means will mean the staying behind the rhythm of the development of mankind. Therefore the concepts about the physical world as the manifestations of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness are necessary first of all. The concepts about the world as the world of the separated material objects, on which the physical science is based, do not correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind any more. These concepts lead man to such dependence from beings of the hierarchies of consciousness, which will be manifested in the dependence from technics that only catastrophe will be able break such connection. To preserve independence from beings it is possible only through knowledge which leads to truth. To such knowledge it is possible to come through the development of the qualities of freedom from egoism and the organs of the supersensible perception.

Personalities and beings without freedom of choice cannot exist without each other, therefore the concepts that the laws of nature can be independent from the existence of man, are erroneous. Such misconceptions make man unfree and finds its expression also in the theories of materialism. The free choice of personality always manifests relations between the hierarchies of consciousness and always has consequences. From here it could become clear the connection between the consequences of free choice of personalities and such catastrophes as earthquakes, floods, fires and volcanic eruptions. The free choice never remains without the consequences which can be very hard for personality. Therefore especially for those personalities, on whom the distribution and use of the accumulated means depends, it is necessary to become conscious of the connection between the free choice and the catastrophes.

The following example shows the relation between the human will and earth movements: By men who die as a result of earthquakes or volcanic eruptions one observes, during their next incarnation, the properties which are quite different. They bring at birth great spiritual pre-dispositions with them because, through their death, they were brought in relation with an element which showed them the true nature of reality and the illusion of material life.

One has also observed relation between certain births and seismic and volcanic catastrophes. During such catastrophes materialistic souls incarnate willingly, drawn sympathetically through volcanic phenomena, through the convulsive motions of the evil soul of the Earth as it were. And these births can in their turn bring about new catastrophes. For the evil souls exert reciprocally an agitating influence on the terrestrial fire. The development of our planet is intimately connected with the development of the human forces and the development of civilizations.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 94. An Esoteric Cosmology.
Lecture on 12th June 1906.

The higher is the consciousness of personality, the more it will correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind, and the more it will include in itself the hierarchies of consciousness without freedom of choice. The outer physical world and inner world of thinking, feeling and willing are manifestations of the hierarchies of consciousness. Therefore that knowledge which leads to knowledge of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness in thinking, feeling and willing, will also lead to knowledge of relations between the hierarchies of consciousness in physical laws of nature. The higher will be consciousness of personality, the more the outer laws of nature will correspond to inner laws

of morals for personality. Therefore the further development of science can not be progressive if it does not correspond to the development of the qualities of freedom from egoism through knowledge of the unity of all personalities in the absolute Spirit.

Jesus Christ attained the highest consciousness of unity of all personalities. This consciousness allowed him to encompass consciousness of the Earth planet. Irrespective of, in what man on the Earth can believe, Jesus Christ acts on the etheric body of each man through the etheric body of the Earth. Therefore an attainment of consciousness of unity of all personalities on the Earth it is possible only through the Christ. The development of consciousness of man occurs through the development of qualities and faculties. Man in physical body could know nothing about the Christ and attain the high consciousness through the development of his qualities and faculties. However his qualities will allow him then to perceive the activity of the Christ in his etheric body directly. And the reality of the Christ will become obvious to man irrespective of, in what he could believe and what religion he could profess before. After becoming conscious of the reality of Christ directly, man can make free choice to follow or not to follow the Christ-impulse. The choice not to follow the Christ-impulse will mean to follow one's own egoism and will mean separation from mankind through the connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness.

Rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind is changing. This change has its expression in connection between the etheric and physical body of man which becomes looser. The etheric body begins to become free from the physical body. Man has an opportunity to know Christ and to enter into spiritual world in his waking consciousness. For man with materialistic concepts there is also possibility to stay behind rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind through connection with beings, whose existence he denies. Man who detains the development of his consciousness through the materialistic concepts and theories of natural science will be in special danger. For such man appears then the danger to experience *spiritual death*.

Man has gone out from the life among the gods; to the life with the gods he will ascend again. However he will have to know them! He will really have to know that the gods are realities. Man will not be able to recall the ancient times any more if his etheric body will be loosened again. If he has lost consciousness of the spiritual world in the medieval times, if he has appropriated solely the only belief that the life in the physical body and what is visible in the physical body are the only reality, then he suspends in the air for all future. Then he is not able to know in the spiritual worlds then he has lost a ground under his feet.

Then comes up a danger of what one calls "spiritual death" for him; since what is around him is an unreality, an illusion for whose reality he has no consciousness, in which he has no belief, and he is dying. This is the real dying in the spiritual world it is something what threatens men if they do not bring with themselves the consciousness of this spiritual world at entering into the spiritual worlds.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 102. The Influence of Spiritual Beings in Man.
Lecture on 13th April 1908.

Man who is connected with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness in such a way, that he is unable to use possibilities of new rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind, can be helped in the development of his consciousness. Jesus Christ can render the greatest help because he has the highest qualities and hence the highest level of consciousness. On this level of consciousness there are no distinctions between God which is all and the absolute Spirit.

God is Spirit.

John, 4:24.

The level of consciousness of Jesus Christ corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind most of all, what is expressed by following words.

I and the Father are one.

John, 8:32.

These words not only mean that the 'I' of each personality is the absolute Spirit. The *Father*, first of all, means the whole mankind, because only all personalities together can attain the consciousness of the absolute Spirit. No man in physical body on the Earth had such consciousness of the unity with mankind yet, which Jesus Christ has had. His consciousness is the highest consciousness of freedom which can be attained only through the knowledge of truth.

Freedom means freedom from egoism. The greatest freedom from egoism will have that man whose free choice corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind most of all. The more free choice of man corresponds to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind, the more man is able to know truth. In order to know truth, it is necessary to know consciousness of beings without freedom of choice because their consciousness is true. If man knows truth, then he includes consciousness of beings of the hierarchies in his consciousness and preserves his freedom. If free choice of man leads to mistake, which is regarded as truth, then man gets into dependence from beings because his consciousness will be included in consciousness of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness.

An attainment of freedom from egoism is inseparably connected with knowledge of truth. As absolutely free can be only the absolute Spirit and to attain consciousness of the absolute Spirit can only all personalities together, then to attain freedom from egoism it is possible only through knowledge of the unity of mankind by each personality. Therefore the free choice which leads to knowledge of the unity of mankind, will also lead to knowledge of the absolute truth as consciousness of the absolute Spirit, and hence to the absolute freedom.

And You shall know the Truth and the Truth shall make you free.

John, 8:32.

The personal message

You can become free because the freedom of choice of the absolute Spirit is manifested in your freedom of choice. Whether your choice will lead to knowledge of truth and to freedom, or to such connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness, that only catastrophe can break the connection, depends only on you because only you can make your free choice. What is your next free choice?

The main conclusions

Consciousness of some set of objects as one unit leads to the concept of number and to the concept of the infinite conscious reality which is all. That what is no all is finite and is manifested through the hierarchies of consciousness. The concepts about the world as the only world of the separated physical objects do not correspond to rhythm of the development of consciousness of mankind. Each phenomenon exists not only as separated, but also as part of the whole. Man in physical body is part of the Earth and cannot exist on other planets. The phenomenon of attraction is the consequence of relations between consciousness of beings of the hierarchies of consciousness. The Michell-Cavendish experiment points out to the existence of the systems of duality. Duality of consciousness is manifested in self-consciousness of beings. The concept of atom corresponds to concept of individuality. The phenomena of electricity and magnetism are connected with manifestation of interaction of

consciousness of beings in the systems of duality. The systems of duality allow make transition from the natural science to the spiritual science. The properties of circle are manifested on the Earth. The centre of the Earth corresponds to that level of consciousness on which it is possible to know finite number of personalities in the manifested world structure. The systems of the world views will be various depending on what level of consciousness will be taken for the basis of consideration of the world structure. In order to exist on other planets of our universe, man must have higher consciousness out of the physical body. To be in other universes it is possible if one assumes the form of existence of other universes. There is only one form of existence in every universe in which personality can have the 'I'-consciousness. The manifestation of catastrophes is the consequence of the free choice of personalities. The development of technics with an objective to satisfy the lusts of power and benefit leads to the development of egoism and make the science regressive. The regressive science leads to such connection with beings of the hierarchies of consciousness which can be broken only through catastrophe. The path of the development of consciousness which leads man to knowledge of truth and to the freedom from egoism is the path of knowledge of the unity of all personalities. The freedom of choice allows man to know the truth and to be free.

Afterword

There is no teaching, which could be absolutely true, for the absolute truth is infinite and any teaching consists of the finite concepts. The concepts and ideas can only help man to develop his consciousness.

The described concepts of principles of the development of consciousness can be accepted not only like the axioms are accepted in geometry, but they can be verified through personal experience. They allow man still during life in physical body to become conscious of sensible world of physical objects in other way, as usually. As life of man does not end together with death of his physical body, then they will help man to preserve his waking consciousness in supersensible world of the hierarchies of consciousness.

In such a way, the described concepts assist man to preserve continuity of consciousness and to attain consciousness of the eternal life. And consciousness of immortality of one's own individuality and individuality of other personalities is worth of to attain.

The remarks, suggestions and wishes with regard to the book can be sent to the following address: katssalomon@gmail.com.

Kat Salomon

Notes

Euklid of Alexandria (360-280 BC), Greek mathematician.

Yogi Ramacharaka, real name William Walker Atkinson (1862-1932), American attorney, merchant, publisher, author.

Jacob Böhme (1575-1624), German mystic.

Helena Petrovna Blavatsky (1831-1891), author from Russia, co-founded the Theosophical Society.

Rudolf Joseph Lorenz Steiner (1861-1925), Austrian philosopher, founder of the Anthroposophical Society.

Sphinx, mythical creature with the head of a human and the body of a lion with the wings of an eagle and with the tail of a bull.

Dionysius the Areopagite, apprentice of Paul the Apostle, lived in Athens, mentioned in Acts of the Apostles (Acts 17:34).

Rational or feeling (psychic) soul

We call the rational soul also feeling (psychic) soul, because this soul is really a duality, because in human nature in the period of time that we call the fourth post-Atlantean, just like the reason also worked the feeling, the sensation.

Rudolf Steiner. GA 148. From the Akasha-Chronicle. The Fifth Gospel.
Lecture on 21st October 1913.

Pythagoras of Samos (570-490 BC), Greek philosopher; *Pythagoreans* – the apprentices and followers of Pythagoras.

Trojan war, XIII-XII century BC, described by Greek mythology.

Darius I (550-486 BC), the Persian king.

Plato, Platon (427-347 BC), Greek philosopher, apprentice of Socrates.

Edda, literary works of Germanic-Scandinavian mythology.

Wotan or Odin, main god in Germanic-Scandinavian mythology.

Icarus or Ikaros; in Greek mythology the son of Daedalus. Daedalus had wings made of feathers and wax. He told his son not to fly too high with it, but Icarus got high-spirited and got too close to the Sun. Its rays melted the wax, and Icarus fell into the sea and died.

Gautama Buddha (563-483 BC), Indian philosopher, founder of Buddhism.

Patanjali (II century BC), Indian philosopher.

Three-legged, Triskelion, the ancient symbol of the island of Sicily; it is situated on the flag of Sicily.

Oedipus, in Greek mythology, the king of Thebes, who solved the riddle of the Sphinx.

Mother Teresa, real name Agnes Gonxhe Bojaxhiu (1910-1997), Catholic nun from Albania, founder of the order "Missionaries of Charity", which serves the sick and poor.

Robert Allan Monroe (1915-1995), American engineer, author.

Carlos Castaneda (1935-1998), American anthropologist, author.

Socrates (469-399 BC), Greek philosopher.

Plotin (204/205-270), Greek philosopher, founder of Neoplatonism.

Aristotle (384-322 BC), Greek philosopher, apprentice of Plato.

Laurent-Moise Schwartz (1915-2002), French mathematician.

Hroswitha of Gandersheim (935-973), German canoness, author.

Karl Julius Schröer (1825-1900), Austrian linguist and literary scholar.

Terence, Publius Terentius Afer (195/185-159 BC), Roman comedy poet.

Mile, German (geographic): 1 mile = 1/15° of equator = 7420 meters.

Isaac Newton (1642-1727), English mathematician, physicist, astronomer.

Johannes Kepler (1571-1630), Austrian astronomer, mathematician, physicist.

Henry Cavendish (1731-1810), English physicist, chemist.

John Michell (1724-1793), English pastor, naturalist, geologist.

Alessandro Volta (1745-1827), Italian physicist, physiologist.

Enrico Fermi (1901-1954), Italian physicist.

Nicolaus Kopernikus (1473-1543), Polish astronomer, mathematician, doctor, lawyer.

Claudius Ptolemäus (Ptolomaeus) (87-165), Greek astronomer, mathematician.

John Ernst Worrel Keely (1827-1898), American engineer.

Glossary

Absolute, the unified conscious reality that is all; the absolute Spirit; absolute *individuality*.
Ahura Mazdao, Ahura Mazda, Persian. "the wise Lord"; spirit of the Sun; great Aura.
Akasha, Sanskrit. "visible"; the universal principle of matter; the principle of form.
Allah, Arabisch. "God"; see *Absolute*.
Ananda, Sanskrit. "bliss".
Anthroposophy, Greek. "human wisdom".
Apocaypse, Greek. "revelation".
Apostle, Greek. "envoy", "one who is sent off".
Arupa, Sanskrit. "formless".
Astral, Latin. "concerning the stars".
Atma, Sanskrit. "Self", "I".
Atman, see *Atma*.
Atom, Greek. "indivisible".
Avatar, Sanskrit. "descent"; the embodiment of *personality* that takes place to help develop the consciousness of *man*.
Axiom, Greek. "worthy"; an assertion worthy of being accepted without evidence.
Being, that which has finite consciousness in the infinite consciousness of the *Absolute*.
Benefactor, Latin. "well-doer", "do-gooder".
Brahman, see *Absolute*.
Buddhi, Sanskrit. "cognitive ability", faculty and the ability to "discern, judge, comprehend, understand".
Chakra, Sanskrit. "circle", "wheel".
Chit, Sanskrit. "knowledge", "consciousness".
Chitta, Sanskrit. "reason"; the universal principle of mind; the principle of consciousness.
Conquista, Spanish. "conquest"; Spanish colonisation of the Americas, 1492-1898.
Demon, Greek. "spiritual being"; a being whose consciousness is opposite to the consciousness of the *heavenly being*.
Deva, Sanskrit. "god", "deity"; see *heavenly being*.
Devachan, Sanskrit. "dwelling of the gods"; mental world, spiritual world.
Dhamma, Pali. "Dharma".
Dhammapada, Pali. "path of Dharma".
Dharma, Sanskrit. "law", "rule"; right action; law of the purpose of life.
Eclectic, Greek. "chosen".
Empiric, Greek. "experience"; based on immediate experience.
Engel, Greek. "messenger".
Esoteric, Greek. "inner".
Evolution, Latin. "unfolding"; unfolding of consciousness.
Exoteric, Greek. "external".
Genius, Latin. "spirit".
Gnosis, Greek. "knowledge", "cognition".
God, see *Absolute*.
Gospel, Greek. "good news".
Guna, Sanskrit. "quality"; three Gunas: Sattva, Rajas, Tamas characterize the *trinity* in *Sankhya* philosophy.
Guru, Sanskrit. "teacher", "master".
Hierarch, Greek. "ruler"; *being*, whose consciousness includes the consciousness of all *beings* in the *hierarchy*.

Hierarchy, Greek. "holy", "domination"; consists of beings of one kind that form a wholeness or *monad*.

Heaven; the heavenly world; the world of *heavenly beings*; see *Devachan*.

Heavenly being; the *being* whose consciousness is higher than consciousness of *man*.

Individuality, Latin. "indivisibility"; the principle of *personality*, which contains all possibilities of free choice of *personality*; the highest consciousness that *personality* can attain in the *world structure*.

Inkarnation, Latin. "embodiment".

Involution, Latin. "folding", "wrapping up"; wrapping up of consciousness.

Ishvara, Sanskrit. "supreme ruler"; consciousness of the *world structure*.

Jnani, Sanskrit. "knowledge".

Jnani-Yoga, Sanskrit. "Yoga of knowledge".

Kala, Sanskrit. "time".

Kaivalya, Sanskrit. "isolation"; isolation from personal *Karma*.

Kalpa, Sanskrit. "period of time", "long period of time".

Kama, Sanskrit. "desire", "longing".

Kamaloka, Sanskrit. "realm or world of desire".

Karma, Sanskrit. "action", "deed"; free action; the act through a free choice of *personality*; the law of cause and effect; the fate of *personality*.

Kundalini, Sanskrit. "coiled", "coiled like a snake".

Logos, Greek. "word"; to manifest the will, to speak out the word is to make free choice through the *Absolute*.

Loka, Sanskrit. "realm", "world".

Man, see *personality*; *personality* in physical body on Earth.

Manas, Sanskrit. "reason", "spirit".

Manifestation, see *being*; to be manifested means to be a *being*.

Manu, Sanskrit. "progenitor", "man"; the *personality* who guides the development of *mankind* consciousness.

Mankind, first manifested *being* whose consciousness encompasses consciousness of all *individualities*.

Manvantara, Sanskrit. "period of activity of Manu"; period of activity; the state of consciousness in which *personalities* create *Karma* through free choice.

Monad, Greek. "unity", "one"; the unified whole, from which it is not possible to separate something without destroying the unity.

Nirvana, Sanskrit. "extinguishing", "blowing away".

Occult, Latin. "secret", "hidden".

Personality, Latin. "mask"; a *being* with freedom of choice; mask of *individuality*.

Philosophy, Greek. "wisdom of love"; love of wisdom.

Prajapati, Sanskrit. "ruler of creatures".

Prakriti, Sanskrit. "nature"; the principle without freedom of choice.

Pralaya, the state of inactivity or cessation of activity; the state of consciousness in which the *personalities* in the *Manvantara* state create the conditions for the generation of *Karma*.

Prana, Sanskrit. "life-force"; the universal principle of life energy; the principle of life.

Purusha, Sanskrit. "man", "spirit"; the principle with freedom of choice.

Rhythm, Greek. "flow"; the alternation of states of consciousness.

Rupa, Sanskrit. "form".

Samskara, Sanskrit. "unconscious and subconscious impressions".

Sankhya, Sanskrit. "counting"; the system of Indian philosophy.

Sat, Sanskrit. "existence".

Satan, Hebrew. "opponent"; the one who opposes and separates from *God*.

Sorat, the name of the Sun-demon, composed of the Hebrew letters Taw (400), Resch (200), Waw (6), Samech (60), read from right to left TAROS; the total numeric value of the letters 666 is the number of *evolution* or of the beast.

Stalking, tracking of one's own vices; control of behavior.

Sutra, Sanskrit. "thread", "chain"; short statement; aphorism; collection of aphorisms.

Tetragram, Greek. "four signs".

Devil, Greek. "slanderer"; fallen God.

Theosophy, Greek. "divine wisdom".

Trinity, triune consciousness of the *world structure*; three elements of *trinity*; One. Two. Three; Brahma. Vishnu. Shiva; Sat. Ananda. Chitt; 1. Logos. 2. Logos. 3. Logos; Father. Son. Holy Spirit; Chitta. Prana. Akasha; Ishvara. Purusha. Prakriti; Sattva. Rajas. Tamas.

Triskelion, Greek. "three-legged".

Universum, Latin. "entirety".

Veda, Sanskrit. "knowledge".

Vedanta, Sanskrit. "end of Veda"; System of Indian philosophy described in *Vedas*.

World structure, all that is manifested.

Vedas, large text collection in Sanskrit.

Yama, Sanskrit. "abstention", "self-control"; first stage in the yoga system of Patanjali; *God* of death in *Vedas*.

Yoga, Sanskrit. "union"; system of the development of consciousness that originated in ancient India.

Yoga Sutras, Sanskrit. "aphorisms of Yoga"; aphorisms of Patanjali, which describe the *Yoga* system of the development of consciousness consisting of eight stages: Yama, Niyama, Asana, Pranayama, Pratyahara, Dharana, Dhyana, Samadhi.

Zodiac, Greek. "cycle or circle of living beings", "circle of animals".

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